再见，来亚什基
Farewell, Rayashki

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欢迎仪式
Welcoming Ceremony FR-01

???: I once traveled to a small town called Rayashki.
???: 来亚什基是我有幸途经的许多小镇之一。

???: It was located high up within the Arctic Circle, and it was frigid cold all year long.
???: 它坐落于北极，一个相当寒冷的地方。

???: After my visit there, I traveled to many more places, from Zealand to the Balkan Peninsula. My journey went on and on.
???: 在那之后，我途经西兰岛、巴尔干半岛……以及后来的许多地方。

???: But above all other places, I kept finding my thoughts returning to that little town. To its incandescent lights glowing in the long dark of the polar night, to the shared dream of the people there.
???: 我始终怀念着这儿的一切，那炽热的光亮，那无比美好的初衷……

???: I got this picture book from Rayashki.
???: 我在来亚什基收获了这本画册。

It is a children's book—a thin one at that. But, story inside has the power to warm a frigid heart.
它是一本小巧而温暖的儿童绘本。

Once opened, whirls of bright primary colors run into one another and flow up onto my palm.
稚嫩而强烈的色彩笨拙地晕开在一张张白纸上。

I found myself returning to it during stormy days when I was stuck at home.
在之后反复发生的恶劣天气里，我无处可去，悄悄抚摩了它许多次。

This is a story about honest and ordinary people.
是的，这是个关于无数平凡而质朴的人们的故事。

Rayashki
来亚什基

???: The swans are dancing in a circle. Their arms go back and forth!
???: 天鹅们正在跳舞，围成圈儿，来回——来去——地挥着手臂！

???: Vila and the swans have done this dance almost twenty times last week. She taught the swans all their beautiful moves.
???: 在今天之前的一个星期里，维拉带着天鹅们已经跳了二十次……就是她教给了天鹅们最优美的舞步。

???: "Swan Lake is the best ballet ever," I remembered Mr. Evgeni once said so. He also said the tortoises would come to watch the show. But why would tortoises want to watch Swan Lake?
???: “《天鹅湖》是最好的芭蕾舞剧。”——叶甫根尼先生好像是这样说的。他还说会有乌龟来看……乌龟为什么要看天鹅呢?

???: Vila says she doesn't like the tortoises. She likes "knowledge." I don't know much about knowledge, but I think Ms. Vila is always right.
???: 维拉不喜欢乌龟，她喜欢“知识”……我不记得“知识”，但维拉是对的。

???: Only between you and me—Vila smells like seaweed and coral. But those are "happy" smells to me. I think she must be the princess of the ocean.
???: 嘘——维拉身上有海藻和珊瑚的味道，很好闻。说不定她是海洋的公主呢……

???: But she tells us she is not special and that everyone here is equal, no matter if they are a princess or a swan!
???: 但她告诉我们，所有人都是一样的，她一点儿也不特别。

???: That we all have two feet and ten fingers, and if we all work together, we can "build a beacon to the future." I hope in the future we still get to sing and dance, when we are not building beacons.
???: 我们都有双脚，有手指头，都可以一起“建设”我们的小镇，也可以一起表演。

???: Nina's favorite food is called Alenka; it's a chocolate bar. She used to cry a lot whenever she made a mistake with her dancing, but then Vila talked to her, and now she doesn't cry so much.
???: 尼娜最喜欢的食物是阿廖卡巧克力。她在舞步跳错的时候总是流泪……但在维拉和她聊天之后，她就很少落泪了。

???: One time, she danced very, very perfectly, so Vila gave her a piece of an Alenka bar.
???: 有一次，她成功地完成了所有的舞步，维拉给了她一小块阿廖卡。

???: I believe she will be a great dancer—if she doesn't get too nervous on stage, then she could have even more chocolate!
???: 如果她不紧张的话，我想她会表演得很好……说不定还能再得到一小块巧克力！

???: I wish I was like her. I want chocolate too!
???: 我很羡慕她，我也想吃巧克力。

???: But I'm not a swan like her. And now there's never any Alenka in the canteen's cupboard.
???: 但我不是天鹅……而且，食堂里的橱柜里已经很久没有阿廖卡了。

???: Now, Nina is the swan princess—the most prettiest of all swans.
???: 现在，尼娜成为了我们的天鹅公主——天鹅里面最漂亮的那一只。

???: Pasono is the swan prince. He is a nice swan, and he has many many swan friends.
???: 帕索诺是所有人都喜欢的王子，他是一只善良的天鹅，有很多天鹅朋友。

???: And Pyotr is the evil sorcerer, a black swan. Nobody wanted to be the bad guy, but Pyotr doesn't mind.
???: 而彼得森是魔王，一只黑色的天鹅……大家都不希望成为魔王，但彼得森愿意。

???: He is very serious and always bossy to everyone, so he doesn't have many swan friends.
???: 他很认真，对每一个人都很严格。他只有很少的天鹅朋友。

???: Pyotr just wants to do his job as perfectly as he can, because he loves our town.
???: 彼得森比任何人都希望做好他的工作……他很爱我们的小镇。

Avgust: Now Avgust is not a swan, but he also loves his town.
阿夫西维: 阿夫西维不是天鹅，但他也喜欢这儿。

Avgust: *sniffs*
阿夫西维: 嗅嗅……

Avgust: Then there is the little mouse, who moves as quickly as the blowing wind.
阿夫西维: 凉飕飕、一阵风一样轻飘飘的小老鼠……

Avgust: Will it be our new visitor?!
阿夫西维: ……是我们的新朋友吗?!

Avgust: What was it that Vila said about new visitors? I don't remember now.
阿夫西维: 这是维拉说过的知识，我不记得了……

Avgust puts down his paper, returning to the world of noise and people.
阿夫西维放下画纸，回到更喧哗的世界。

He looks around for a familiar face.
他四处奔走，搜寻着那个熟悉的身影。

Avgust: Vila!
阿夫西维：维拉——！

The boy slips through the crowd. Until at last he finds that face, looking out over a snowy field.
他穿过层叠的人群，终于在一片雪地前发现了目标。

Vila: Mm?
维拉：嗯……？

Avgust: Reporting to you, Comrade Vila! I have a very important question!
阿夫西维：向你报告，维拉，我有一个重要的问题！

Vila: Well, then go ahead, little Comrade Avgust.
维拉：请说，阿夫西维同志。

Avgust: How should we receive the new visitors coming to town?
阿夫西维：我们应该怎么对待新的客人？

Avgust: Maybe we can welcome them with Alenka, or friendship, or maybe something else?
阿夫西维：是阿廖卡、友谊，还是别的什么呢……

Vila: *chuckles*
维拉：呵呵～

Vila: We will welcome them with white snow, with smiles on our faces, and with the welcoming arms we use to achieve our dreams. As we do for everyone who comes here, little comrade.
维拉：以白雪，以友好，以对待理想的同样热忱——我们欢迎每一位远道而来的朋友。

Vila wipes away the paint from the child's face and stands.
维拉站起身来，轻轻拂去孩子身上沾染的颜料。

Vila: It's always good to ask questions. But don't forget your task today, alright?
维拉：好奇是很好的。但无论如何，别忘了属于你的劳动，好吗？

She points to the unfinished painting in his hand.
她眨了眨眼，悄悄地指了指对方手上那幅尚未完成的“画作”。

Avgust nods eagerly.
孩子忙不迭地点头。

Avgust: I won't!
阿夫西维：我记住了——！

Avgust: My drawings are important, but Vila says entertaining our new friends is also important. Which one comes first?
阿夫西维：画画很重要，欢迎新朋友也很重要，我该先做哪一个呢？

He holds up his cluttered drawing board.
忙碌的画板又支了起来。

Avgust: After the swans have flown away, Evgeni will go up to the stage.
阿夫西维：天鹅们飞走了，叶甫根尼该上台了。

Avgust: Evgeni is not an evil sorcerer, but he knows a secret magic that makes everyone's tongues hide in their mouths.
阿夫西维：叶甫根尼不是魔王，但他擅长让人不说话的魔法。

Avgust: He is not so much a bad person, I think. Evgeni's shadow is very long, but no one, not even my sunflower, can explain why.
阿夫西维：他的影子很长，连向日葵也看不懂……但他不是坏人，我想。

Avgust: Evgeni walks heavily onto the stage; his appearance comes without any applause.
阿夫西维：叶甫根尼走得很慢，没有人为他鼓掌。

The tall figure reaches the podium.
挺拔的身影终于登上了演讲台。

Evgeni: *clears throat*
叶甫根尼：咳——

Evgeni: We have received a telegraph. Zeno's investigators will arrive here in Rayashki tomorrow afternoon.
叶甫根尼：根据不久前收到的电报，芝诺调查员将在明日下午抵达来亚什基。

Evgeni: And we will be hosting a welcome ceremony.
叶甫根尼：这正是我们举行欢迎仪式的目的。

The crowd is silent in reply.
台下维持着既有的沉默，无人应答。

Evgeni: I understand your concerns. I know you don't want Zeno to interfere with your lives, nor do you want their troops stationed here.
叶甫根尼：我能理解各位的心情。你们并不希望芝诺过多地干预小镇的发展，更不希望让芝诺派驻军队保护小镇……

Evgeni: And I would remind you that they have honored their side of the deal for decades now.
叶甫根尼：事实上，他们在过去的数十年里确实是这么做的。

A callused hand rises up to break the silence.
人群中，有人举起手来。

Knut: We give them runium ore, and they supply us in return. It should be as simple as that.
克努特：咱们给芝诺卢恩矿石，他们给我们报酬——很简单，就这么回事。

Knut: Always it has been this way, since my grandfather's time.
克努特：几十年过去了，从我的爷爷辈开始，咱们一直都是这么合作的……

Evgeni: Times have changed, Comrade Knut.
叶甫根尼：不再是了，克努特同志。

Evgeni: In the old days, Zeno used to pay us generously for mining this runium, because our ore was necessary for their arcane combat vehicles.
叶甫根尼：从前，我们能够开采卢恩矿石，它们是最好的神秘学单兵作战载具的燃料，芝诺也愿意为它们付个好价钱。

Evgeni: But now, we have nearly exhausted all our mines. You know this better than I do.
叶甫根尼：但现在，这儿的卢恩矿石几乎开采殆尽了。我想，你应该比我更加清楚。

Knut: ...
克努特：……

Knut: But isn't there some other work we can do? Already, we built our own houses, and now we even grow our own crops.
克努特：那咱们就不能干点别的劳动吗？就像现在这样，咱们能够盖房子，甚至还能在培育好的土地上种蔬菜。

Resident I: He's right. Why must we work with Zeno if we could feed ourselves?
镇民 I：没错，我们能自给自足，为什么要向芝诺低头呢?

Resident II: Comrades, calm yourselves! Evgeni is doing this for everybody's sake—have you forgotten about those little monsters?
镇民 II：冷静点，同志们！叶甫根尼也只是为了来亚什基考虑——难道你们忘了那些令人头大的小怪物们吗?

Resident II: Is there anyone left on our defense team that hasn't been injured fighting them?
镇民 II：那些参加了保卫队的伙计们，有哪个身上是没挂彩的……?

The audience falls quiet. Evgeni seizes on their momentary pause.
台下一时噤声，叶甫根尼抓住了这个宝贵的时机。

Evgeni: It is as Comrade Nikita said.
叶甫根尼：尼基塔同志是对的。

Evgeni: The critters are running rampant these days. Not only have they occupied most of our mines, some have even found their way into the town.
叶甫根尼：来亚什基周边的魔精愈发猖獗了，它们不仅占据了我们的大部分矿场，有些怪模怪样的家伙甚至窜进了镇子里。

Evgeni: Do you really think we can protect our people with our small defense team? Don't you care about your neighbors' safety? Do you want to keep Rayashki an isolated town just to let it die?
叶甫根尼：仅仅靠着我们自己的保卫队，你们真的觉得能保护好这里吗？还是说，你们宁愿为了一个“来亚什基”的虚名，就罔顾周围人的死活?

Vila: Rayashki is more than an isolated town, Evgeni.
维拉：来亚什基并不只是一个虚名，叶甫根尼。

Vila: And we all know that.
维拉：你我都知道它代表着什么。

Evgeni: But this is the reality we all must face now.
叶甫根尼：现实摆在你我眼前，现在不是谈理想的时候了。

The scales on Vila's face rise involuntarily. She holds her stare.
维拉脸上的鳞片微微起伏着，她盯着叶甫根尼，半步也不肯退让。

Workers, cooks, security personnel ... Soon, all of Rayashki has joined in.
工人，厨师，保卫队人员……越来越多的人们加入了辩论。

Knut: Comrade Evgeni. It was your idea to turn to these Zeno big guys for help. But you never even asked what we think, did you?
克努特：叶甫根尼同志，把那些高高在上的老爷们找来是你一个人的决定，你根本没有向大伙征求过意见，不是吗?

Knut: So you can't blame us for disagreeing now.
克努特：你得理解大伙的抵触情绪……

Evgeni: I'm doing this for your good.
叶甫根尼：我是为了你们好。

His assurances did not seem to have much impact on the crowd.
斩钉截铁的话语显然没能缓和争执。

A cold wind passes across the square.
遗憾的是，紧接而至的一阵寒风也无能为力。

Vila: We can take care of ourself- ...
维拉：我们能顾好自己——

She has more to say, but as she moves to speak, her scales stand on edge and shiver audibly.
她还想再说些什么，一阵浓郁的冰冷气息覆盖上了她脖颈的鳞片。

She holds her hand up, signaling to the crowd. There is a scent on the wind—danger is near.
比起制止争端，寒风显然预示着某种更紧迫的危险。

???: *roars*
???: 吼吼——！

A horde of hairy critters burst into the square.
几头毛发耸立的魔精突兀地窜进了广场。

Vila: Everyone, watch out!
维拉: 大家小心——！

She picks up a wooden chair to fend them off.
她转过身，抄起一旁的木椅迎了上去。

Evgeni: Defense team!
叶甫根尼: 保卫队成员，全员备战！

Guard I: On it!
保卫队员 I: 明白！

???: *wails*
???: 呜……

The critters flee in a panic.
长相古怪的魔精落荒而逃。

If nothing else, the attack served to bring the town together again.
值得庆幸的是，它们至少为制止争端贡献了一份必要的力量。

Evgeni: I salute your sense of smell, Comrade Vila. We could have suffered much more severe consequences without your forewarning.
叶甫根尼: 向你的敏锐嗅觉致敬，维拉同志。你避免了更多的伤亡。

Handshakes and salutes are shared, their dispute now absent from anyone's mind.
握手，敬礼，像是一切都没有发生过。

Vila: Think nothing of it. It's just a reflex reaction when there is danger nearby.
维拉: 这没什么，只是……应对危险的一种天赋的应激反应。

She touches her scales, pressing them down until they settle.
她摸了摸手腕，不着痕迹地将凸起的神经按了下去。

Evgeni: But this incursion has proved my point. We need Zeno's help.
叶甫根尼: 但这正说明我们需要芝诺的协助——

Evgeni: The other townspeople are not gifted with your set of talents. We are all vulnerable to the growing dangers, wouldn't you agree?
叶甫根尼: 其他人并不具备像你这样的“种族天赋”，他们更容易遇上难以预料的危险，不是么?

Evgeni: I only ask you to put yourself in their shoes.
叶甫根尼: 我希望你能更多考虑普通人的处境。

He speaks softly, evenly, but even so, the words land like a heavy blow.
他的声音不大，却依然凌厉地刺入维拉的耳中。

Vila: Your criticism is valid and well-accepted, Comrade Evgeni.
维拉: ……我接受你的批评，叶甫根尼同志。

Vila: Perhaps I could agree with your plan. Provided Zeno's presence is a temporary one. We just don't want them to change things for us here.
维拉: 但我必须申明，芝诺对来亚什基的维和行动必须迅速完成。更重要的是，我想这儿的人都不会同意芝诺对我们指手画脚。

The atmosphere in the square moves from joyful to serious, as the meaning of their words takes hold.
广场的气氛终于缓和了下来。

Evgeni: I'm glad that you have finally come to realize what is best for us.
叶甫根尼：很高兴你们能想通这一点。

Evgeni: Zeno is known for their rigorous methods and rational decision-making, and they are committed to maintaining peace around the world. I'm sure they will make the right decision.
叶甫根尼：芝诺是一个严谨而理性的机构，他们致力于维护世界各地的和平。我相信，他们会做出正确的决断。

Evgeni: They trusted us to supply their ore, and we have faithfully played our part in supporting them. Thanks to our help, Zeno has successfully tackled many international issues.
叶甫根尼：正如他们与来亚什基过往的无数次合作。我们解决了芝诺的能源问题，成了他们坚固的资源保障。而芝诺，则在第一线解决了许多国际问题。

Evgeni: It has always been them and us together, fighting for a better world.
叶甫根尼：来亚什基与芝诺共同努力，为了更美好的世界而拼搏——

Knut: Hahaha! When he puts it that way, he's right. We should be proud of our cooperation!
克努特：哈哈～
这话说得没错，我们都该为之骄傲——！

Even without a punchline, Knut's deep belly laugh breaks the tension.
四周终于产生了一些刻意压低的、自豪的笑声。

Evgeni: Therefore, we will show our appreciation to Zeno for the contributions they've made to the world with our help. Now, let's continue our rehearsals.
叶甫根尼：在这之前，我们理应向芝诺表达敬意。我宣布，排练继续……

As the adults return to their duties, a sharp-eyed child notices that someone is missing.
吵吵嚷嚷的声音终于停了下来，眼尖的孩子四处张望，终于发现了不对劲。

Pasono: Have you seen Avgust? I can't find him!
帕索诺：你们瞧，阿夫西维不见啦！

Vila: Hmm?!
维拉：嗯——?!

Nina: Strange, where did he go?
尼娜：咦，阿夫西维同学去做什么啦?

Pyotr: Hmph, looking for any Alenka left in the cupboards, I'd bet! He's always breaking the rules doing whatever he wants.
彼得森：哼，说不定是去偷吃阿廖卡了……违反规矩，自顾自地干自己的事，他最擅长的就是这个！

Nina: We shouldn't talk badly about our classmate, Pyotr! He's one of us.
尼娜：我们不应该贬低他人，彼得森同学！阿夫西维同学也是我们的一份子……

Pyotr lowers his head, his face crumpling, until at last, he lets out a grumble fit for a bear.
彼得森沉默着把头低了下去。许久，他才发出比小棕熊还细微的声音。

Pyotr: *sighs* Yes, you're right. I just want everyone to do their best, even him.
彼得森：对不起……我只是想让大家都做好自己的事。

Vila: Don't worry, kids. We will find him.
维拉：别担心，孩子们，大人们会找到他的。

Vila pats Nina's shoulder softly.
维拉拍了拍小姑娘的肩膀。

Vila: A child is missing, Comrade Evgeni. I suggest a temporary suspension of our rehearsals.
维拉： 我们的孩子失踪了，叶甫根尼同志，我要求暂停排练。

Evgeni murmurs a half-response, until he catches the weight of her words.
叶甫根尼哼了一声，像是想起了什么。

Evgeni: Urgh, it must be that strange kid again! He is always sneaking away like this.
叶甫根尼： 又是那个古怪的孩子，这已经不是他第一次偷溜了……

Avgust has been no small trouble in the past. Evgeni frowns, but Vila's determined glare tells him "No" is not an acceptable answer.
叶甫根尼毫不客气地皱了皱眉，他还想再说些什么，却迎上一双更加坚决的眼睛。

Vila: He is only trying to understand the world in his own way.
维拉： 他在填补自己的世界。

Evgeni: ...
叶甫根尼： ……

8#1
8#1

大发现!
Big Discoveries! FR-02

Children's Square, Rayashki
来亚什基·儿童广场

The question of where their curious little dreamer has disappeared soon becomes a true conundrum,
关心石头的孩子去了哪儿呢?

as their search through the dockyard, the post office, and even the town phone booth reveals no trace of him.
码头，邮站，电话亭……反正，不在这儿。

This is, of course, because he has assigned himself a more critical mission: welcoming newcomers.
他为自己赋予了更重要的迎新任务。

A difficult task, especially when it leads him so far away. But he is not alone. His sunflower hops along with him.
它伴随着艰难、遥远，以及绵延了一路的向日葵。

Abandoned Mine, Rayashki
来亚什基·废弃矿区

Avgust: Vila once said that sunflowers mean warmth, and that makes them everyone's friends.
阿夫西维： 维拉说，向日葵很温暖，是所有人的朋友。

Avgust: They would warmly welcome every guest that comes to town.
阿夫西维： 它们热情地欢迎所有客人。

Avgust: Just like my best friend here, right?
阿夫西维： 就像我最好的朋友一样，对吗?

He raises the sunflower in his hand and whispers softly to its petals.
他扬了扬手上的向日葵，附在对方叶片上小声嘀咕。

Avgust: Best friends ... Everyone should have a best friend.
阿夫西维： 好朋友，每个人都应该有一个好朋友。

He then picks up the pendant.
而后，他捧起吊坠。

Following his whispers, the pendant emits a faint glow.
一阵古怪的嘟哝后，吊坠散发出幽微的光芒。

Avgust: ♪ ... ♫ ...
阿夫西维： ♪～♬～～

Avgust: Alright! Now here are big friends, small friends, many, many friends!
阿夫西维： 好了——现在这儿有大朋友、小朋友……很多很多朋友！

Avgust: So that our new guests won't feel so lonely when they come!
阿夫西维： 这样新来的客人就不会孤单了～

The small footprints continue forward through the snow, imprinting over older, larger steps.
稚嫩的脚印继续向前绵延着，印在更模糊的雪地靴的印子上。

He has nearly caught up with Rayashki's newest guest.
他终于赶上了他的新朋友。

???: Amazing! I've never seen such a highly mutated Ijiraq before.
???: 天呐——！我还是第一次见到异化程度如此之高的伊吉拉格【Ijiraq】。

???: I would have missed these precious research opportunities if there weren't a gathering in the town.
???: 如果不是镇上的人都凑到一块儿，像这样优秀的研究素材就只能白白地流失了。

Windsong: Windsong, seems like life has been good to you and your theory.
北方哨歌： 北方哨歌，看来上天还没有完全遗弃你和你的理论……

She stares intently at the beasts in front of her, her written notes hardly keeping pace with her whispered observations.
她目不转睛地盯着眼前的那群野兽，刷刷地写着，连嘴巴也不肯闲下来。

Windsong: The disorder in ley energy here has not only caused the exhaustion of the runium mines, but has also mutated local critters to varying degrees.
北方哨歌： 看来地脉能量的紊乱不仅体现在卢恩矿石的枯竭，甚至还给这儿的魔精们都打上了几针不同程度的异变剂。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Windsong: Then Zeno was right. No wonder they have sent so many researchers here to look for abnormalities, even the crank ones like me.
北方哨歌： 芝诺的猜测是对的，难怪他们派遣了那么多学者到这儿来寻找异象，甚至连不知道打哪儿来的乡野学者都不放过。

Windsong: It's obvious that this town has more to it than a handful of overly active critters.
北方哨歌： 很显然，这座镇子的古怪之处远远不止那些过分活跃的常规魔精们……

Windsong: But they don't seem especially interested in the mutant ones either.
北方哨歌： 可他们又对这些古怪的魔精变异种兴趣缺缺……

Windsong: Zeno, what were you looking for here?
北方哨歌： 芝诺到底想要什么呢……?

Avgust: *happy chuckles*
阿夫西维： 嘿嘿～

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌： ——!

A sudden movement passing under her coat brings her out of her monologue.
腿上传来的剧烈摩擦打断了她的自言自语。

flop
“噗——”

Windsong: Mmm?!
北方哨歌：……嗯?!

Windsong: Hey! Let go! Let go of my leg!
北方哨歌：喂——快放开，别拽着我的腿!

Avgust: *sniffs*
阿夫西维：嗅嗅——

Avgust: Strange! You're not a fox, and you're not a sable.
阿夫西维：真奇怪……你不是狐狸，也不是貂鼠……

The appearance of this unknown child brings, at first, confusion, followed swiftly by panic.
突然出现的孩子显然让忙于观察的学者慌了神。

Windsong: Hey! Kid, what are you doing?!
北方哨歌：嘿——！小子，你在干什么?!

She picks herself up, dusting off a small flurry of snowflakes.
她终于站起身来，卷起一阵稀稀拉拉的雪花。

Unfortunately, Windsong is not the only one startled by the child.
这儿的响动显然惊吓了不止北方哨歌一人。

Ijiraq: *roars*
伊吉拉格：吱＃￥&%……!

Windsong: Oh, shoot. Ijiraqs are usually known for their good temper. It seems to not apply to their mutant kin.
北方哨歌：糟了，尽管伊吉拉格生性温良，但从来没人说过它们的变异种朋友也这么好说话……

Rugged antlers aim squarely at the researcher.
一双嶙峋的鹿角对准了北方哨歌。

The creature's nose puffs with each aggravated breath.
它们目不转睛地盯着眼前的不速之客，鼻端扑腾着粗壮的喘息。

Windsong: Fine.
北方哨歌：……好吧。

Windsong: Природа это числа и черты.
北方哨歌：Природа это числа и черты.

Avgust: Umm?
阿夫西维：咦……

Avgust: Are you building blocks here?!
阿夫西维：你在这儿搭积木吗——?!

Ijiraq: *roars*
伊吉拉格：吱吱——!

The startled Ijiraq runs off into the distance.
受惊的伊吉拉格迅速地逃窜了。

Windsong: Phew! Lucky for us, it seems to still be afraid of the dark, like the rest of its kind.
北方哨歌：呼……至少这位与众不同的家伙还保留着种族遗传的畏暗习性……

Windsong: It's finally over.
北方哨歌：终于结束了……

Her satisfaction fades as she takes stock of her surroundings.
她突然想起了什么。

Windsong: Oh! My materials!
北方哨歌：嘿，我的素材——！

Avgust: Wow! You are the most "most"!
阿夫西维：你做得很好～

His little hands struggle to reach any higher. He pats the freezing hand of the researcher.
稚嫩的手努力攀高着，拍了拍学者僵在原地的手。

Avgust: You drove away all the bad critters and protected everyone!
阿夫西维：你赶走了坏蛋，保护了大家。

Avgust: The swans on the stage, the big burning furnaces in the factory, and even the uncles sleeping in the mine with Papa ... I think they would all give you a big thumbs-up!
阿夫西维：你瞧，舞台上的天鹅们、工厂的大铁炉，还有睡在矿洞里的爸爸和其他人们……他们都会高兴的。

Windsong: ...?
北方哨歌：……?

She sighs, resigned that she must now deal with her uninvited guest.
她叹了口气，终于接受了这位不速之客出现的事实。

Though, in fact, she is the one here uninvited.
或者说，她才是那位不受人欢迎的不速之客。

Windsong: Ahem, you can call me Windsong.
北方哨歌：咳咳，你可以叫我北方哨歌。

Windsong: Just to be clear, I'm not a spy, kid. I'm just a traveler staying in town for the moment.
北方哨歌：事先声明，我可不是什么窃取机密的怪人，只是个借住在这儿的游客。

She casually raises an identification card in her hand, a card adorned with a familiar sunflower pattern.
她随意扬了扬手上的证件，上面画着阿夫西维最熟悉的向日葵图案。

Avgust: Oh! But I have never seen you before!
阿夫西维：噢……可我从来没见过你！

Avgust: Do you also like to rest in the water? Like Vila?
阿夫西维：你住在水里吗？……就像维拉那样。

Avgust: Do you also have a beautiful blue tail?
阿夫西维：——你也有一条漂亮的蓝色尾巴吗?

His strange questions prove difficult to parse, even one at a time, but the little boy circles around her, unleashing more in salvo after salvo.
过于跳脱的思维显然令她难以招架，她费力制止了那个围着她打转的身影。

Windsong: I have no idea what you're talking about, but I'm certain that I'm not what you think I am, little fellow.
北方哨歌：虽然我不明白你说的是什么，但毫无疑问，小家伙，我绝对不是你想象中的那种身份。

Windsong: I am a researcher. We often stay in quiet corners when we work on a project, so you won't see us often. Understand?
北方哨歌：我是个……咳，学者。当投身研究时，我们在大多数时候都深入简出，在谁也找不着的地方，你明白了吗?

Avgust: Researchers? Like those people on TV?
阿夫西维：学者……是电视上的那些人吗——

Avgust: I saw them stand on a tall tall stage, with flowers in their arms. They spoke a lot and cried, and then they were given a shiny medal.
阿夫西维：他们站在很高的台子上，抱着鲜花，说很多很多的话，然后流下眼泪——每个人都能得到一个漂亮的金色奖章。

Avgust: Vila said the medals were to praise them for being very clever.
阿夫西维：维拉说，它们是给最聪明的人的奖励。

Avgust: Can I see your medal?
阿夫西维：我能看看你的奖章吗……?

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

This last salvo penetrated deep. Windsong's face twitches unnaturally.
孩子的问题总是一针见血。北方哨歌的面庞不自然地抽动着。

Windsong: Haha. Oh! The crystal on you looks stunning. It looks purer than those in the mine carts.
北方哨歌：哈哈——你身上的水晶可真漂亮，它看起来可比那些矿车上的纯粹多了。

Her gaze centered on it, a beautiful crystal hanging on the boy's neck. A chance possibly to stop his barrage of questions.
她的目光上下飘忽，终于抓住了那颗挂在脖子上的漂亮水晶。

Avgust: Of course. Papa gave it to me.
阿夫西维：当然，这是爸爸留给我的。

His small chest swells with pride.
小小的胸膛骄傲地鼓了起来。

Windsong: It is precious, but also very dangerous. A crystal like this is almost as volatile as undiluted runium ore. They use this stuff for war machines!
北方哨歌：它很珍贵，也很危险……比它更纯粹的，大概只有传说中的卢恩原矿了。对那些战争机器来说，它们是惹人垂涎的战略资源。

Windsong: Kid, listen to me, put that away. Go home now, and don't let anyone see it. Understand?
北方哨歌：孩子，你得收好它，别让陌生人看见了，然后赶紧回家去，好吗?

Windsong: It could stimulate the critters' appetite!
北方哨歌：对于可怕的魔精来说，它们激发的大概就是最原始的食欲了……

Avgust: Ah!
阿夫西维：呜哇——!

Windsong nods with satisfaction, eager to see him leave.
北方哨歌满意地点了点头。

Unfortunately, the sunflower gently brushes up against her arm once more.
但显然，孩子的好奇心并没有就此消失，那株向日葵又一次轻轻碰了碰她的手臂。

Avgust: Can you build a very, very tall wall? One that can protect the whole town? Like what you did with the blocks?
阿夫西维：你能盖一个很高很高的房顶吗？把整个小镇都保护起来——就像刚才搭起积木那样!

Windsong: I'm sorry, little fellow.
北方哨歌：我很抱歉，小家伙……

She points to the now-empty patch of snow-covered ground.
她指了指那片空荡荡的雪地。

Windsong: That was just a trick. It won't last long.
北方哨歌：这只是个小把戏，过一会儿就不见了……

Avgust: No, that was amazing!
阿夫西维：不，这是个了不起的成就。

Avgust: Nina, Knut, Vila—everyone should learn from you!
阿夫西维：尼娜，克努特，维拉——所有人都应该向你学习！

Avgust: Could I make the dirt and stones listen to me like you did one day? Will I be great like you?
阿夫西维：我也能像你一样，让土地和石头们乖乖听话——做出这些了不起的成就吗?

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Windsong: A strange kid like you should live in the Age of Aquarius and be a part of the New Age Movement, or become some kind of Yogi doing meditation.
北方哨歌：像你这样神神叨叨的孩子，更应该出现在新纪元运动的宝瓶座年代，或是什么冥思团体之类的地方。

Windsong: And do it anywhere but here.
北方哨歌：而不是这儿……

Avgust: The New Age Movement? What is that?!
阿夫西维：新纪元运动——是什么?!

Her helpless attempt at turning him away goes without notice; worse still, it seems to intrigue him.
阿夫西维并没有捕捉到对方的无奈。更糟糕的是，他对此产生了更高的兴致。

Avgust: Is that where you're from?
阿夫西维：你是从那儿来的吗?

Windsong: It's not a place. It's a spirit of a time. Full of interesting things—like crystals, new schools of thought, many crazy and creative ideas.
北方哨歌：它是一场盛大的风潮，里面有很多有趣的东西。卢恩水晶、新兴学派、无数天马行空的想法……

Avgust: Will the sun close its eyes? Will the dark clouds spit on people?
阿夫西维：他们那儿的太阳会闭眼吗？乌云们会吐口水吗?

Avgust: Will their ships blow bubbles under the water?
阿夫西维：大船会在水底下吐泡泡吗……?

Somehow, the persistent questions stop being a source of annoyance.
孩子不依不饶的纠缠并不使人厌烦。

The subtle warmth of his boundless wonder shakes loose the frost from her heart.
细微的、童稚的温暖拨开了某种尘封已久的乌云。

Her smile turning from feigned to genuine.
她放弃了早已准备好的熟稔套话与敷衍说辞。

Windsong: Of course! They even believe that the world is a giant piece of blank paper, and they are the artists drawing on it.
北方哨歌：当然……他们甚至坚信脚下的世界是一张巨幅图纸，并立志画出上面的一切。

Windsong: And not only that, they are obsessed with bizarre ideas. Where did the Stonehenge on the Salisbury Plain come from? Where are the ships and planes which traveled past the Sargasso Sea now?
北方哨歌：不仅如此，他们着迷于各种稀奇古怪的问题，索尔兹伯里平原的石头们是从哪儿来的？马尾藻海的船只与飞机又去了哪儿……

Avgust: I like them!
阿夫西维：我喜欢他们——！

The child's voice blurs the edges between reality and pleasant memories of her past, to a time when there were others that thought like her.
稚嫩的童声似乎模糊了回忆与现实的边缘，某些隐晦的遐想从记忆里漂浮了上来，令人一阵目眩神迷。

Windsong: They called themselves ley hunters, the apprentices of a once-renowned school of thought. However, few people in academic circles accepted the idea of ley lines as an answer to their questions.
北方哨歌：他们自称为理线师，来自于某个曾经显赫一时的学派……但许多人并不喜欢理线师，也不喜欢他们口中的图纸与答案。

Windsong: So for these ley hunters, it has been a long walk through a dark night.
北方哨歌：对理线师来说，他们度过了一个漫长的夜晚。

Avgust: Then they can come to Rayashki! Here, the sun never sets! Half the year, anyways.
阿夫西维：那他们可以到来亚什基来，太阳先生一直住在大家的头顶上！

Avgust: Then I can be their friend! And when I grow up, I will be a ley hunter too!
阿夫西维：我可以和他们做朋友……等我长大了，我也能成为一位理线师！

Windsong tightens her scarf, as if warding off a chill.
北方哨歌紧了紧身上的围巾，像是在抵御某种寒意。

Windsong: I'm afraid it's a bit too late, little fellow.
北方哨歌：恐怕已经来不及了，小家伙。

Windsong: Most have already given up. They lost interest in solving the mysteries and lost their faith in finding the curves and the lines. So the study of ley lines has been all but abandoned.
北方哨歌：许多人都放弃了，放弃了对未解之谜的解释，放弃了图纸上的直线与曲线……当然也放弃了理线学。

Windsong: There's only one fool left that hasn't given it up.
北方哨歌：现在理线学就剩下一根可怜的独苗了。

She speaks wistfully, entranced in that daze of memory, oblivious to the nearing sound of footsteps behind her.
北方哨歌说得入神，丝毫没有注意到吱嘎响起的脚步声。

Avgust: Shhh!
阿夫西维：嘘～～～

Windsong: ...?
北方哨歌：——?

Vila: And you, I suppose, are this "only one fool," yes?
维拉：你就是那根仅剩的独苗么？——这位我从来没见过的女士。

Vila pulls Avgust toward her protectively and reproaches him with a ruffle of the child's hair.
她拉过藏在一边的阿夫西维，责备地揉了揉孩子的脑袋。

Windsong: Ah! Please, ma'am, believe me, I am not a child abductor!
北方哨歌：我必须申明，女士，我绝对没有任何诱拐儿童的想法！

Vila: Well ...
维拉： 嗯……

Windsong offers a pained gesture towards the boy.
对方不置可否地点了点头。

Vila: I think this isn't a good place to receive our guest. We have much more appropriate arrangements for new friends.
维拉： 我想，这儿算不上什么接待客人的好地方。对于新来的朋友，我们有更合适的安排。

Vila: But ...
维拉： 不过——

Vila: If our guest has any ill intentions, we will retaliate.
维拉： 倘若是行为可疑的破坏分子，我们也有另外的处理方式。

Windsong: Umm.
北方哨歌： ……

8#1
8#1

羽茅地
Needle-Grass FR-03

People's Square, Rayashki
来亚什基·民众广场

The group, each harboring their own thoughts, returns toward the small town. Vila and Avgust humming out a sing-song tune.
各怀心思的一行人回到了小镇。

And anxious Windsong remains silent for the journey.
惴惴不安的北方哨歌沉默了一路。

Vila wheels around just as they arrive at the outskirts, keeping up the cadence of the song.
恍惚之际，走在前面的维拉与她似有若无的歌声一同回过头来。

Vila: We're here.
维拉： 我们到了。

Vila: Thank you for taking care of our little Comrade Avgust, miss.
维拉： 向你的热心肠表示感谢，女士。

Windsong: ...?
北方哨歌： ……?

Windsong: You mean I'm not here to be questioned? Or arrested?
北方哨歌： ——不是来审判我或者给我定罪之类的?

Vila: *chuckles* Of course not.
维拉： 呵呵～当然不是。

Vila: Perhaps we are a little too optimistic, but when we meet a stranger, we prefer to welcome them.
维拉： 对一切已发生或尚未发生的事情保持乐观与好奇，大概是这儿人们的通病。

Vila looks over the awkward figure, reading the expression on her face. The researcher breaks the silence with a stumble.
维拉仔细地观察起眼前略显窘迫的身影，值得庆幸的是，她的好奇心并未等待太久。

Windsong: Oh, well, I'm Windsong.
北方哨歌： 北方哨歌。

Vila: That's a very unique name. And where is it you come from?
维拉： 很特别的名字，听起来——你是从那边来的?

Windsong: From the east side of the Dniester River.
北方哨歌： 那边……？算是吧，我来自德涅斯特河的东岸……

Vila's scales are hit with a sea breeze. It halts her and their conversation.
她还想再说些什么，微微咸涩的海风挟着脖颈上的细腻鳞片便一同凑到了她的跟前。

Vila: *sniffs*
维拉： ……

Windsong: ...?!
北方哨歌： ——?!

The teacher breaks out from her pause.
许久，对方终于抬起头来。

Vila: No offense, Ms. But you have a complicated and unfamiliar scent about you.
维拉： 无意冒犯，女士。你的身上混杂着许多我从未闻到过的气息。

Vila: The smell of hard rocks, a lighthouse by the sea, rainwater in a humid summer. Mm. Nothing hostile, though.
维拉： 它们有的像坚硬的石头，有的又像海岸线上的灯塔、潮热的雨水……但至少，我没有从中闻到丝毫敌意。

Windsong: *chuckles* I think most rootless travelers like me smell like that.
北方哨歌： 呵呵……无根漂泊者大都如此。

Vila: Welcome to Rayashki, Ms. Windsong.
维拉： 欢迎你到来亚什基来，北方哨歌女士。

Vila motions inward to the town.
维拉认真地敬了个礼。

Windsong: Thank you.
北方哨歌： ……谢谢。

Windsong: I understand your caution. But ...
北方哨歌： 我理解你们的警惕，但……

Windsong is seized by her own suspicion, spying the unusual scales on her host's neck.
北方哨歌同样狐疑地打量着对方。

Vila catches the glance. She subtly tugs at her sleeve and shrinks her neck into her coat, taking a few cautious steps backward.
维拉不动声色地扯紧袖口，缩了缩脖子，稍微向后退了几步。

Vila: You have nothing to worry about; it's not a disease.
维拉： 别担心，这并不是恶性疾病，只是些无足轻重的小事。

Vila: Anyway, let's talk about you. I heard that you're a researcher.
维拉： 我们还是来聊聊你的故事吧……
听你的说法，你是一位研究学者。

Vila: Not long ago, many of your peers visited here. They wandered around and looked under every rock and floorboard in the town, like you do. I thought perhaps they were attracted here by the town itself.
维拉： 不久前，这儿曾涌入过许多学者和探险家们，他们流连于小镇的各个角落，就像现在的你。我以为他们受到了来亚什基的吸引……

Vila: But regrettably, not long after, they left one after another in disappointment.
维拉： 但令人遗憾的是，没过多久，他们便一个接一个地，揣着失望离开了。

Vila: I was disappointed, too.
维拉： 当然，我也很失望。

There is a curiousness in her tone.
她的语气并不像自己所说的那般失落，更多的是好奇。

Vila: Will you be like them?
维拉： 你会和他们一样吗?

Windsong: Haha.
北方哨歌： 哈哈……

Windsong: Those people are famous scholars; of course, they won't spend too much time on a project with unclear prospects. But I, I'm used to those.
北方哨歌： 他们大多是声名在外的学者，自然不会对着一个看不见方向的研究投注过久的目光。但我……早已习惯了失败。

She spreads her hands out to the town, with nothing more to say.
她摊了摊手，没有继续说下去。

Vila: I salute you for your courage and spirit of exploration.
维拉： 为你无畏的探索精神——致敬。

Windsong: I thought you ... I thought you might be more hostile to me. Shouting things like "Who do you think you are to prowl about on our private property!"
北方哨歌： 我以为你的态度会更恶劣一点儿……像是“你们凭什么染指这儿，这是小镇的私有财产”……

Vila: ...?
维拉： ……?

Windsong: Many see the study of ley lines like finding a needle in the grass of a Siberian field—wasted effort with negligible results.
北方哨歌： 外面的人都觉得理线学是羽茅，在西伯利亚的土壤中遍地都是的那一种，不仅毫不起眼，缺乏营养，更是惹人厌烦，最大的用途是抢夺属于它们的营养。

Vila: There's no such thing as meaningless work.
维拉： 劳动并无高低贵贱之分。

Vila: It doesn't matter who you are, where you're from, or what you do. You will find your purpose here.
维拉： 不论是什么身份，来自何方，也不论你投身于何种事业，都能在这儿发光发热。

Vila shifts her gaze over to Avgust, who has been found and surrounded by the other children not far away.
维拉的目光投向不远处被其他孩子们围在中间的阿夫西维。

Windsong: Is that so? No wonder how you have such an unusual student like Avgust.
北方哨歌： 难怪这儿能有阿夫西维这样……特别的孩子。

Vila: All that childhood wonder, innocence—somehow you've preserved it in him, haven't you?
维拉：你也没有破坏这样的一颗童心，不是么？

The children seem unconcerned with the new adult; they have their own world and their own rules to be addressed.
一旁的孩子显然并不关心成年人之间的问候，他们有着独属于孩子们的世界与规则。

Avgust: Is the show finished?
阿夫西维：……我们的表演结束了吗？

Nina: We cancelled our rehearsal, Avgust. Mr. Evgeni just left red-faced.
尼娜：排练暂时中止了，阿夫西维同学……叶甫根尼先生刚才气冲冲地离开了。

Pyotr: Yes! And he canceled the "Friendship" cheese on the food menu, all thanks to you.
彼得森：是啊——！多亏了你的叛逃，临走之前，他取消了食堂菜单上的奶酪。

Avgust: But I was welcoming our new friend!
阿夫西维：可我在欢迎新朋友呀～

Pyotr: And we have lost our cheese because of you. This is all your fault!
彼得森：你害得我们失去了宝贵的“友谊”……这全是你的错，阿夫西维。

Pyotr: You're the most bothersome kid in Rayashki!
彼得森：你是来亚什基最调皮的孩子！

Avgust: I know that word! "Most" means the best! So thank you, Pyotr.
阿夫西维：我知道，“最”是很好的意思！——谢谢你的夸奖，彼得森。

Pyotr: You!
彼得森：你——！

The other children gather close.
其他的孩子们也凑了上来。

Pasono: Avgust, we don't see anyone new here. You're not lying again, are you?
帕索诺：阿夫西维同学，我们都没有见过这位新朋友，你该不会又在骗人吧？

Avgust: She's with Vila! They greet each other, share footprints, and even sing together.
阿夫西维：她在维拉的身边，她们打招呼，分享脚印，一起唱歌……

Avgust: Windsong is also the "best"! She can draw many lines on the snow, and even on a seagull.
阿夫西维：北方哨歌也是“最”，她画出很多线条，在雪地上、海鸥的身上——

Pyotr: ...
彼得森：……

Pyotr: We're not having another freak in town, right?
彼得森：她该不会和你一样奇怪吧？

Nina: Do you mean drawing on the blackboard? Like Ms. Vila did?
尼娜：是在黑板上画画吗？就像维拉老师那样。

Avgust playfully shakes his head, feigning an air of mystery.
阿夫西维故作神秘地摇了摇头。

Avgust: She made the earth turn into a tall tall wall, and she blew her breath at it, and made a building appear.
阿夫西维：她捏好泥土，墙壁就竖了起来，再吹一口气，房子就建好了……

Avgust: If we had enough ley hunters like her working together, we would be able to send sunflowers high into the sky!
阿夫西维：如果有许多理线师一起工作的话，大家就能把向日葵送到天上去！

Pyotr: Ah, that's not so tough! All the men in town know how to build stuff like that!
彼得森：这听起来没什么稀奇的～工厂的每一个叔叔都擅长建房子。

Pyotr: When we grow up, we will work like them, with hoes and shovels.
彼得森：等我们长大，我们也能学会使用锄头和铲子。

Pasono: But that will take ages.
帕索诺：可那还要很久很久呢……

Nina: If we can learn how to build like the ley hunters, then we could help the adults right now!
尼娜：如果我们现在就学会了理线师的魔法……那我们就能帮大人们一起造房子了！

Pyotr: Don't listen to Avgust!
彼得森：你们可别被阿夫西维骗了——！

The children discuss the notion animatedly. Pyotr finds himself squeezed out of their huddle.
孩子们热烈地讨论着，彼得森与他鼓起的脸颊一同被挤了出来。

He puffs his cheeks and hurries over to the adults.
他快步跑到大人们的跟前。

Pyotr: Greetings, Ms. Windsong.
彼得森：向您问好，北方哨歌女士。

Windsong: Mm?
北方哨歌：嗯……？

Pyotr: Is it true? Can you really shape the earth into different things and build things from it?
彼得森：您真的能把土地变成各种各样的形状，搭起高高的房子吗？

Windsong: Not exactly. The things I build with my arcane skill have only a momentary effect. I can't use it that way. I learned it as a part of my research while studying ley lines.
北方哨歌：……这是一种短暂起效的神秘术，它来自我所研究的学派，理线学。

The other children join in.
其他的孩子们也拥上前来。

Nina: Ms. Windsong, those things Avgust told us, are they true?
尼娜：北方哨歌女士，阿夫西维说的都是真的吗？

Nina: The sun that closes its eyes, the dark clouds that spit on people, and the lines that can reveal everything.
尼娜：闭眼的太阳，吐泡泡的乌云，还有能看清一切的图纸……

Pasono: Ms. Windsong, will you be our teacher, like Ms. Vila?
帕索诺：北方哨歌女士，您能像维拉老师一样，为我们讲课吗？

Pyotr: Can you prove anything?
彼得森：您能拿出证据吗……？

Vila: Kids. One question at a time.
维拉：调皮鬼们，一个个来。

The children surround Windsong, catching her off guard.
越来越多的孩子们簇拥着北方哨歌，这显然令她措手不及。

She looks apologetically at Vila.
她略带歉意地望向维拉。

Windsong: Sorry, Ms. Vila. I should explain it to them.
北方哨歌：抱歉……维拉女士，我会向孩子们说明的。

Windsong: Mine is not a ... formal discipline. Many people believe that it "relies too much on the observations of arcanists" and "the conclusions aren't useful for the public."
北方哨歌：这只是个被大众疏远的非正式学科……沿用世俗评价的说法，“依赖神秘学家视角的观测”、“结论与大众需求不符”……

Windsong: So it is best that you kids do not study it.
北方哨歌：大概并不适合这个年纪的孩子们。

She shrugs her shoulders.
她耸了耸肩，呼出的温热水汽在她的面庞前起落。

Windsong: A pursuit of passion, fit for only a very stubborn fool like me.
北方哨歌：我想，它仅仅适合像我这样的顽固分子的自娱自乐。

Vila: I see.
维拉：原来如此。

Vila nods in understanding.
维拉会意地点了点头，她转过身去，面向一团热闹的云。

Vila: Then, you must show us all about it. Shouldn't she, kids?
维拉：当然可以，孩子们。

Vila: I'm sure Ms. Windsong would be very happy to give us a special lesson about her studies.
维拉：北方哨歌女士很愿意为你们开展一堂特别的通识课。

Windsong: Huh?!
北方哨歌：嗯……?!

Avgust: Yay!
阿夫西维：太好啦——！

Escaping this unasked-for obligation may prove more difficult than expected.
而后，这团云转眼便飘向了更远的地方。

Windsong: Ms. Vila! I thought I made myself clear!
北方哨歌：维拉女士，你没听明白吗……?

Vila: You have worked hard in this "pursuit of passion," haven't you?
维拉：你为自身热爱的事业付出了许多努力，不是么?

Windsong: Regardless, the study of ley lines is ... Well, it's useless.
北方哨歌：理线学是门“多余”的学问。

Windsong lightly taps her yellowed notebook filled with cryptic scribbles and notes.
北方哨歌轻拍着手中泛黄的笔记本，上面画满了密密麻麻的线条与笔记。

Vila: Useless?
维拉：多余……?

Windsong: These kids should learn something like geography. It's a much more thorough and important field.
北方哨歌：世界上早就有了相当完备的地理学。

Windsong: As far as the general public and academic institutions are concerned, the study of ley lines is just a niche aspect of geography, worse still, one that is solely accessible to arcanists.
北方哨歌：无论是人们，还是其他的学术机构，他们并不需要一个看上去和它差不多的，立足于更“狭隘”的神秘学视角的小众学科。

Windsong: To devote any real time to its investigation would take up valuable research funds and equally valuable researchers.
北方哨歌：瓜分研究经费，分流研究人员……大部分人都不乐意见到这样。

Vila: At least that was how they felt about it.
维拉： 一种糟糕的学术倾轧。

Vila furrows her brow.
维拉皱了皱眉头，用力踩实脚下的土壤。

Windsong: Who can say for certain?
北方哨歌： ……谁知道呢?

Vila: What about you? Do you also think that the study of ley lines is a waste of funds and manpower?
维拉： 那么你呢，你也认为理线学是毫无意义的么?

Windsong: I, of course, I don't. Through ley lines, we can detect arcanum-related events in the area, learn about local arcane creatures, and find the secrets hidden both above and below the earth's surface.
北方哨歌： 我——当然不……理线学并非一无是处。它能让人了解当地的神秘学现象，分析神秘动物，了解地表甚至是地壳中的秘密。

Windsong: But, I can't yet prove this to people.
北方哨歌： 只是……我目前还没法证明更多的事。

Vila places her hand on Windsong's shoulder.
维拉拍了拍北方哨歌的肩膀。

Vila: Well, you don't have to prove it alone.
维拉： 那么，我们也一样。

Vila: It doesn't matter what others think of your work. The only important thing is finding its uses.
维拉： 外界的承认与否并没有那么重要，能否发挥作用才是最重要的。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Vila: At first, Rayashki was just a remote village far north in the Arctic Circle. People came here to share a dream of a better future. It was only by luck that we found the runium.
维拉： 最早的时候，来亚什基仅仅是一个鲜为人知的偏远极区，人们为了同一个理想来到这儿。值得庆幸的是，我们在这儿发掘出了卢恩矿石。

Vila: Then Zeno approached us and became our business partner.
维拉： 再后来，芝诺找到了我们，成了来亚什基的第一个合作者。

Vila: For over 60 years, people here have worked together to make it what it is now.
维拉： 这儿的人们为之奋斗六十余年，将它建设成了现在的样子。

Vila: We built the school, the swimming pool, and the cinema ... For everyone.
维拉： 我们为它创造了学校，创造了游泳馆、电影院……当然，这也是为了我们每一个人。

Vila: Rayashki embraces and takes in every newcomer. You and your studies are no exception.
维拉： 来亚什基接纳也鼓舞着身处其中的每一个人……当然也包括你与理线学。

Vila: This is where our paths meet.
维拉： 我们殊途同归，不是么?

Vila smiles warmly. It hits like a warm sea breeze.
维拉亲切地笑了笑，像一阵暌违已久的暖风。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

A pair of hands, concealing sharp scales, extends toward Windsong.
一双掩藏起棘刺与棱角的手伸到了北方哨歌的面前。

Vila: Please know that ...
维拉： 我需要申明的是——

Vila: I'm not just doing this for you. I'm doing this for a better future.
维拉： 这一邀请并不只是为了鼓励你，更是为了我们的未来。

Vila glances at the children not far away. Some of them seem to be solemnly saluting a sunflower, as if it were a security team guard.
维拉望向不远处的孩子们，有人正认真地对着一株向日葵敬礼。

Vila: A well-rounded education is vital in bringing up the next generation of scientists and workers.
维拉： 最优秀的科学家与劳动者们往往诞生于全科教育与通识教育并进的时代。

Vila: Our children should learn more about this world, even from those perspectives and types of knowledge that aren't widely accepted.
维拉： 孩子们理应接受更丰富、更全面的知识，哪怕它并未受到广泛的认可。

Windsong looks out to them and meets the face of her unexpected friend. He waves back excitedly.
北方哨歌会意地看了过去，她目光与阿夫西维撞在一起，后者兴奋地向她挥手。

Windsong: Thank you, Ms. Vila.
北方哨歌： 感谢你的邀请，维拉女士。

She clasps her hand; it is colder than expected, but welcoming.
她回握住那只冰凉却格外热情的手。

8#1
8#1

园丁对花儿说
Said the Gardener to Flowers FR-04

Windsong: The study of ley line sees the world as a clear map.
北方哨歌： 理线学希望将世界变成一张简洁的图纸。

Windsong: The cities look like squares to us, while natural landscapes appear to be curves overlapping one another.
北方哨歌： 在我们眼里，城市是一个个整齐的方格，大自然是许多条交叠的曲线。

Windsong: Many bizarre places in the world, such as the location of the Tunguska explosion or the mysterious 30th Parallel North, can't be drawn in squares and curves like cities and ordinary landscapes.
北方哨歌： 但世界上有许多奇怪的地方，比如发生大爆炸的通古斯、神秘的北纬 30 度……它们并不能被归入其中。

Windsong: We need to find a way to indicate them,
北方哨歌： 所以我们不得不将它们画出来。

Windsong: in a clear, precise way.
北方哨歌： 以更清晰的方式。

Avgust: It's a maze!
阿夫西维： 是迷宫！

Windsong: Well, it is the ley line map of a city. But you are right. It does look like a maze.
北方哨歌： 实际上，这是一张属于某座城市的地脉能量网。当然，你们也可以将它视为迷宫。

Windsong: To begin with, I should introduce the most crucial concept in the study of ley lines—that of ley energy.
北方哨歌：首先，我想给各位介绍理线学理论中最重要的概念——地脉能量。

Windsong: It is a special energy which we can easily detect throughout the town. See how it comes out from underneath the ground and goes into the local biosphere, circulating around like a system.
北方哨歌：这是一种特殊的能量形式，我们能从城市的任何地方观察到它的存在。它们从地底向上渗出、蒸腾，在一切生物与非生物之中富集。

Windsong: If we think of the town's ley lines as a food web, then ley energy lies at its foundation.
北方哨歌：如果将城市本身看作一张巨大的食物网，地脉能量则位于食物网的最底层。

Avgust: Like how big fish eat small fish, and small fish eat even smaller fish!
阿夫西维：大鱼吃小鱼，小鱼吃——更小的鱼！

The boy's comparative is simple but essentially correct.
他抓住了这个更简洁的形容词。

Windsong: Exactly. They are the smallest "fish" eaten by the "big fish." If we catch the "big fish" and study what they eat, we will know where to find the other "big fish."
北方哨歌：是的，它们是最小的“小鱼”，“大鱼”们吃掉它们，我们抓住“大鱼”，分析它们的鱼肉，从而找到别的“大鱼”们。

Windsong: And the ley energy, I mean, when the "big fish" die and break down, the "small fish" will go back to where they first came from. The circulation goes on and on.
北方哨歌：而后，地脉能量……咳，随着“大鱼”们的死亡与分解，“小鱼”回到原点，就像跃入一条永恒循环的长河。

Vila: You've put it very well, Ms. Windsong.
维拉：这是个很有趣的假说，北方哨歌女士。

Vila: Like the rainwater that comes from the ocean, to the rivers, and returns back to the ocean.
维拉：它正如我们所见的雨水、河流……从大海中来，也终将回到海洋。

Her tone rises, the scales along her neck unfurling slightly.
她的语气明显地兴奋了起来，连鳞片都微微张开。

Windsong: You are a quick learner.
北方哨歌：你理解得很快。

Windsong: But it is not exactly like water. The concentration of ley energy is far more noticeable than that of a lake or a school of fish. Once we find its densest spot, we will be able to trace it back to its source.
北方哨歌：但与之不同的是，地脉能量的富集现象远比水源与小鱼要明显的多。当我们找到它的源头，我们便能借此发现它所流经的一切痕迹。

Nina: Then what are these bright spots?
尼娜：那这些发亮的光点是什么呢……?

Windsong: These are the energy-rich locations. In a way, they indicate the energy flow.
北方哨歌：它们代表着地脉能量最丰裕的地方，也在某种程度上指引着地脉能量的流向。

Avgust: So many, they look like stars in the sky!
阿夫西维：比天上的星星更多——！

Windsong: Yes, and finding these locations can be very costly in terms of time and manpower.
北方哨歌：是的，确认地脉能量的富裕点是一份需要耗费许多时间与人力的工作。

Pasono: Then, what do we do after finding them?
帕索诺：那……发现它们之后呢?

Windsong: They can "tell" us many things. The ley hunters will follow their courses, analyze the components in them, and match those components to each resource.
北方哨歌：它们是理线师们的“眼睛”。我们观察地脉能量的走向，分析地脉能量中富集的成分与痕迹，把它们与现实中存在的资源一一对应……

Windsong: Some of the components don't match with any of the known resources, which means there might be a new resource waiting to be discovered.
北方哨歌：那些无法确认来源的痕迹，便预示着我们尚未发现的新资源。

Windsong: Of course, from the ley energy, we can also learn about the local critters.
北方哨歌：当然，周边那些怪模怪样的魔精们，它们的痕迹与习性一定会在地脉能量中有所显示。

Pyotr: You talk about strange things, almost like Avgust does!
彼得森：您说的话与阿夫西维一样难懂！

He pouts, finding all of this hard to believe.
不服气的孩子撅起嘴巴，他显然难以相信这一切。

Pyotr: These are just lines.
彼得森：它们不就是些普通的线条吗？

Avgust: Like dancing earthworms! They wriggle, they twist, they are having fun!
阿夫西维：蚯蚓们在跳舞，摇摇——摆摆——它们一定很快乐～

Avgust: Jumping on the waves, then into the little boxes, and back into the little balls!
阿夫西维：它们跳到了水花上，跳到了四方格……最后跳回了小圆球里！

Pyotr: *sighs* Great, we have two of them now.
彼得森：唉……这儿又多了一位“阿夫西维”。

Classroom, Rayashki
来亚什基·综合课堂

Nina: They look interesting, but we don't really understand.
尼娜：它们看上去很有趣，但我们不明白……

Her theories are a bit too complex for children at this level, even with the aid of a drawing.
但无论如何，理解一个新理论对孩子们而言过于复杂了，哪怕只是一张图纸。

Windsong: Cheer up, kids. It's not finished yet.
北方哨歌：别灰心，小家伙们……实际上，这只是个半成品。

Windsong: Ley line cartography is complicated. It takes the efforts of many ley hunters working together, investigating the area, even braving dangerous and forbidden places.
北方哨歌：绘制完整的地图是一项复杂的工作。它需要许多理线师们一同考察、分析环境，甚至需要深入城市禁区与危险的地方……

Windsong: To this day, we've never been able to finish a completed ley energy map.
北方哨歌：所以我们始终没能绘制出一张完整的地脉能量图。

Their enthusiasm dims, but some remain immersed in the world of ley lines.
得到安慰的孩子们平静下来，但仍有人沉浸在线条的世界之中。

Avgust raises up the incomplete drawing.
阿夫西维兴奋地扬起了那张并不完整的图纸。

Avgust: I know! I know it now!
阿夫西维：我、我知道了！

Avgust: This is Rayashki!
阿夫西维：——这是我们的来亚什基！

Vila: ...?
维拉：……?

Pasono: Ah! I see it too! And here is the swimming pool. That little square is our square. These little balls are our homes!
帕索诺：啊！原来如此——这儿是游泳场，那个方格是我们的广场，那些小圆球是我们的家！

Nina: Oh! I live here, the third ball on the left of yours.
尼娜：我住在这儿，就在你左边的第三个圆球。

The children react with surprise. Windsong applauds.
孩子此起彼伏地惊讶着，北方哨歌鼓起了掌。

Windsong: You're very bright, Avgust. This is the ley energy map of Rayashki.
北方哨歌：你果然很敏锐，阿夫西维……这确实是来亚什基的地脉能量图。

Nina: But, Ms. Windsong, why are you mapping the energy of our town?
尼娜：可是，北方哨歌老师，您为什么要画下我们的小镇呀?

Nina: Have you found any secrets that we don't know?
尼娜：难道这儿还有连我们也不知道的秘密吗……?

Windsong: Children, right now, you can only see what's above the ground, but there is even more ley energy beneath the ground.
北方哨歌：小家伙们，你们看到的只是它的表面，而地脉能量会告诉我们完整的答案。

Windsong lowers her head, feeling momentarily transported back to a time long past, while her audience listens intently below.
北方哨歌摇了摇头，像是回到了某种久违的过去，台下的人们认真地倾听着关于理线学的一切。

Windsong: Will the sun always be in the sky? Will the glaciers ever melt away? What lies in the darkness beneath us?
北方哨歌：太阳会一直挂在天上吗？远处的冰山会消融吗？地底下又有多少秘密?

Windsong: Are there other critters around here that you've never seen? How should we deal with them?
北方哨歌：小镇的周围是否又藏着你们从没见过的魔精，我们又应该如何应付它们呢?

This topic sets off a clamor of excitement from the children.
这一话题显然更能吸引孩子们的兴趣。

Pasono: I heard once that there were many strange footprints next to the school windows.
帕索诺：我听说过——！学校的窗户上就出现过许多奇怪的脚印。

Nina: Uncle Patrik saw it! A monster with six legs, and each one has spikes!
尼娜：食堂的帕特里基大叔也见过，那是一种长着六只脚的可怕怪物，腿上全是比锉刀更锋利的刺！

Windsong: That must be a Qiqirn, a small sized canidae critter, mostly seen in cold areas.
北方哨歌：奇肯恩【Qiqirn】，一种小巧的犬科魔精，大多时候生存在寒冷的地方。

Windsong: But the ley energy might have affected the weather of their habitat, or they wouldn't be here in Rayashki in summer. The deep blue line here shows that particular one's movement.
北方哨歌：当然，由于受地脉能量变化而导致的反季节情况的影响，它们确实出现在了这里，那条深蓝色的线条正是它的痕迹。

Pyotr: Or maybe Uncle Patrik could have drunk too much.
彼得森：帕特里基大叔肯定是喝醉了……

Windsong: The ley energy accumulated in them suggests that they mostly feed on moss and worms under the snow and stay near town.
北方哨歌：从它们体内所富集的地脉能量可以看出，它们主要的食物是雪地下的泥土与小虫，且常出没于离小镇更近的地方。

Windsong: We can infer that this is a docile, herbivorous kind of critter that is merely curious about human behavior. I think feeding them will be much more useful than driving them away.
北方哨歌：我们可以推断，这是一种温顺的草食性魔精，且对人类的行为相当好奇。如果你们见到了它，我想，喂食比驱赶要有用得多。

Vila nods thoughtfully.
维拉若有所思地点了点头。

Vila: Since these critters began to overrun the area, the defense team has encountered many new creatures. I can feel there's something strange about them, but I can't yet understand the differences.
维拉：自打小镇周边的魔精泛滥以来，保卫队就见到了许多从未见过的新怪物。尽管我能感受到些许它们的怪异，但我始终没能理解它们的差异……

Vila: You provided a different angle on the situation, Ms. Windsong. I believe it could help the defense team greatly.
维拉：你为我们提供了一个新鲜的视角，北方哨歌女士。我想，这或许能解决保卫队面临的许多难题。

These new discoveries have provoked interest in the teacher and her students alike.
新课题，新发现，大人们的，孩子们的，源源不断。

Avgust: The fires in the furnaces are out, the bees and kites dance around the pond, white mosses on the wall.
阿夫西维：炉子里的火熄灭了，蜜蜂和风筝在水池跳舞，围墙长出白色的苔藓……

Avgust: Oh, oh! Stones will fall down from the sky!
阿夫西维：呜呜～天上的石头要砸下来了！

Windsong: Huh?!
北方哨歌：嗯……?!

His bizarre yet ominous statements seem to upset the others.
稚嫩而清晰的结论显然震惊了不止一人。

Pyotr: Stop saying these strange things, Avgust!
彼得森：你在胡说些什么呢，阿夫西维！

Pyotr: The defense team will keep the critters out of town and protect everyone!
彼得森：那些可怕的魔精只会乖乖地待在小镇的外面，保卫队会保护好大家！小镇里面是最安全的地方！

Pyotr: And there will not be any stones falling from the sky!
彼得森：这儿更不会有什么石头砸下来——！

Pyotr stands up, his fists clenched and face flush red.
彼得森气鼓鼓地站了起来，拳头握得很紧。

Avgust: Is everything alright, Pyotr?
阿夫西维：你难过吗……？彼得森。

Pyotr: You! You're lying! Rayashki is safe. It will be our home forever!
彼得森：它们……它们都是假的——来亚什基很安全，我们可以一直住在这儿！

Windsong: I hate to tell you this, kid. But what Avgust just said could be right. I have the same feeling that ...
北方哨歌：我不想骗你，小家伙。但阿夫西维的说法并不完全是错的，我同样有类似的设想——

Windsong: The good weather here won't last too long.
北方哨歌：像现在这样的好天气，大概持续不了太久了。

She gazes outward. The sky above is gray and growing darker.
她望向窗外，天灰蒙蒙的，像是蒙上了一层阴影。

Windsong: Look at those thick, gray lines.
北方哨歌：瞧瞧那些灰白相间的粗线条～

Windsong: Those are the traces of cloud movements and moisture. Now, they're mingled together.
北方哨歌：它们是云朵与水汽的痕迹。而现在，它们混成了一团。

Nina: But the sun will still be shining. Ms. Vila said that the polar day will last for a very, very long time!
尼娜：可太阳一直都在呀……维拉老师说过，来亚什基的极昼还会持续很久呢～

Windsong: Ms. Vila was right, and past statistics don't lie. According to the data, the weather here should continue for the next few months.
北方哨歌：当然，历年的天气数据不会骗人。它告诉我们，在近期的几个月里，这儿的天气都不会有什么变化。

Windsong: Yet the ley lines say otherwise. They say the weather will be extremely unpredictable.
北方哨歌：可就理线学的推测来说，这儿的天气极其不稳定，随时可能转向更糟糕的状况。

Pyotr: You are making things up! The forecaster on TV said the weather in Rayashki will be temperate in the coming months.
彼得森：您在骗人——！
电视上的播报员说过，这几个月，来亚什基的天气都很凉爽。

Windsong: And the weather forecaster was right according to his analysis, but life is full of surprises.
北方哨歌：当然，官方给出的数据总是对的，但这并不绝对。

Vila: I know why you're concerned, Ms. Windsong. I feel the glaciers are melting slightly faster than usual. There's going to be a warm front forming from the melting water.
维拉：我能理解你的担忧，北方哨歌女士。我也感受到了周围冰山的轻微融化，它们似乎成为了更温暖的水流，而又升上天空……

Windsong looks at her audience. She had half-hoped for some opposition from them.
北方哨歌讶异地看着台下，预想中的反对与鄙夷并未抵达。

Nina: But, but will there really be stones falling from the sky?
尼娜：那、那天上真的会有可怕的石头出现吗?

Windsong: I can't say anything for certain just yet, kid.
北方哨歌：我不能保证，小姑娘～

Windsong: All I have is this incomplete map, and as you can see, many sources of the marks and traces haven't been located, which means we can't come up with a precise calculation.
北方哨歌：以目前这份残缺的地脉能量图来看，许多痕迹都没能对应上它们的主人，理线学暂时无法给出更确切的结论……

Windsong: But there's no question that Rayashki will soon face many challenges. The weather could become much worse, the environment might change, maybe some unknown critters might turn up.
北方哨歌：但毫无疑问，天气的恶化、环境的改变，甚至某些更危险的魔精……它们都有可能出现在来亚什基。

Pyotr: ...
彼得森：……

Pyotr: Liar! You are all liars!
彼得森：我才不相信……你们都是骗子！

Pyotr: Rayashki is our home, so it can't be dangerous!
彼得森：小镇是我们的家园，它是最好的地方！

The class bell rings at an inopportune moment.
下课铃声不合时宜地响了起来。

The children rush out of the classroom one after another.
孩子们一前一后地冲出了教室。

Avgust: Pyotr, you can't fly if your feathers get wet!
阿夫西维：彼得森，魔王的羽毛是不能被打湿的。

Windsong sighs. Although she hasn't fully adapted to her new role, she must keep up with the children.
北方哨歌叹了口气，尽管还没能适应自己的新身份，但她得跟上孩子们的脚步。

Vila intercepts her.
维拉及时地拦住了她。

Vila: They will need some time to take in all this new knowledge, don't you agree?
维拉：一堂新课程的学习总需要一点儿时间，不是吗?

Windsong: I thought I could handle all their questions. I think I made things worse. Sorry.
北方哨歌：我以为自己早就习惯了这种场面……抱歉……

Vila: Have faith in them. They will come around.
维拉：相信孩子们吧，他们能处理好的。

Children's Square, Rayashki
来亚什基·儿童广场

Pyotr squats on the ground, muttering softly to himself while rolling some pebbles.
彼得森蹲在地上，小声地嘟哝着。

A sunflower, and the boy attached to it, approaches.
向日葵也靠了过来。

Pyotr: Are you here to laugh at me?
彼得森：你是来嘲笑我的吗……?

Pyotr: All these stories of monsters and falling stones—they aren't good at all!
彼得森：那些魔精和天上的石头的故事，一点儿也不好！

Pyotr: I overheard Mr. Evgeni talking.
彼得森：我偷偷听到了叶甫根尼先生的谈话……

Pyotr: He said the town has so many problems, and soon, what some people think will decide our future.
彼得森：他说，小镇现在面临着很多问题，大家的意见对于小镇的未来非常重要。

Pyotr: If people believe in those terrible stories, maybe they will be scared, and they won't come back to Rayashki.
彼得森：如果其他人都相信了这些可怕的话……他们就会害怕，就会不再喜欢来亚什基了……

Pyotr: Our town will be forgotten.
彼得森：甚至会放弃小镇。

Avgust: But, I wasn't lying.
阿夫西维：可是，我没有说谎呀……

Choking tears fill their small world.
泪珠与哭腔充盈着这片小小的天地。

Rustling sounds come up from behind the flowerbed.
窸窸窣窣的响动从花坛后传了出来。

???: *roars*
???：嗷呜～

Crimson eyes set in a furry head observe them with curiosity.
绒毛盖过的赤色瞳仁好奇地观察着眼前的一切。

Avgust: Mm? Hello, Qiqirn!
阿夫西维：咦……你好呀，奇肯恩——！

Pyotr: What, what are you doing?! I will draw its attention. You go find the defense team for help!
彼得森：你、你在做什么呀?!
我来拦住它们，你快去找保卫队的叔叔们呼救！

The older boy opens his trembling arms defensively.
年长的孩子张开了颤抖的手臂。

Children's Square, Rayashki
来亚什基·儿童广场

A mound of sunflower seeds is presented on a pair of tender hands.
一粒粒精巧的向日葵种子在稚嫩的手上摊开着。

Moist nostrils approach, and then a rough tongue greedily curls around the seeds.
湿润的鼻孔凑了上来，而后，毛躁的舌头贪婪地卷起所有的种子。

Avgust: *chuckles* Heh-heh, it's itchy!
阿夫西维：嘻嘻～好痒呀——！

The Qiqirn purrs contentedly as the now empty hands stroke it gently but confidently.
奇肯恩满意地打起呼噜，一双手轻轻地摸了上去。

Avgust: It feels warm, doesn't it?
阿夫西维：它摸起来很暖和，对吧！

Avgust: Ms. Windsong said they can be our friends, that they would bring seeds to every corner of the town.
阿夫西维：北方哨歌说，它们很温暖，是我们的好朋友，把种子种在小镇的各个角落……

Pyotr: Like a gardener?
彼得森：就像我们的园丁先生一样……?

Another pair of hands reach out to cautiously caress its fur.
另一双手也颤巍巍抚上了那一簇柔软的绒毛。

Avgust: Yes!
阿夫西维：没错！

Avgust: Go plant more sunflowers, Qiqirn!
阿夫西维：去种下更多的太阳吧，奇肯恩～

The deep blue creature darts away.
那团深蓝的身影一溜烟地跑开了，留下一小块余温尚存的角落。

Pyotr: ...
彼得森：……

Pyotr: So, Ms. Windsong was not a liar.
彼得森：所以……北方哨歌老师没有说谎……

8#1
8#1

手风琴
Accordion FR-05

Port, Rayashki
来亚什基·港口

The warm current of the ocean is a stranger to this place.
北大西洋暖流的风并未吹及这里。

The long-silent dock seems to be pining for use, for visitors, to bustle once more with industry.
但沉寂已久的码头确实收获了久违的喧闹。

A lone figure stands there, resolute, unblinking.
有人在码头上远眺，有如沉默的塑像。

Evgeni: ...
叶甫根尼：……

Vila stretches out as she stands beside him. The scales on her wrists and ankles catch the light, shimmering against a white reflection in the water.
维拉努力地伸展身体，她手腕和脚踝上的鳞片裸露出来，在一片白色的映照下熠熠生光。

Vila: Do you really think it's a good idea to turn to Zeno for help?
维拉：你真的认为寻求芝诺的帮助是个好选择吗?

Evgeni: We have drawn almost every man and woman from the mining facilities to get rid of the critters nesting around the port.
叶甫根尼：为了驱逐盘踞在港口的魔精，我们甚至将矿区周边的人手都抽调了过来。

Evgeni: Most of the defense team were injured. Some lightly, but others got much worse. It will be weeks before they can return to duty.
叶甫根尼：保卫队的轻伤人员超过五成，其中的一部分人受伤更加严重，需要在家休养半月以上。

Evgeni: If an attack like the one at the rehearsal happens again, I'm not sure we will be able to protect ourselves.
叶甫根尼：如果再发生类似上次排练时的大规模魔精袭击事件，恐怕不是负伤这么简单了……

His stance doesn't waver, but his face turns stiffly toward the abandoned mine far in the distance.
他的身躯毫不动摇，目光落在更遥远的废弃矿山上。

Kittiwakes screech as they swoop down over the vast white tundra.
叫不出名字的尖嘴鸥鸟呼啸着掠过白茫茫的大地，此起彼伏的嘶吼声遥遥传来。

Vila: ...
维拉：……

Evgeni: I know most of our people are frustrated with Zeno's arrival. But I expected better from you, Vila.
叶甫根尼：现在许多人都在为芝诺的到来而置气……我希望你能清醒一点，维拉。

Evgeni: People trust you, and they will follow you, but that doesn't make you right. Maybe you're still too young to see the dangers.
叶甫根尼： 人们信任你，愿意跟随在你身后，但这并不代表着正确。你们太年轻，对这个世界的认知尚不全面。

Vila: I might be wrong, but history is a long lesson in learning what is right through being unafraid to be wrong.
维拉： 历史不正是在一步步试错中向前的么？

Evgeni: Sadly, we don't have time for trial and error.
叶甫根尼： 可留给来亚什基的时间不多了。

Vila: And this is your excuse for making decisions for us against our will?
维拉： 所以你替这儿的所有人做出了决定，而毫不在乎他们是否接受？

Evgeni: I will hold myself responsible for my decisions. In that, you have my word.
叶甫根尼： 我会为我做的一切决定负责，我保证。

Their conversation reaches deadlock once again.
谈话不可避免地又一次陷入僵局。

Fortunately, elsewhere, there are others with fewer and simpler burdens.
好在，我们仍能见到一个更简单的世界。

Avgust: Today is the day of our welcome ceremony. Vila said, when the bell rings, the important people from the tortoise academy will arrive.
阿夫西维： 今天是举行欢迎仪式的日子。维拉说，当钟声响起的时候，乌龟学院的大人物们就会来到我们的小镇。

Avgust: Everyone looks excited.
阿夫西维： 是的，每一个人都很高兴。

Avgust: Nina has put on her best dress. I know she will be great on stage.
阿夫西维： 尼娜穿上了她最漂亮的裙子，她一定能跳得很好。

Avgust: Pasono will duel with Pyotr. It's his duty to protect the princess.
阿夫西维： 帕索诺即将与彼得森决斗，他必须保护好公主。

Avgust: As for me, I got a new job from Mr. Evgeni.
阿夫西维： 叶甫根尼先生为我安排了新的工作。

Avgust: "Salute, shake hands, and give them the warmest welcome."
阿夫西维： “敬礼，握手，向来到这儿的每一位先生致以最诚挚的问候。”

The child nods solemnly, aware of the weighty mission he must undertake.
孩子努力地回想着肩负在身的重大使命。

The little standard-bearer stands ready to receive Rayashki's latest guests.
很快，这位新晋的仪仗队员便迎来了第一位客人。

Qiqirn: Boawh ... arrh!
奇肯恩： 呜嗷、嗷——！

Avgust: What this? There are bubbles in the water!
阿夫西维： 咦……？水里出现了泡泡！

The critter pops its head out of the water, two eyes staring out at the boy with bewilderment.
咧开嘴的魔精从水中探出头来，两双懵懂的眼睛毫无准备地交错在一起。

Avgust: We meet again, Qiqirn! Are you planting sunflowers under the water?
阿夫西维： 我们又见面了，奇肯恩！……你在水面上种太阳吗？

Qiqirn: *blows bubbles*
奇肯恩：咕噜咕噜～～～

Avgust: Have you brought your friends?
阿夫西维：你带来了你的朋友们——？

Bubbles swell on the open surface of the water as more Qiqirns break up through the slurry of ice.
水面的泡泡们接连不断地出现，越来越多的奇肯恩破开浮冰，漂浮在水面上。

Though their peculiar appearances differ from one to the next, they all possess large, lamp-like eyes that look out and around with curiosity.
它们的长相古怪不一，睁大如油灯般的明黄瞳孔，好奇地打量着人们的一切。

Avgust: One, two ... Oh, your friends also have six legs!
阿夫西维：一、二……天啊，你的朋友们也有六条腿呢！

Avgust: Look, they are wearing needlegrass and flat files on their legs.
阿夫西维：它们腿上的花纹可真漂亮，像羽茅、锉刀，还有……

Avgust: Are you also here for the ceremony?
阿夫西维：你们是来参加我们的聚会吗？

The child takes pride in his imagined duties.
孩子为自己增长的智慧而骄傲。

Avgust: Welcome, Qiqirn and friends!
阿夫西维：欢迎你们的到来——奇肯恩和朋友们！

Avgust: Welcome to the prettiest town in all of the Arctic—Rayashki!
阿夫西维：很高兴你们能来参观这儿最漂亮的小镇，来亚什基。

Avgust: Please enjoy our song—
阿夫西维：请欣赏合唱曲目——

His cheeks flush as spirited childish voices reverberate in unison out into the sea ahead.
他的脸颊通红，响亮的童声回荡在辽阔的海面上，热烈地传了出去。

Seagulls take flight as a distant stern statue springs to life and rushes over.
海鸥惊叫着飞起，皱眉的先生快步走上前来。

Evgeni: Comrade Avgust, what are you doing?!
叶甫根尼：阿夫西维同志，你在做什么?！

Avgust: Oh? I'm welcoming the Qiqirn.
阿夫西维：嗯？我在欢迎奇肯恩呀～

The child happily salutes the Qiqirns as they step onto the dock.
孩子高兴地向登上码头的奇肯恩们致意。

Evgeni: Get out of there. They are dangerous!
叶甫根尼：离开那儿，它们很危险——！

Evgeni: Defense team, drive them away!
叶甫根尼：保卫队，清除这些捣乱的魔精们！

Vila: Wait! These are Qiqirn. They are not aggressive! They are just curious about us. The kids seem to like them.
维拉：等等——它们是奇肯恩，一种温驯的魔精。它们并无恶意，只是对人类世界感到好奇，孩子们都很喜欢它们……

The defense team moves swiftly and without hesitation.
对方的动作没有丝毫迟疑，甚至没有回头看一眼。

Evgeni: Get rid of them.
叶甫根尼： 消灭它们。

Guard I: As you command, comrade!
保卫队员 I： 是——！

Sprays of bullets and bursts of flame disrupt the water's surface, following the Qiqirns as they dive in, one after another.
弹孔与火光将平静的水面搅得七零八落，奇肯恩们纷纷窜入水中。

Alarms wail in the distance, but the Qiqirns are already long gone.
它们在响起的钟声里潦草地退场，甚至没能目睹随之盛开的礼花。

The children who came to see them are left on the ground, gripping their hats over their ears.
闻讯而来的孩子们也没能为它们送行。

Nina: The Qiqirns are all gone. I think they don't like us anymore.
尼娜： 奇肯恩们逃跑了，它们一定不喜欢我们的小镇了……

Kids: ...
孩子众： ……

Vila: Comrade Evgeni ...
维拉： 叶甫根尼同志……

Evgeni: Take the kids back to where they were, Comrade Vila. It was your duty to protect them.
叶甫根尼： 带领孩子们归队，维拉同志，这是你的责任。

His orders fizzle out as soon as they are said.
毫无情绪的命令被冷漠地掷在了地上。

Pyotr: Maybe if we make the town a better place, more friends will come back.
彼得森： 只要我们能把小镇建设得更好，就能吸引更多的好朋友。

Pyotr: Then they will also come back!
彼得森： 它们也一定会回来！

Pasono: That makes sense!
帕索诺： 没错——！

The researcher observes all this from a nearby vantage. Her notebook rustles with a sigh.
不远处的学者注视着这一切。一阵无人发觉的叹息后，笔记本沙沙作响。

Windsong: The family of Qiqirn includes dozens of subspecies, but none of them are so greatly adapted to water as this. That is to say ...
北方哨歌： 奇肯恩的家族有数十个种类，但无论在哪个区域，任何一个种类的奇肯恩都不曾表现出如此优秀的适水性。也就是说——

Windsong: They might also be affected by the ley energy under Rayashki.
北方哨歌： 它们同样是受来亚什基的地脉能量变动影响而产生的特例。

Windsong: Pity that they were driven away. There was much we could have learned from them.
北方哨歌： 只可惜没法获得更详细的研究数据了……

She looks up. A blanket of clouds obscures the sun, with only a few rays of light breaking through.
她抬起头，一团浓郁的云遮住了太阳，几缕散逸的光艰难地穿过了它。

Windsong: *gasps*
北方哨歌： 嘶——！

Windsong: The temperature here is rising much faster than expected, and much earlier in the season.
北方哨歌： 这儿的温度上升得也太快了，甚至比我的预期还要快上几天。

Windsong: I imagine if you asked the weather bureau, they would say this is just an "odd occurrence of unseasonable weather outside of expected ranges."
北方哨歌：按照历年的官方数据，如此严重的异常升温现象显然是一种超出标准的“无效数据”……

boom
“砰——”

The booming sound of cannon fire interrupts Windsong's train of thought.
轰鸣的礼炮声打断了北方哨歌对遥远海岸线的目送与致意。

Evgeni: It's time. The Zeno investigators should be here any minute.
叶甫根尼：约定的时间到了，芝诺的调查员很快就会抵达这里。

Evgeni: I must stress again how important this ceremony could be for our future.
叶甫根尼：我需要重申，这是一次相当重要的仪式。

Evgeni: Our town's economy is facing a cliff, and I am sure each one of you has noticed the increased rationing.
叶甫根尼：小镇的经济情况并不乐观，我想每一个人都能从我们各项物资的配给中有所发觉。

Evgeni: If we wish to take care of our people in the future and protect our friends and family from these frequent critter attacks, we need Zeno's support.
叶甫根尼：为了照顾好更多的人们，也为了应付周围愈发频繁的魔精袭击，芝诺的支持必不可少。

Evgeni: So we will work with Zeno. Because we must!
叶甫根尼：我们亟需与芝诺建立新的合作关系。

Evgeni: The future of Rayashki is in our hands, so is the future of every comrade here.
叶甫根尼：它关乎着来亚什基的命运，也关乎着我们每一位同胞的未来。

Evgeni: And we need the cooperation of every man and woman here.
叶甫根尼：这需要我们每一个人的共同努力。

His stare falls toward the Rusalka's vibrant tail.
他的目光落在那尾鲜艳的鲁萨尔卡身上。

After a pause, his target replies.
许久，视线里的人影终于开口了。

Vila: Zeno's ships are very fast, so, as soon as they appear on the horizon,
维拉：当芝诺的船帆出现在海平面时——

Vila: our ceremony will begin.
维拉：欢迎仪式正式开始。

Choir Members: Understood.
合唱队员们：明白。

The choir rises in unison, looking out at the pale blue horizon.
人们不约而同地站直了身子，凝望着蓝白色相接的一线。

The sea responds placidly.
遗憾的是，万众瞩目的海平面并没有承载起这份厚重的期待。

Salmon leap out from the water. Seagulls circling along the empty coastline.
红鲑鱼在海面上跃起又落下，鸥鸟盘旋在空无一船的海岸线上……

Yet no sign of the anticipated ship appears.
而绘制着芝诺图案的旗帜却始终没能升起。

The quiet expectations of the adults set the children to whisper.
过于安静的大人们显然引起了孩子们的注意。

Pasono: Zeno is late.
帕索诺：芝诺的先生迟到了。

Pyotr: So late that Ms. Vila would say they were absent!
彼得森：按照学校里的规定，这种行为属于旷课。

Nina: Do you think something bad happened to them?
尼娜：他们遇上了什么不好的事情吗……？

Avgust: What are they doing there?
阿夫西维：他们在做什么呢……？

No answers come, but a new event catches their attention.
值得庆幸的是，更具吸引力的事物很快便落了下来。

Avgust: Oh! Something is falling!
阿夫西维：咦——！有什么落下来了！

Avgust: Light and soft, like a polar bear's hair!
阿夫西维：轻飘飘，软绵绵……好多好多的熊毛！

Dark clouds press down on them, blocking out the final rays of sunlight.
乌云压了过来，遮住了最后一丝阳光。

Avgust: Poor bear, losing all his hair.
阿夫西维：……可怜的北极熊，它的身上一定光秃秃的。

Snowflakes flutter down across the gray sky.
漫天的雪花纷纷扬扬地洒落。

Converging in the blustering wind, they fall towards the town.
它们相互拥抱、汇合，飘落在这座不大的镇子上。

Nina: Mmm?
尼娜：……嗯？

Pasono: It's snow!
帕索诺：下雪了——！

Pyotr: What?! How can there be snow in summer?
彼得森：怎么可能?！……原来来亚什基的夏天，也会下雪吗?

Pasono: Mm? Is this related to the strange thing Avgust said earlier?
帕索诺：咦～这就是阿夫西维说的奇怪的东西吗?

Nina: If so, I'm happy that these aren't stones or a dark cloud's spit.
尼娜：幸好它们不是石头，也不是湿漉漉的口水。

The children huddle near Avgust, astonished by the accuracy of his predictions.
孩子们靠向阿夫西维，围在这位坚定的先行者身旁。

Pasono: Avgust, I can't believe it! You were never right before!
帕索诺：阿夫西维同学，真不可思议，我可没见过你有这么聪明的时候呀～

Nina: *shivers* Oh, oh, it's chilly. The snow is biting against my skin.
尼娜：唔，好冷……这些小雪花可真刺人！

Pyotr: I'm sorry, Avgust. I shouldn't call you a liar.
彼得森：我向你道歉，阿夫西维同学——你没有骗人。

He lowers his head hesitantly.
他扭扭捏捏地低下了头。

Pyotr: But will Rayashki really get into trouble?
彼得森：可是，来亚什基会变得更糟吗……？

A gentle hand nudges Pyotr, a motion learned from someone older and wiser.
一双稚嫩的手拍了拍彼得森的肩膀。

Avgust: Pyotr, we will not be defeated, not by clouds, or bears.
阿夫西维：彼得森，我们不会被乌云打败，也不会输给北极熊。

Avgust: Look!
阿夫西维：你看——！

Avgust: Mr. Tortoise is walking very slowly.
阿夫西维：慢吞吞的乌龟先生还没有来。

Avgust: But no one has left their position.
阿夫西维：但是大家都认真地站在自己的位置上。

Avgust: For Rayashki.
阿夫西维：大家都喜欢来亚什基。

Avgust: You little swans must go back to your lake too! Go as fast as you can!
阿夫西维：天鹅们也要回到湖里，快点儿，再快点——！

Nina: We will!
尼娜：……嗯！

Pyotr: Don't forget your own job, Avgust!
彼得森：别忘了你自己……阿夫西维同学！

The children return to their positions and ready themselves.
孩子们回到了各自的位置，正如最开始的那般。

Windsong: So, this milky white line is this snowstorm.
北方哨歌：好吧……看来这条乳白色的痕迹属于这场暴雪。

Windsong: The average temperature in Rayashki has reached its highest point in the last five years, which, together with the abnormally rich air moisture, has produced an unseasonal and odd kind of snow.
北方哨歌：毫无疑问，来亚什基的平均气温甚至已经越过了近五年的夏季最高点，它们与同样反常的丰富水汽一同协作，造成了这场越下越大的暴雪……

Windsong: The weather forecast was wrong; ley lines were right!
北方哨歌：官方的数据被推翻了，理线学是对的！

Windsong can't hide her excitement.
北方哨歌相当振奋。

She leans up on a wall some distance from the event, her pen flying across page after page of notes.
她倚靠在更远一些的围墙边，运笔如飞，翻过了一页又一页的笔记。

Until she is compelled to snap back to reality.
许久，她终于回过神来。

Windsong: Mm?
北方哨歌：嗯……？

The assembly before her has barely moved.
留在原地的显然不止她一人。

The snow claims more territory by the minute.
暴雪无声地落下，淹没越来越多的地方。

Over sea and land, piling up on the railings, and rising over boots, large and small.
海面，栏杆，以及一双双或大或小的长靴。

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌：——！

A distant foghorn accompanies the sight of a flag piercing up into the horizon. Zeno arrives at last.
遥远的汽笛声裹着芝诺的旗帜终于姗姗来迟。

Evgeni: Everyone, listen!
叶甫根尼：全体人员，准备！

Evgeni: Our ceremony will begin.
叶甫根尼：欢迎仪式正式开始。

Residents: As you command, comrade!
镇民众：是——！

Evgeni: Music, please!
叶甫根尼：……奏乐！

Residents: "Let go of yesterday, let it fade away."
镇民众：“时光呀它缓缓地飘远——”

Residents: "Each step paints a brand-new day."
镇民众：“朋友呀别为那不停留的怀念——”

Residents: "Don't look behind, no shadows will be seen in the daylight."
镇民众：“失去的昨日令我们遗憾——”

Residents: "Under brighter skies, we leave on our journey."
镇民众：“但更美好的仍旧在前方——”

The steamship pulls into their rudimentary harbor, but no further movement follows.
汽船缓缓停靠在这个简陋的港口，再也没有任何动静。

A porthole opens, but no voice comes out, no sound whatsoever beyond the lapping waves.
而终于打开的舷窗边，没有问候，没有声响。

A letter flutters out toward the anxious crowd.
只有一封古怪的信件，轻飘飘地落在了所有人的面前。

???: It's a pleasure to speak to you all, our valued friends in Rayashki.
???：很高兴与你们会面，来亚什基的朋友们。

???: On behalf of Zeno Arms Academy, I am here to announce the details of the "Zeno-Rayashki Cooperation Agreement."
???：我在此谨代表芝诺军备学院，发表对于“芝诺与来亚什基合作条例”的初步通知。

???: As many of you have expected, a squad of armed troops will soon be sent to aid you with the critter problem.
???：如你们所期待的那样，我们带来了一整支精锐的武装小队，我相信，他们一定能为各位解决眼前的魔精麻烦。

???: However, having given it careful consideration, we have decided that the town of Rayashki is no longer viable for our continued support and must be abandoned. We advise that all residents prepare to be transferred to a new post, immediately.
???：但同样，我们很遗憾地宣布——经过反复且慎重的考量，芝诺初步决定，暂时中止对来亚什基的一切支持政策，并建议各位尽早开展在来亚什基的撤离工作。

???: Thank you for your cooperation.
???：希望各位能予以配合。

Vila: What?!
维拉： 什么——?!

8#1
8#1

好日子，坏日子
Good Days, Bad Days FR-06

Meeting Room, Rayashki
来亚什基·会议室

Bertolt: I don't see the point of your reluctance.
贝托尔特： 我不理解你们坚持的理由。

The frowning master of ceremonies straightens the tortoise-patterned letter and then shoves it back into its envelope.
皱着眉头的先生理了理信上的龟形纹样，将那页轻飘飘的纸张塞进了信封的嘴里。

Bertolt: The letter conveyed Zeno's decision clearly.
贝托尔特： 关于芝诺的决定，信上已经写得很清楚了。

Bertolt: I suggest we warm ourselves up with a few drinks before we go. Do you have any Stolich in town?
贝托尔特： 我建议，我们应该找个暖和的酒馆，喝上最后几杯……如果你们这儿有斯托利的话。

Bertolt: Better than sitting here dwelling on the things that cannot be changed.
贝托尔特： 而不是坐在这个冷冰冰的地方，讨论着一些早有答案的问题。

Bertolt: Please tell me you have something like cocoa here.
贝托尔特： ……这儿没准备点可可豆之类的吗?

Their long-awaited guest stretches lazily, as if no one is around, and sinks into the couch.
他旁若无人地伸了个懒腰，陷进了沙发里。

The tension in the air hangs like fumes waiting to ignite.
空气近乎凝固，底下的暗流几乎要翻涌上来。

Vila: This is not what we agreed on earlier, Mr. Bertolt.
维拉： 贝托尔特先生，这和说好的不一样。

Evgeni: Calm yourself, Vila.
叶甫根尼： 冷静点，维拉。

Bertolt: You must be mistaken, my very passionate friend.
贝托尔特： 你似乎误会了什么，这位冷冰冰的女士。

Bertolt: Zeno sent a warning months ago. "The estimated value Rayashki can add to Zeno's program is less than satisfactory. Further support is no longer recommended."
贝托尔特： 芝诺早在数个月前便寄出了通知：“来亚什基的现有价值已不足以支撑芝诺的后续支持……”

Bertolt: "Should any new valuable resources be found in the region, please reply to this letter as soon as possible for further assessment."
贝托尔特： “若该区域发现了尚未报告的、更具价值的资源，请相关负责人尽早回复，并提请芝诺调查员的进一步评估。”

Vila: ...!
维拉： ——!

Bertolt: Then we heard back from Rayashki.
贝托尔特：之后，我们收到了来亚什基方面的回信。

Bertolt: In fact, the sender was you, Evgeni.
贝托尔特：发件人是——叶甫根尼。

Evgeni: Yes, it was.
叶甫根尼：……是的。

Bertolt: And it was you yourself that argued the most compelling point, I have to say. One that has drawn the higher-ups' attention, and the reason why I was sent here.
贝托尔特：不得不承认，你的观点相当有趣，甚至引起了上头的注意……所以，我才被派到了这儿。

Bertolt: I believe you wrote: "I have total faith in the quality of the people of Rayashki. Their solidarity, dedication, and motivation have proven invaluable to us."
贝托尔特：“我认为，来亚什基的人们拥有着卓越的品质。他们团结、敬业、充满干劲，是一批相当优秀的可用之材。”

Bertolt: "I am certain they would carry those same strengths of character and skill to any post, no matter where they were assigned."
贝托尔特：“哪怕在芝诺的其他地方，我也始终确信，他们能够发挥出重要的作用。”

He folds the letter and hands it to Vila, her face blank as a canvas.
他折起信纸，递给一脸茫然的维拉。

Evgeni: Zeno accepted my application.
叶甫根尼：芝诺受理了我的申请。

Evgeni: Of course, I asked around before making my submission, and Zeno seemed to have a good reputation.
叶甫根尼：当然，我私下询问了不少人，他们都对芝诺评价颇高。

Evgeni: It was a golden opportunity to join them.
叶甫根尼：……加入芝诺是一个难得的机会。

Bertolt: It is, but do not get us wrong. Our entrance requirements can be most difficult to meet.
贝托尔特：别误会，我们的考核可一点儿也不轻松，你们机会难得。

Bertolt: Zeno only takes in the best of the best.
贝托尔特：芝诺只需要无数优秀人才中的最优秀的那一丁点儿～

Vila: You want some of us to work for Zeno?!
维拉：让一部分人……搬去芝诺?!

Vila: You never told us anything like that, Evgeni!
维拉：你从没有跟我们提过这些……叶甫根尼！

Evgeni: Be reasonable, Vila. Some of us deserve this opportunity.
叶甫根尼：但从更理性的角度而言，我们应该让一部分人把握住这个投身芝诺的机会。

Vila: What about the others?! We have elders and children. Some of our comrades have been injured and even died in the mine; are we to forget their sacrifices?
维拉：那其他人呢?！——我们的老人、孩子、那些为了挖掘矿石而负伤甚至死亡的同胞……

She tries to suppress the gills on her neck as they heave violently.
她尽力扼制自己的愤怒，脖颈上的细鳃剧烈地起伏。

Bertolt: Relax, my friend. That's why we sent our very best biological control squad.
贝托尔特：放心，我的朋友。这正是我们派出最为精锐的生物问题处理小队的原因。

Bertolt: We will escort you to the nearest shelter.
贝托尔特：我们会协助你们撤离到最近的安全避难区。

Another wave upon relentless waves of shock.
打击一浪接一浪，似乎永无尽头。

Evgeni: Face reality, Vila. I know how much effort we have put into building this town, and I understand you have this dream to fulfill.
叶甫根尼：维拉，你得正视现实。我知道大家都为这儿付出了全部的努力，也理解你的目标——

Evgeni: But we must prepare for the worst: we may have to give up on our Rayashki.
叶甫根尼：可我们必须面对它，做好放弃来亚什基的最坏打算。

He takes out a document covered in scratched notes and annotations and hands it to her.
他拿出了一份满是划痕与批注的文件，递给了对方。

Evgeni: Read this.
叶甫根尼：看看这个吧……

Vila: "Field investigation has confirmed that the remaining runium reserves in Rayashki are around 0.0173 kilotons, which is less than 0.275% of our average annual output."
维拉：“经实地探测确认，来亚什基目前可供开采的卢恩矿约为 0.00173 万吨，已不足往年年均产量的 0.275%。”

Vila: "The mine is located high within the Arctic Circle, which has entailed significant transportation costs. The harsh environment is also wholly unsuitable for building any permanent processing facilities."
维拉：“此外，该区域由于地处北极，矿石运输成本极高，且不适合作为卢恩矿石加工厂的选址。”

Vila: "In addition, military spending on the region has recently been elevated 3.61 times due to increasing animal and critter attacks, and that number is still rising."
维拉：“同时，考虑到当地愈发频繁的野兽与魔精的袭击事件，需配备的武装保护支出已累增至原成本的 3.61 倍，且呈现出递增趋势。”

Vila: "Clearly, the region is now incapable of self-management."
维拉：“显然，该区域已不具备负担区域自理的能力。”

Vila: "According to the Guide on Global Humanitarian Aid by the Office for Disaster Risk Reduction of Zeno Arms Academy, we propose to ..."
维拉：“据芝诺军备学院下辖减灾署《世界人道主义援助指南》规定，初步决议如下——”

Vila: "... send a special squad to the region to evacuate all local citizens and subsequently take care of the remaining biological control issues."
维拉：“安排负责人员前往该地区，协助当地住民的有序撤离；同时，在撤离完成后，接管该区域后续的一切危机清理事务。”

Bertolt: And our admission standards will be lowered—at Zeno's discretion—so that you will all find work with us somewhere.
贝托尔特：此外，芝诺可适当放宽对于该地区的人员遴选标准，以补充芝诺各分部的人员。

Zeno's representative offers a timely, if unconvincing, supplement to the letter.
芝诺的代表人适时地补充了尚未写明的内容。

The paper creases and crumples into a ball in her hands.
纸张在维拉的手上生出一道道褶皱，最后被揉成一团凌乱的纸球。

Evgeni: I'm sorry, but this is reality.
叶甫根尼：很遗憾，这就是现实。

Evgeni: From the start, this ore was the only thing they wanted from us.
叶甫根尼：对于芝诺而言……他们扶持来亚什基的初衷正是为了这些价值高昂的小石头。

Evgeni: The environment here has always been harsh for mining, but we overcame it and sent our shipments to wherever Zeno had need of them.
叶甫根尼：我们克服了恶劣的开采环境，将它们一箱箱地装入矿船，运往芝诺的各个分部。

Bertolt: And I salute each one of you for your work, my friends.
贝托尔特：向你们每一个人致敬，我亲爱的朋友们。

Evgeni: But now, our mission is over.
叶甫根尼：现在，这一使命完成了。

There is no doubt in anyone's mind: runium has been the town's lifeblood and the key to its survival.
毫无疑问，卢恩矿石是小镇的命脉。而失去它之后，来亚什基羸弱得像个孩子。

Evgeni: I believe all of you will continue to work hard in your new positions. No matter what ...
叶甫根尼：我坚信，这儿的所有人会在其他地方继续劳动，继续建设，哪怕……

Vila: You shouldn't rush to a decision. We're discussing Rayashki's future here, Evgeni.
维拉：……叶甫根尼，你对待来亚什基的未来太轻率了。

Vila: For six decades, the people here have put in great efforts to turn the town into what it is today. We won't leave just because you tell us so.
维拉：这个地方凝聚了数代人六十余年的血汗，离开并非是你我的一句话。

Vila: Our grandparents didn't even have construction equipment at the beginning. They built these houses with their own hands.
维拉：最早的时候，祖辈们甚至没有一台正常运行的起重机。他们用无数双手掘起了一块块巨石。

Vila: We shipped over the planting soil. We built walls to keep out the wind and snow.
维拉：汽船们运来了种植蔬菜的土壤，我们砌起了抵挡风雪的围墙。

Within the meeting room's cloistered walls, the air is heavy with moisture once more.
闭塞的会议室里，空气又湿润了几分。

Evgeni: When you came here, you brought books for the children and introduced us to a species different than humans. You became one of us.
叶甫根尼：后来你来到了这儿。你为孩子们带来了许多新课本，也让大家认识了在人类之外，还存在着许多特别的种族……你融入得很快。

Evgeni: I am not happy about this either, Comrade Vila.
叶甫根尼：我很抱歉，维拉同志。

Vila: I won't buy that, Comrade Evgeni. This is not just about my dream, but everyone's dream.
维拉：我不接受你的同情，叶甫根尼同志。这不只是我个人的理想，而是这儿所有人的。

Vila: Or have you forgotten what Rayashki was meant to be?
维拉：难道你忘了来亚什基建立的初衷吗?

Evgeni: A utopia built for and by everyone. The voice of a better future, one which would sound across the land and seas.
叶甫根尼：一个为所有人而建，也欢迎所有人一同建设的理想城市，它会发展，壮大，直到遍布世界的每一寸土地。

Evgeni: I remember every word of it.
叶甫根尼：我一点儿也没忘。

Evgeni's voice is low but still decisive.
叶甫根尼的语气低沉，但仍旧斩钉截铁。

Bertolt: You have my sympathy, friends.
贝托尔特：我很同情你们，朋友。

Bertolt: Zeno has also suffered huge losses in many regions.
贝托尔特：因为某些原因，芝诺在世界各地都遭受了巨大的损失。

Bertolt: We have lost manpower, territory, armament factories, and even some of our affiliated military schools. Rayashki is but one of these losses.
贝托尔特：不只是来亚什基，我们也损失了许多人手，失去了许多战略要地、军工厂，甚至是下辖的军事学院。

Bertolt: We know how you feel right now.
贝托尔特：我们对你们的现状感同身受。

He shrugs his shoulders, his face a picture of unhelpfulness.
他耸了耸肩，无奈挂满了整张脸。

Bertolt: But Zeno has its own problems to be faced.
贝托尔特：但这显然不只是芝诺的问题。

Bertolt: And investing in these new industries, purchasing fancy equipment, all these things Rayashki will need ... All of this takes money. And even Zeno must be economical.
贝托尔特：新工业，让人眼花缭乱的电器，五花八门的新花样——到处都需要资金。哪怕是芝诺，我们也得在某些地方勒紧裤腰带了。

Vila: Shouldn't the people in Rayashki also benefit from these global benefits Zeno has promised?
维拉：那你们口口声声标榜的世界福祉呢?

Bertolt: We will get there, my friend. Maybe slowly, but we will get there. Trust me, Zeno has done everything they can for you.
贝托尔特：当然是放缓了，我的朋友。相信我，芝诺已经为你们竭尽了全力。

Bertolt: We need to keep our eyes on our goals and stay on the right course, so that we won't get lost in these turbulent times, yes?
贝托尔特：哪怕在这个动荡的时代，我们仍然有所坚持，并且不懈地抓牢我们向往的重要之物，对吧?

Vila: ...
维拉：……

He leans toward Vila, providing an unnecessary whisper.
他略微靠近了维拉，压低了声音。

Bertolt: I know how much faith these people have in you, and I believe you can show them a different perspective about these coming changes.
贝托尔特：我明白你在这座小镇的分量，也相信你能安抚好余下的其他人。

Bertolt: Of course, this will also help you during Zeno's assessment.
贝托尔特：当然，这也会为你的考核加上不少分……

Vila: ...
维拉：……

Bertolt: Good luck, my friend.
贝托尔特：祝你们好运，朋友。

8#1
8#1

纸奖章
A Paper Medal FR-07

Hotel, Rayashki
来亚什基·旅馆

Windsong: The reserves of runium running dry, the appearance of new critters, the sudden snowstorm.
北方哨歌：匮乏的卢恩矿石，新的魔精亚种，骤降的暴雪……

Windsong: I've connected the ley lines of each of these phenomena. The map is nearly complete!
北方哨歌：多亏了它们自证身份，这张地脉能量图越来越完整了！

She unfolds the complex blueprint filled with various lines and marks.
她展开了那张种种线条与光点堆叠在一起的繁复图纸。

Windsong: But still haven't traced many lines and marks back to their source.
北方哨歌：可是……这里还有不少没有得到验证的线条与痕迹。

Windsong: Perhaps if I go back to the factories, into the restricted zones ... But, I can't do that alone.
北方哨歌：光靠我自己，想再偷摸着溜进那些工厂、禁区之类的地方一点儿也不现实。

Windsong: Definitely not when the situation in town is so unstable.
北方哨歌：更何况，这座小镇还遭遇了更大的麻烦……

Windsong collapses onto the table. An avalanche follows, covering her in layers of books and manuscripts.
北方哨歌趴倒在桌面，层层叠叠的典籍与稿纸堆把她埋在了最底下。

The piles around her loom like a mountain range, casting her in shadow.
纷繁的故纸堆像是连绵的高山，遮蔽了所有的光线。

Windsong: Well, I should have given this up long ago. There's no chance that the study of ley lines will ever be accepted again.
北方哨歌：好吧，也许我早该放弃了……理线学根本没机会回到大众视野之中去。

Phantom voices of past mockery and scorn rise up to her ears.
过往的讥讽与鄙夷悄无声息地追上了她。

"Reviewer": Regretfully, Ms. Windsong, with nothing but these outdated files and materials to back you up, there's simply no way to justify reinstating the study of ley lines into our curriculum.
“评述者”：我很抱歉，北方哨歌女士。光凭这些不知多少年以前的老旧资料和报告，我们显然不能通过理线学的复课申请。

"Reviewer": We don't have unlimited funds, and we must save our money for projects with greater potential. The study of ley lines is ...
“评述者”：我们的研究经费是有限的，理应拨调到能稳定产出名誉与成果的学科上……至于理线学嘛，呵呵……

"Reviewer": Of course, we might be able to consider new ideas and projects. You can't be allowed to do this on your own.
“评述者”：当然，我们同样鼓励新兴学科的发展，但仅仅依靠你自己是不够的……

"Reviewer": You will need endorsements from the Institution of Geographic Studies, the Arcane Creature Society, or other such organizations.
“评述者”：你得拿出一块有诚意的敲门砖，地理研究学会、神秘动物协会，或是更有分量的背书。

"Reviewer": Let me think. Zeno seems to be interested in geographers recently. They've just recruited a number of researchers for a new commission. Maybe you should go try your luck with them.
“评述者”：噢，让我想想，芝诺似乎最近对地理学者的兴致颇高，他们招徕了一大批编外研究员，我想，你大可以去那儿碰碰运气。

An echo of a nursery rhyme rings out from beyond her self-made mountain range.
窗外传来了叮叮咚咚的声音，像是儿歌的和声。

But she is all but oblivious to it.
但她沉浸在沉重的郁愤中，丝毫没有发觉。

Windsong: The submission date is getting closer each day, but I've made poor progress. Zeno won't endorse me if I can't find a breakthrough.
北方哨歌：芝诺指派的期限越来越近了……可光凭现在的成果，显然没法搞到芝诺的推荐信。

Windsong: They have become more and more radical and desperate lately. First, they sent those researchers here to conduct their haphazard studies, and now, an armed force.
北方哨歌：他们的动作越来越激进了，先是派来了一大堆杂七杂八的编外调查人员，甚至现在还派出了军队……

Windsong: And all this effort just to chase the rumor of some source of "perpetual energy"?
北方哨歌：——就为了一个不知什么年代编造出的“永动能源”传闻?

Windsong: "That this perpetual energy source must be hidden somewhere beneath the permafrost!"
北方哨歌：“永动的能源显然存在于永冻的土壤中!”

Windsong: The higher-ups call the shots. All they need to do is spread a little honey in the right places. Then all the little researchers will swarm on it like flies.
北方哨歌：大人物们动动手指，从指甲缝里抠出点甜头，可怜的小狗学者就得屁颠屁颠地窜来窜去!

Windsong: But could there really be a magical power source like that?
北方哨歌：可世界上真有这样神奇的能源吗?

Windsong: Whether there is or not, I still have a map to finish. There's no way that I can map every ley line in the region all by myself.
北方哨歌：无论如何，独自完成地脉能量图的绘制只是个遥不可及的梦……

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Windsong: Goodbye research funds, goodbye lectures and seminars, and so long to my dreams of being chair of the "Geographical Perspectives" forum.
北方哨歌：永别了，我从未享受过的研究补助、万众期待的学术访谈，还有遥不可及的“地理视野”论坛。

She jostles the heaps of books, moving them just enough to let in some light and sound.
她推开了几本挡在面前的书，光线和一些细微的声响渗了进来。

They seep in through the cracks like starlight.
像是缀入黑夜的点点繁星。

???: Took-took!
???: 当当——!

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌：……!

The door snaps shut. Windsong stands against it nervously.
房门被迅速地关上了，北方哨歌紧张地靠在门上。

Instruments roll off the table, colliding with each other on the windowsill, the corners, and under the bed, falling in a cacophonous disarray.
桌上的仪器滚落一地，在窗台，在桌角，在床底。它们相互碰撞，一同奏起慌乱的乐章。

Windsong: What was that?
北方哨歌：我眼花了吗……?

The door is gently pushed open again, revealing the curious face of a sunflower peeking in through the crack.
房门再一次被轻轻推了开来，一束向日葵从门缝里探出头来。

Avgust: Ms. Windsong, we've been waiting for you!
阿夫西维：北方哨歌，我们在等你～

As far as medals go, the design is a little cruder than expected, and damp paper doesn't quite have the same gravitas as gold or silver.
这是一枚略显简陋的奖章，缺少精美的设计理念，也没有厚重的金属质感。

Still, Windsong has fantasized countless times about receiving such an accolade for her work, even a paper one.
北方哨歌曾为理线学幻想过无数次与之相似的画面。

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌：……!

Nina: Ms. Windsong, we prepared a special medal ceremony for you and Avgust!
尼娜：北方哨歌老师，我们为您和阿夫西维同学准备了授勋典礼!

Pasono: Please come to our ceremony!
帕索诺：我们欢迎您来参加仪式——!

Pyotr: ...
彼得森：……

Pyotr: We just wanted to thank you for teaching us.
彼得森：谢谢您教给我们知识……

Pyotr: Ms. Vila was right. We shouldn't have been so quick to argue. We should have listened!
彼得森：维拉老师说得对，我们不能随意地否定他人。

Nina: So you should be given an award for being right!
尼娜：你们应该受到表扬!

Nina: But our ceremony will not be as big as the ones on TV.
尼娜：不过，它要比电视上的简单多了……

Indeed, this is a very special and exclusive reward.
是的，这是独属于孩子们的颁奖仪式。

Simple as it is, it comes with something nothing else could: the innocence and laughter of children.
无比简陋，同时具备孩子气的童真和滑稽。

Pyotr: Ms. Windsong, will you accept this medal?
彼得森：北方哨歌老师，您愿意接受这枚勋章吗?

For the first time in a long while, the study of ley lines basks in the glow of scholarly acclaim.
这是许久以来的时间里，理线学第一次受到了如此广泛的认可。

The paper medal is cupped in her trembling hands.
纸质勋章被微微发颤的手包裹了起来。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Windsong: I have no cup to put this medal in, so we can't toast with it in celebration.
北方哨歌：哪怕我现在没有能装进这枚勋章的杯子，也没法一口饮尽你们的鼓励。

She sniffles.
某种浓烈而激烈的气味冲撞着她的鼻腔。

Windsong: But now I know, no matter what, I won't be returning empty-handed. Thank you, kids.
北方哨歌：但至少，这趟短暂的旅程不算一无所获……谢谢你们，小家伙。

Nina: Do you mean, are you leaving us?
尼娜：您要离开我们了吗……?

Pasono: But there is so much you still need to teach us!
帕索诺：可我们还什么都没学会呢！

Pyotr: "Rayashki embraces every guest," including you, Ms. Windsong—don't you like it here?
彼得森：“来亚什基永远欢迎每一个人”，当然也包括您——难道您不喜欢我们的小镇吗?

The children are on the verge of tears. She is pulled in helplessly, too.
孩子们泫然欲泣，现在轮到另一个人慌乱了。

Windsong: But those things I heard at the welcome ceremony ... Won't we all be leaving soon?
北方哨歌：可在欢迎仪式上，我听说了那些不好的传闻……

Avgust: No! I don't believe it. That stranger was mean; he wasn't our friend!
阿夫西维：大嘴信是小气鬼，不是好朋友！

Pyotr: Hmph. This is our town; they can't speak for us.
彼得森：哼——这是我们的小镇，他们说了可不算。

Nina: That's right!
尼娜：没错！

Neither doubt nor sorrow will dim their eyes—before her lies only a sea of steadfast faces.
没有怀疑，没有难过，只有无数双坚定的眼睛。

Their words encouraging and powerful despite their youth.
童稚的话语积极而炽热。

They plant some strange seed of hope within her.
消解了她的愕然，又似乎悄悄种下了什么。

Pyotr: Ms. Vila "invited" the man from Zeno to leave his ship. Then they went into Mr. Evgeni's meeting room together.
彼得森：维拉老师“邀请”了那位来自芝诺的先生下船，他们一起去了叶甫根尼先生的会议室。

Nina: Uncle Knut promised me that no one will give up this place.
尼娜：是的……克努特叔叔向我们保证过，没有人会放弃这儿。

Nina: They will go to many meetings and find "a solution that satisfies both sides."
尼娜：他们会继续和芝诺开会，得、得出“一个让大家都满意的方案”——

Avgust: The tortoises move slowly. They need to keep their eyes opened and look for a better answer!
阿夫西维：乌龟们爬得很慢，他们需要瞪大眼睛，仔细观察！

Nina: So will you stay and teach us?
尼娜：……您还能继续为我们上课吗?

Pyotr: I won't cause you any more trouble, I promise!
彼得森：我再也不捣乱了，我保证！

The children burst into laughter.
孩子们哄堂大笑。

Their voices very nearly drown out the rustling noises coming from the windowsill.
甚至盖过了窗台传来的窸窣异响。

Avgust: Mm? Comrade Calculator is speaking!
阿夫西维：咦？尺子同志在说话——！

Curiosity propels the child through the half-open door of the guest room.
孩子好奇地窜进了半掩着门的客房。

Avgust: Hello!
阿夫西维：你好～

"Ley Calibrator": ...
“改线尺”：……

Avgust: Comrade Calculator, are you giving the earthworms directions?
阿夫西维：尺子同志，你在指挥蚯蚓们的方向吗？

The clamor by the window crescendos.
窗边的异响更加嘈杂，同时伴随着玻璃的震动。

Even on tiptoes, the child barely reaches the faintly glowing calibrator.
孩子踮起脚尖，堪堪够着了正散发着微光的改线尺。

Unfortunately, he is not the only one reaching for it.
遗憾的是，有此意图的显然不止他一个人。

???: *roars*
???：吼吼——！

More unfortunate still, scaly claws prove mightier than little fingers.
更不幸的是，生满鳞片的爪子要比稚嫩的手指健硕得多。

"Ley Calibrator": *cracks*
“改线尺”：咔嚓——

The other children notice the tug-of-war and crowd around Windsong, squeezing into the increasingly cramped room.
终于，其他孩子也发现了这儿的纷争，他们拥着北方哨歌一同挤进了这座愈发逼仄的屋子。

Windsong: What's going on here? Ah, my calibrator!
北方哨歌：你们在做什么？——噢，我的改线尺！

???: *chews*
???：嚼嚼！吼 %@#@——！

Windsong: The whale-like backbone, the diamond-shaped teeth, two short legs, with dim eyes, and an extremely sharp nose. That must be a Kikituk!
北方哨歌：鲸鱼骨骼，菱形利齿，双足短粗，双目萎缩，极其尖锐的鼻端……是基基图克[Kikituk]！

Kikituk: *gasps*
基基图克：嘶——！

Windsong: But their closest habitat should be Kong Karls Land, hundreds of kilometers away.
北方哨歌：根据资料记载，它们最近的聚居地应该在离这几百公里的卡尔王地群岛……

Its snout fixates on the new treat in Windsong's grasp.
红棕色的鼻尖直勾勾地对着北方哨歌手上的新食物。

She pulls out the scanner, its gears whining as ley lines flood forth.
她掏出嘎吱作响的扫描仪，赤色的线条疯涌了上来。

Windsong: Their marks on the map appear to be red, sort of reddish brown, and there's a large amount of ley energy accumulated around them. Clearly, they're high on the food chain.
北方哨歌：红棕色的痕迹，它的体内富集了相当丰裕的地脉能量。很显然，这个家伙处于食物链的上位圈……

Windsong: Seems like the "small fish" have attracted more than one "big fish."
北方哨歌：看来这儿的“小鱼”勾来的可不止一条大鱼。

With a swift kick, she sends the grinning critter tumbling.
她一脚把龇牙咧嘴的魔精踹了下去，抵住了窗台。

Windsong: Kids, get behind me!
北方哨歌：小脑袋瓜们，躲到我身后——！

The undeterred Kikituks close in on the narrow ledge.
基基图克们显然并不打算就此作罢，它们围着狭小的窗台打转，试图再次扑跃而上。

Kikituk: *hissing*
基基图克：嘶嘶——！

Avgust: Oh, oh! The Kikituks are giving a performance!
阿夫西维：哇啊！基基图克们在表演节目！

Avgust: Their nose sings, their fur dances, and their belly shakes.
阿夫西维：鼻子歌唱，羽毛跳蹦蹦舞，肚皮跳摇摆舞……

Avgust: Mm?
阿夫西维：咦……？

Avgust: But why aren't their ears doing anything?
阿夫西维：它的耳朵为什么不表演节目呢？

Windsong: Avgust! What are you doing there? Stay back; those are not Qiqirn!
北方哨歌：阿夫西维，你在念叨些什么呢！——躲远点，它们可比奇肯恩凶猛一百倍！

Avgust: But, but ...
阿夫西维：可是，可是……

The meaning of both their messages is lost in the confusion.
他们都有着各自的、对方无法理解的焦急。

Avgust: But, but their ears are left behind. They-they can't join the dance.
阿夫西维：可是它们的耳朵一点儿也不听话，没有加入朋友们的舞蹈……

Avgust: Then they will not get their Alenka!
阿夫西维：这样是没法得到表扬的——！

Windsong: Ears?
北方哨歌：耳朵……？

Windsong, struck by her sudden revelation, fixes on the Kikituk's head.
北方哨歌像是醒悟了什么，她死死盯着基基图克的脑袋。

Beneath its tufts of plush fur lie well-hidden ears of a deeper color.
它们藏在厚实的绒毛里，偶然露出的耳根显露出远甚其他部位的红棕色。

Windsong: Природа это числа и черты.
北方哨歌：Природа это числа и черты.

After a brief incantation, lines converge in a beam that hits precisely on its ear.
短促的咒语后，一束线条迅速而准确地击中了耳根。

Kikituk: *wails*
基基图克：呜……

The creature's cry pierces the air.
可怜虫吃痛地叫了起来。

Windsong: So that seems to be their weak spot.
北方哨歌：看来这确实是它们的弱点……

Windsong: Good job, little one. You're even more perceptive than I thought!
北方哨歌：小家伙，干得不错。你的感知力比我想象得还要敏锐！

Windsong pats Avgust's head.
北方哨歌收起眼底的惊讶，拍了拍阿夫西维的脑袋。

Windsong: Next ...
北方哨歌：接下来嘛——

She reveals a dark and dangerous smile.
她露出一个危险而邪恶的微笑。

Windsong: Hmph.
北方哨歌：哼哼～

The Kikituks finally relinquish their ill-gotten gains, leaping down and away from the windowsill.
基基图克们终于放下了本就不属于它们的战利品，而后跃下窗台，转瞬便消失得无影无踪。

Leaving behind gnawed wet fragments of the ley calibrator.
徒留一地浸润在口涎之中的改线尺碎片。

Windsong: S**t! This was one of the last working instruments I had.
北方哨歌：&%#！*【德涅斯特河东岸粗口】……这可是我为数不多的资产了。

A sunflower gently pats against Windsong's shoulder.
一束向日葵轻轻地拍了拍北方哨歌的肩膀。

Avgust: Don't be sad, Ms. Windsong.
阿夫西维：别难过，北方哨歌。

Avgust: If we plant them in the soil, many more will come out when spring comes.
阿夫西维：我们可以把它们种在土壤里。明年，它们就会长出许多朋友。

Windsong: Heh. Thank you, Avgust.
北方哨歌：……谢谢你的安慰，阿夫西维。

Pyotr: Ms. Windsong, can I be a ley hunter too?
彼得森：北方哨歌老师，我也能成为一名理线师吗?

Nina: If we were as good as you are, maybe we could've protected your machine.
尼娜：如果我们也像您一样厉害，就能保护好您的尺子了……

Pyotr: And maybe we could protect our town.
彼得森：也一定能保护好我们的小镇。

Windsong turns her head, meeting many pairs of expectant eyes.
北方哨歌转过头来，对上了无数双充满活力的眼睛。

Windsong: Kids, ley hunting isn't a good profession.
北方哨歌：小脑袋瓜们，理线师可不是什么值得骄傲的职业。

Windsong: If you become a ley hunter, you will have to deal with doubt from all your peers, even hatred, and homework that piles up to your roof.
北方哨歌： 走上这条路，你们就得应付无数的质疑、鄙弃，还有堆成山的作业。

Nina: Ms. Windsong, people in Rayashki are taught not to doubt or hate others. They would never hate you, or us!
尼娜： 您说得不对，北方哨歌老师——来亚什基的大家都很团结。

Pyotr: Exactly!
彼得森： 没错！

The children of Rayashki are in some ways so strange to her.
面前的孩子们熟悉而陌生。

Their courage and solidarity overcome her long-standing hesitation.
某些无言的、由来已久的退缩悄然消失了。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Her curiosity at them, at all of this, becomes a palpable force.
一种更强烈的好奇感笼罩了她，像是一股无形的、难以抗拒的推力。

One pulling her ever closer to Rayashki.
将她推向更具体的来亚什基。

8#1
8#1

工厂颂
The Ode of Factory FR-08

Children's Square, Rayashki
来亚什基·儿童广场

Nina: I'm happy that you let us show you around, Ms. Windsong.
尼娜： 很高兴您愿意参观我们的小镇，北方哨歌老师。

Nina: We haven't had many other visitors here since the critters started coming near the town.
尼娜： 自从小镇的外面成了魔精的游乐场，到这儿来的客人们就越来越少啦～

Avgust: I met a blind lady once. She always smiles, and she has a pretty typewriter. Vila said she's a "writer."
阿夫西维： 我见过微笑的盲眼女士，她有一台很漂亮的打字机……维拉说，她是“作家”。

Avgust: The writer has been to many towns, and she fills up her papers with so much ink, just like I do! So, I made a drawing for her, too.
阿夫西维： 作家去很多小镇，把白纸涂得满满当当，像我一样。所以，我把画儿送给了她……

Nina: And she promised us that she will tell more people to come visit Rayashki!
尼娜： 她答应我们，会让更多人了解来亚什基！

Pyotr: Will people from other places like it here?
彼得森： 其他地方的人们……会喜欢我们的小镇吗?

Images bounce around in Avgust's mind, just out of grasp.
阿夫西维努力地掰着手指头，但那些脑子里的模糊影像蹦蹦跳跳的，连半点也抓不住。

Windsong: What about your other visitors?
北方哨歌： 别的游客们呢……?

Avgust: I remember they had green and red rectangular paper and some shiny cookies in their hands.
阿夫西维： 他们手上拿着很多绿色和红色的方格纸，还有闪亮的小松饼。

Pyotr: They tried to trade us their silly paper so they could take our cans and things. They never wanted to work with their own hands.
彼得森： 那些人想要用古怪的东西换走我们的罐头和礼物，但不愿意和我们一起劳动。

Pyotr: And Rayashki doesn't like lazybones!
彼得森： ——我们才不欢迎这些客人呢！

On this, the children's heads bob in agreement.
在这一点上，孩子们的脑袋起伏得相当一致。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Nina: Ms. Windsong, Pyotr got all of us together last night, and we read through our "how to be a good tour guide" guide. So we can guide you!
尼娜： 北方哨歌老师，彼得森同学昨晚带领大家一起复习了“如何成为一个好导游”——我们会做好的～

Pyotr: Ms. Windsong is just a bit strange. She's not lazy!
彼得森： 北方哨歌老师只是有点儿奇怪，她可不是懒虫！

The child hides his face, but the blush on his cheeks reaches up to his ears.
别扭的孩子转过头去，一丝涨起的红晕漫过了他的耳背。

Avgust: This time, I want borscht, blinchik, and oladyi!
阿夫西维： 红甜菜汤、布林饼，还有——欧拉季益！

Pasono: Ahem, let's not hurry on to our rewards, Avgust. We haven't helped Ms. Windsong yet.
帕索诺： 咳咳，阿夫西维同学，别急着许愿奖励……我们还没帮上北方哨歌老师的忙呢～

Avgust: Oh, right.
阿夫西维： 噢……好吧。

Figures, large and small, pass deftly through the once tightly-sealed iron door,
大大小小的身影灵巧地穿过一张张紧闭的铁门。

arriving at the only factory left, whose lock has not yet rusted over.
终于抵达了唯一一间门锁尚未锈蚀的工厂。

Factory, Rayashki
来亚什基·生产工厂

Knut: Good to see you at our little factory, Ms. Windsong!
克努特： 欢迎到我们的工厂来，北方哨歌姑娘——！

Windsong: Hello, sir.
北方哨歌： 你好，先生。

Knut: The kids have told me that you want to learn more about the history of Rayashki and the strange things that have happened in the past, yes?
克努特： 我都听孩子们说了，你希望了解来亚什基的历史，还有过去发生的怪事儿，是吗?

Windsong: I do. But would that be going against any rules?
北方哨歌： 是的……但这不违规吗?

Knut: Most certainly not, miss. We're not some stubborn old goats that dismiss people for asking questions.
克努特： 当然不，好姑娘，我们可不是什么吹胡子瞪眼、在家里划拉出一大片禁地的老古董。

He strides forward.
他大步走上前来。

Knut: In fact, I'm relieved—it will be much easier to talk to you than that bitter fellow from Zeno.
克努特：谢天谢地——你比那位刻薄的芝诺先生看起来要友善多了。

Knut: He came to the factory with his armed squad, took a quick look around, and left even without a polite farewell.
克努特：那位来自芝诺的先生和他的武装小队匆匆地巡视了咱们的工厂，只一会儿就消失了。

Knut: Like a whiff of cold breeze, that one.
克努特：——就像一阵让人直打哆嗦的西伯利亚冷风。

Knut: These old, out-dated machines and hundreds of workers, young and old, each one a mouth to be fed.
克努特：废旧的老式机器、几百个年龄参差不齐的工人们……

Knut: They are certainly not a pretty sight to the eyes of that greedy hyena. Hmph!
克努特：只能闻见腥味的鬣狗当然看不上我们的宝贝，嘁！

Windsong: A pathetic number-crunching cretin.
北方哨歌：功利主义的脑袋……

The whispered insult creeps up to her listener's ear.
小声的“诽谤”清晰地落在了对方的耳朵里。

Knut: Hahahaha! I'm starting to like you, miss! We would have much to talk about, perhaps over a drink, if only I didn't have to get on with my work!
克努特：哈哈～我越来越欣赏你了，好姑娘！如果不是忙着生产，我们必须得喝几壶——！

A curious look around goes beyond the hard-laboring workers.
好奇的目光显然不止落在这儿的工人身上。

Tightly sealed doors and a thick layer of dust on aging machinery paint a less than optimistic picture.
两侧紧闭的大门，周遭飘忽的灰尘，情况似乎远没有想象中乐观。

Knut: You can see what's going on here, right?
克努特：你注意到了，对吧～

Knut: Don't feel sorry for us. Zeno might no longer need this ore processing factory, but we can make use of what's left of it.
克努特：没什么好难过的……哪怕芝诺不再需要矿石加工厂了，咱们也能把它改造成别的厂子。

Knut: Once we get rid of the critters, we can arrange for other minerals or materials to be shipped to Rayashki for processing!
克努特：别慌神，只要度过这段被魔精们围困的日子，后续的原料和矿材都能源源不断地运进来！

He rubs his hands together, leaning against the shell of a rusted machine.
他搓了搓手，靠在某个生锈机器的外壳上。

Knut: It is a shame we've wasted so much of our good years, never preparing for these bad times.
克努特：就是可惜了这些个好时候，多少宝贵的时间都被白白地浪费了！

Knut: If those strange little monsters weren't there, we might be able to return to our mines. Ah, then, we'd really be able to turn things around.
克努特：要不是那些猖狂的小怪物，我们至少能到矿场去——那儿才是我们的天堂！

Windsong: About these mining sites ...
北方哨歌：矿场……?

Her notebook flutters rapidly, its pages turning as fast as a rolling flame.
她手上的笔记本在不同的页码上迅速地翻了几个身，像是飞溅的火星。

Windsong: Mr. Knut, have you ever found anything there? Other than runium ore?
北方哨歌：克努特先生，你在矿场里有挖出过什么新东西吗？——尤其是卢恩矿石以外的东西！

Knut: Hmm.
克努特：唔……

Knut: Never! I know those sites like the back of my own hand. I've never seen any other minerals of any worth there.
克努特：我向你保证，绝对没有！哪怕是矿场里的一颗砂砾我都能认得出来……至于新矿石嘛，从来没见过。

The rugged man seems to catch her disappointment, and far quicker than she'd expect.
心思远比外表看起来细腻的大叔显然发现了对方眼底的失落。

Knut: But give it some time, miss. Well, give me some time.
克努特：别心急，姑娘……让我再想想！

Knut: Just a few months ago, back when Zeno was still keen to work with us and not just ship us away, I remember they found some strange little pebbles.
克努特：早在几个月前，芝诺还在热心地跟咱们打交道的时候——他们在矿区倒是发现了些我们从没见过的小石头。

Knut: Dark pebbles that were stuck in the claws of those little monsters.
克努特：那些黑乎乎的小石子儿嵌在张牙舞爪的小怪物们的指甲缝里。

Knut: Zeno soon sent out some troops and caught all the monsters. They didn't leave a single one behind.
克努特：很快，芝诺派来了军队，把它们抓了个干净，连点渣滓都没留给我们……

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌：——！

Knut: We never heard about those pebbles again, nor have we found more of them in the mines.
克努特：后来，芝诺就再也没提过这茬了，我们也再也没有见过那些黑乎乎的小石头了。

Knut: And you know the rest. Now we've exhausted the runium, and more and more strange-looking critters have appeared. So it's not safe to go back there. We left them completely deserted.
克努特：再后来嘛，卢恩矿石被我们开采得一滴不剩，越来越多怪模怪样的魔精霸占了矿区。我们就再也没去过那儿了。那儿也基本废弃了。

Windsong: Please take a look at this, Mr. Knut.
北方哨歌：……请你看看这个，克努特先生。

Windsong sketches fervently as Knut lumbers towards her with a curious eye.
北方哨歌唰唰地画了起来，对方热情地凑了上来。

Knut: No, no, their claws were thicker than a polar bear's.
克努特：不不，它们的爪子比北极熊还粗好几个指节……

Knut: Ah! But these are closer!
克努特：噢！——和它们长得很像！

Knut: These monsters had much larger teeth. They almost looked like old mining picks.
克努特：但是牙齿要比这更大一些，像是把用了好多年的称手矿锄。

Knut: And no ears!
克努特：没有耳朵——！

Windsong: Could they be some kind of Hoituk?
北方哨歌：……难道是霍伊图克?!

Knut: Yes! This one looks just like the creatures!
克努特：没错，就是这样！

Windsong: If that's true, then it may be another "big fish" that has come here to feed.
北方哨歌：好吧……又一条赶来吃“小鱼”的大鱼。

Knut: It is true! You can ask around. Many of the other workers have seen it.
克努特：我可不会骗你，小姑娘……很多工人都见过它。

Windsong: So, the color of a Hoituk is bright yellow, and that matches with these bright yellow lines I've traced here on the map.
北方哨歌：很好，霍伊图克的性状是明黄质，难怪之前这张理线图上的明黄色线索始终找不着主人……

Windsong: They are burrowing animals, often living as deep as 50 meters underground. So if they were here, that must mean ...
北方哨歌：它们生性喜爱挖掘，常常出没于 0—50 米之间的地下。既然它们出现在这儿，就说明——

Windsong: That there must be some undiscovered resource here.
北方哨歌：这儿一定有尚未被发现的新资源。

The corners of her mouth curl as she mutters the words.
北方哨歌小声地嘀咕着，但她愈发明朗的脸色显然瞒不过任何人。

Knut: Talk of undiscovered resources would be music to our ears, miss.
克努特：看来结果不错，好姑娘。

Windsong: Ahem. I don't want to get your hopes up. It's still too early to draw any conclusions.
北方哨歌：咳——现在还不能下定论……

Knut: Hahaha! Yet, the corner of your mouth is suggesting the opposite!
克努特：哈哈，可你的眉毛都快翘到天上去啦～

Windsong: I must be cautious before confirming there really is a new resource!
北方哨歌：在真正的结论出来以前，我必须得再谨慎一点！

Windsong: Nonetheless, it's a silver lining. Thank you, Mr. Knut.
北方哨歌：但无论如何，这都是一道新的曙光……谢谢你，克努特先生。

Knut: Think nothing of it, miss! Maybe one day, you and your research will return the favor.
克努特：没什么好谢的，姑娘——说不准到什么时候，你的研究也能帮上咱们的忙呢～

Windsong: I will, if I can.
北方哨歌：但愿会有这么一天。

She reaches out a hand, and he shakes it heartily with warm strength.
她伸出手去，对方以更热情的姿态迎了上来。

Windsong: I hope your work here can be resumed shortly.
北方哨歌：也祝你们的工厂能早日复工。

Knut: Don't worry about us! We will find a way to drive those critters away and start production once again.
克努特：哈哈～就算没有芝诺，大家也能靠着自己赶走魔精，把工厂重新开起来。

Knut: We have all our brothers and sisters with us, and these machines still run perfectly.
克努特：咱们的工人们都在这，那些钢铁家伙们也在。

Knut: As long as we continue to put in our best effort, there is no reason why things won't get better.
克努特：再说了，我们总在劳动，总在生活，一切都会好起来的。

He pats the trembling, coughing machines with affection, like embracing an old friend.
他拍了拍周围仍在发颤的巨大机械们，像是在与老友勾肩搭背。

Windsong: Is this exceptionally positive spirit common with the people here?
北方哨歌：……这儿的人们都像你这么乐观吗?

Knut: Well, can't blame us for that! There are very few places in the world like Rayashki.
克努特：当然，毕竟全世界也找不着几个来亚什基这样的地方了——

Knut: Here, everyone earns their food and their rest through working hard together. Then, outside of work—ice hockey, learning courses, even music lessons—not everyone is as lucky as us.
克努特：每一个人都能靠着自己的双手劳动，享受食物、疗养假期……我们有数不过来的冰球比赛、成人教育，甚至还有乐器培训……

Knut: That is why we won't let Rayashki die.
克努特：我们可不想让来亚什基荒废下去。

Knut's voice rises as if singing.
克努特的声音越来越高昂，像一首快活的乐曲。

Knut: With busy hands and open hearts, Rayashki will live on.
克努特：咱们手上的功夫、脑袋里的东西，谁都没法抢走它们。

Knut: It will grow stronger, glowing as brightly as these furnaces!
克努特：就像这儿到处都有的熔炼炉一样～

Something brilliant indeed burns within those furnaces.
某种炙热的事物在里面熊熊燃烧着。

A product greater than any ore or slag, emerging from the melding of purpose and sweat.
崭新的造物在许多件工装与汗滴的交融中悄然诞生。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

The pen that stopped stirs once again.
停下的笔又一次动了起来。

But this time, she seems to be sketching out something far harder to picture.
但这次，她似乎想抓住某种更缥缈的东西。

Windsong: I have to say, Rayashki is truly a curious place.
北方哨歌：……我承认，来亚什基是个相当特别的地方。

Windsong mutters to herself.
北方哨歌喃喃自语。

Windsong: It has a spirit which I've never found elsewhere.
北方哨歌：它拥有任何地方都没有的某种特别的东西。

Windsong: Yes. Perhaps that's what was missing from the study of ley lines in the past.
北方哨歌：是的，这正是过去的理线学始终不曾具备的……

gurgle
“咕噜——”

An odd sound interrupts her contemplation.
某种古怪的声响打断了她的思考。

The sunflower pats against the boy's belly.
向日葵悄悄地盖住了肚皮。

Avgust: Ms. Windsong, would you like to meet Mr. Patrik?
阿夫西维：北方哨歌，你想认识帕特里基先生吗?

The friendly bear Knut nods with an understanding smile.
克努特会意地点头。

Knut: It's time to go to the canteen, boys and girls. Eat well, and you'll grow strong!
克努特：你们确实该去食堂了，好姑娘们、小伙子们……你们现在正是长身体的时候呢!

Knut: Patrik knows how to feed you well. He's the best cook in town.
克努特：帕特里基可是个热情的老伙计，镇上最好的厨师。

Knut: But I would suggest you be careful with that one, if you don't want to get stuck with his endless chatter all night.
克努特：不过嘛，你最好躲着他点。
如果你不想被他拉着胡侃上一整晚的话……

Windsong: I have never been to the canteen. I stayed out of that area in my previous "visits" to avoid unwanted trouble.
北方哨歌：咳，碍于之前毫无必要的担忧，我确实不曾涉足过食堂，那一块儿的数据至今还是空白的。

Avgust: Heh-heh! Forward, to Comrade Blinchik!
阿夫西维：嘿嘿～向布林同志出发!

Knut: All the best, miss! I look forward to hearing good news from you.
克努特：祝健康，好姑娘——期待看到你的成果。

Knut waves them off before settling back into his world of metal.
克努特挥了挥手，又坐进了他最熟悉的铁皮壳里。

The churning and wheezing of machinery replacing words.
人影远去，机器声重新充盈了这里。

The canteen buzzes with the din of workers.
热闹的职工食堂里人头攒动。

The children weave through the busy hall, leading Windsong by the hand.
孩子们领着北方哨歌，穿梭在排列整齐的餐桌和椅子间。

Canteen, Rayashki
来亚什基·劳动食堂

Avgust: This is our canteen.
阿夫西维：这里是大家的食堂。

Avgust: We play hide-and-seek here when we're hungry.
阿夫西维：肚子饿的时候，我们就会来这里玩捉迷藏。

Avgust: Comrades Stew and Potato Piroshki are always the easiest to find!
阿夫西维：炖汤同志、土豆馅饼同志每次都是最先被找到的!

Avgust: They are not very clever at hiding!
阿夫西维：它们一点儿也不聪明。

Avgust: But Comrade Blinchik is very good at the game. He can only be found at dinners on Friday.
阿夫西维：但是布林饼同志擅长捉迷藏，它只会在每周五的晚餐才会被找到。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Nina: We have good food, like mashed potatoes, and boiled potatoes, and potato stew!
尼娜：我们有很多好吃的……土豆泥，煮土豆，还有土豆炖汤!

Nina: Mr. Patrik said a good cook can turn even simple ingredients into delicious food!
尼娜：帕特里基先生说，真正的好厨师，能够把最简单的食物做成大家都爱吃的美味！

Nina casts a glance around her before she speaks softly.
尼娜望了望周围，小声地说了下去。

Nina: The grown-ups are so kind to us. Sometimes they give us their cheese and salad, so they only have potatoes to eat.
尼娜：大人们很善良，他们吃掉土豆，把奶酪和沙拉留给我们……

Pyotr: Don't cry, Nina. Remember when you shared your Alenka with everyone?
彼得森：别难过，尼娜同学，你不也总是把阿廖卡分给大家吗?

Pyotr: When we grow up, it'll be our turn to help the grown-ups with their potatoes!
彼得森：等长大了，我们也能吃掉更多的土豆！

There is an awareness in them, a gravity few children possess at their age.
气氛似乎凝重了起来。

Thankfully, some do retain their blissful innocence.
好在有人浑然不觉。

Avgust: We also have the tin-hat festival, when they gave us metal hats with food in them!
阿夫西维：我们还有铁帽子节，帽子里藏着很多好吃的！

Windsong: ...?
北方哨歌：……?

Pyotr: Avgust, it's called the Worker's Festival.
彼得森：阿夫西维同学，它的名字叫“工人节”。

Pyotr: We have it every month. Everyone must sit in a circle in the canteen and sing songs, and Ms. Vila plays the accordion for us.
彼得森：小镇每个月都会举办工人节。所有人围坐在食堂一起唱歌，维拉老师会为我们拉手风琴……

Pyotr: We each get a can with food in it. Sometimes it's tushonka, sometimes it's salad, sometimes sprats.
彼得森：每个人能得到一份罐头，图桑卡罐头、沙拉罐头，或者鲱鱼罐头。

Avgust: Yes, and after the tin-hat festival, we would bury our tin-hats in the ground. Yellow ones, red ones, and white ones. Then tiny trees will come out from them next year!
阿夫西维：是的，过完铁帽子节之后，大家把帽子埋在土里，黄的、红的、白的……帽子会冒出小苗，长出叶子！

Pyotr: I have told you many times! They are not tin seeds, and they don't grow into trees! They are just tin cans! We only bury them so they won't pollute the snow.
彼得森：我早就说过了！它们不是铁皮土豆，它们也不会长大！它们只是普通的罐头！……堆在一起是、是为了更方便地处理它们，防止雪地被污染。

The subject of their debate flips a hidden switch in Windsong's mind. The revelation flicking into light.
孩子们的争论冲击着北方哨歌的脑袋，令她头昏脑涨。

Windsong: Piles of tin cans ... Food ...
北方哨歌：堆积的铁皮……食物香气……

She unfolds the ley energy map, pointing to the last blurred area of interwoven lines and traces.
她猛然展开了地脉能量图，指向了最后一片各色线条与痕迹交织的模糊区域。

Windsong: Those empty cans you mentioned—did you store them here?
北方哨歌：那些罐头，它们最后都去了这儿吗——?!

Pasono: Oh, I know this place. That's where the adults dug a big hole; they put some things inside. It's covered up with rocks and ice now.
帕索诺：噢，我记得那个地方……大人们挖了一个很大的坑，不过现在，它肯定被冰块和石头填满啦～

Nina: Yes, Pasono is right! That's where the grown-ups put all our old metal after they make them into little cubes!
尼娜：是的，就是那儿！每个月，大家都会把废弃的钢铁重新熔成一个个方块。

Nina: Ms. Vila said it helps keep our town and the whole region clean.
尼娜：维拉老师说，这样能让我们的小镇和周围的土壤更加整洁。

Nina: Why, what's wrong with that place?
尼娜：那儿有什么奇怪的吗……？

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌：……！

Windsong: I'm thrilled! There must be lots of "big fish" left to be found around there!
北方哨歌：好极了，那儿一定有不少尚未被发现的“大鱼”！

Windsong: If I can write a report and provide a practical plan, maybe I can get Ze- ... I mean, I could request reinforcements!
北方哨歌：只要将这个推论形成一份具备可行性的报告，说不定能说服芝……咳，说服他们加派人手！

She halts, swallowing back the unfriendly name.
她及时地刹住了车，把那个算不上友好的名字咽回了肚子。

Kids: Yay! School trip! School trip!
孩子众：太好啦！我们又能去外面玩了！

Windsong: This is no trip, children! I'm not going there for a hike! You must stay in town and be good. That goes for every one of you! Understood?
北方哨歌：当然不行！这可不是什么益智游戏——你们都得给我乖乖地留在镇上，所有人，明白了吗！

Her resolution fails before she even finishes.
显然，这一决议难以服众。

The children's protests rise in a disordered chorus, drowning out all other surrounding sounds.
抗议声此起彼伏，盖过了周围的一切声响。

Only to be matched by the static fizz of an announcement.
也包括头顶正滋滋作响的电流声。

Bertolt: Ahem!
贝托尔特：咳咳——！

Windsong clutches at a thin straw of salvation.
北方哨歌终于抓住了难得的救命稻草。

Windsong: Shh. Quiet, kids!
北方哨歌：嘘～安静，小脑袋瓜们！

Bertolt: Attention please. Tomorrow, at 8 in the morning, we will be holding our final hearing.
贝托尔特：亲爱的朋友们，我们将在明天 8：00 开始举行最后一次听证会。

Bertolt: In this meeting, we hope to finalize our next steps and answer any remaining questions. We look forward to seeing you there.
贝托尔特：本次会议旨在厘清各位对于小镇处理方案的建议与疑虑，欢迎朋友们按需参加。

8#1
8#1

比知识更重
Heavier Than Knowledge FR-09

Meeting Room, Rayashki
来亚什基·会议室

Bertolt leans back in his armchair, casting a fleeting glance forward before his head falls.
贝托尔特懒洋洋地靠在沙发椅上，只瞥了一眼来人，便迅速地低下了头。

Bertolt: What's this? Are you planning on getting a job with Zeno, too?
贝托尔特：怎么——你也打算在芝诺谋个一官半职?

Windsong: ...?
北方哨歌：……?

Bertolt: It says here you've been staying in this town for months, but it seems you're not on our list for "Potential Recruitment from Rayashki."
贝托尔特：尽管你在这儿呆了几个月的时间，但很遗憾，你并不在这次的“来亚什基人员特聘计划”的名单上。

The smile on his face remains as affably saccharine as ever.
他脸上的笑容仍然维持着既有的温和。

Bertolt: I should remind you, for you researchers, what you produce tells much more about you than your "efforts."
贝托尔特：我得提醒你，对于你们这样的学者来说，拿出成果才是最重要的。

Windsong: That's precisely why I'm here.
北方哨歌：这正是我来找你的原因。

Bertolt: Go on.
贝托尔特：噢——?

He finally deigns to raise his head up.
对方终于又舍得抬起那颗矜贵的头颅来。

Windsong: Based on the recent investigations, I'm confident that there is a new energy source in the area that has yet to be discovered.
北方哨歌：根据我这段时间的调查，我几乎能够确信，这儿确实存在着某种尚未被开采出的新资源。

Bertolt: ...
贝托尔特：……

Bertolt: And that's it? We already believed there was something here when we sent you out in the first place!
贝托尔特：这就是你花了几个月的时间才调查清楚的事？我们早就告诉过你们每一个人，接受委派的小学者，来亚什基一定有我们要找的东西。

Bertolt: You were sent here to find it. Instead, all you do is confirm what we already knew.
贝托尔特：你的任务是找到它，而不是向我确认这个早有答案的事实。

Windsong: But you said that "perpetual energy" was just a myth, didn't you?
北方哨歌：可你说的什么“永动能源”只是传说，不是么?

Bertolt: O-of course, it wasn't "just a myth," lady. Why else would we ask you to investigate here in the first place?
贝托尔特：这当然不只是传说，女士。要不然我们怎么会派你们过来呢……?

Windsong gives a frown that slips, quite intentionally, into a scowl.
北方哨歌皱了皱眉头，那张失望的臭脸毫不掩饰地在她眼前晃来晃去。

Bertolt: Do you have anything else to report?
贝托尔特：除此之外，你还有什么需要报告的吗?

Windsong: No, but I do need your help. I will need an armed squad to come with me to the mining sites so that I can continue my investigations into this subject.
北方哨歌：……我想申请芝诺的协助调查。你派遣一支武装军队将我送往矿区深处，我会在那里进行下一阶段的研究。

Windsong: I'm afraid I don't know how long it will take. It also depends on the number of soldiers you can spare for the task.
北方哨歌：时间上我无法保证，这得视你们派遣的人员数量而定……

Bertolt: Aha!
贝托尔特：咳、咳咳——

Bertolt: You have a terrible sense of humor.
贝托尔特：我猜，你开了一个一点儿也不好笑的玩笑。

Windsong: I'm not being funny. You want more research on the new resource too, don't you?
北方哨歌：我很认真。况且，这不也关乎着你们的目标吗!

Bertolt: Ms. Windsong, do you really think this is even a remotely reasonable request?
贝托尔特：可是，学者女士，你知道这意味着什么吗——?

Bertolt: Critters are running rampant in the area, and you demand help to verify what is, as far as I can see, a highly questionable conclusion. Why should I waste Zeno's time and resources on this?
贝托尔特：这儿的魔精早已泛滥成灾，为了你的一个虚无缥缈的理论，我们就得耗费巨大的人力与物力——

Bertolt: Not to mention putting the lives of our soldiers at risk.
贝托尔特：甚至搭上辛苦培养的芝诺精锐?

Windsong: If you have doubts, please take a look at these files.
北方哨歌：如果你还有疑惑，可以看看我目前整理出的这些……

The researcher dives her hands into her bag but is met with a wave of dismissal.
学者急迫地翻找着自己的背包，对方毫不客气地摆了摆手。

Bertolt: And let me guess, you learned all this from your "study of ley lines"?
贝托尔特：让我想想，是你的“理线学”告诉你的吗?

Windsong: I ...
北方哨歌：……

Bertolt: To date, the theory of ley lines has neither been approved by the "Arcane Study Review Association," nor accepted by the "Project Assessment of Human Science and Technology." It has zero academic achievements, zero endorsements, and aside from the questionable example in front of me—zero researchers.
贝托尔特：据我所知，这应该只是一门在“神秘学会考评会”和“人类科研课题立项”中几度没能通过的民间学派，没有成果，缺乏官方背书，甚至连研究员都没几个……

Windsong: That's all only a temporary setback.
北方哨歌：……这只是暂时的。

Bertolt: Ms. Windsong, I sympathize with the awkward situation I have put you in. However, Zeno simply cannot afford to waste resources on a proposal without any solid evidence.
贝托尔特：我同情你的遭遇，但很遗憾，在你拿出切实可行的证据之前，芝诺没法向一位编外的草根学者提供过多的帮助。

Windsong: I will give you something; all I need is a bit of help upfront. I promise!
北方哨歌：我会给你们成果的，只要你们先预支一点儿帮助。我保证！

The look in his eyes is glazed, bored, but Windsong does not falter.
眼前的人没有丝毫动摇，但北方哨歌同样不愿放弃。

Windsong: Did you not come here to deal with these critters? Then what's the fuss about? Can't you deal with them while accompanying me to these mining sites as well?
北方哨歌：协助小镇解决魔精问题，不也正是芝诺向这儿的人们提供的援助方案么？……这不过是举手之劳罢了！

Bertolt's eyes widen, now unglazed, as he rises.
贝托尔特瞪大了眼睛，像是听到了些什么了不得的消息。

He paces silently, drifting at first, then proceeding to the windowsill.
他在房间里来回踱步。许久，他终于挪到了窗台。

Bertolt: I'm afraid you've got our intentions altogether wrong.
贝托尔特：噢，天真的女士，你一定是误会了什么。

The windows close tightly, sealing the last whispers of wind from the outside.
窗户合拢起来，连风声也透不进来了。

Bertolt: Zeno is here for one thing only: a source of perpetual energy.
贝托尔特：芝诺的目标从来都只有一个，就是传说中的永动能源。

Bertolt: This is what you have been tasked to find, with the resources you were given. We won't approve any further requests until you have a solid lead. We aren't paying you for a charity mission.
贝托尔特：这也是你的任务，找出它，而不是在毫无成果的时候向我提要求，我们可不是什么落魄学者的慈善资助机构。

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌：……！

Windsong: So, then, you never planned on controlling the critters here. The squad you brought here was to control the town?!
北方哨歌：所以你们从来都不打算清理这儿的魔精灾害，也只堪堪派出了这么一支行动小队……就为了无声无息地彻底掌控这里?!

Bertolt: A force sufficient to deal with critters would have attracted unwanted attention from our rivals. It is not in our interests to share this town or its resources. I'm sure you can see that.
贝托尔特：我们不希望引起其他组织的注意，显然，这也不是什么适合与他人分享的成果，不是么?

Windsong: So, even if we do find the resource for you, you won't leave this town or its people alone.
北方哨歌：哪怕最后找到了原矿，你们也不准备保留这座小镇……

Bertolt: We're talking about the ultimate energy source of arcanum. Do you think we will just walk away and leave it to be squandered by a bunch of ignorant peasants and miners?
贝托尔特：这可是人人觊觎的神秘学的终极能源之一，怎么能让一群化外之民来负责呢?

Windsong: You should be ashamed of yourself!
北方哨歌：可耻的说法……

Bertolt's smile fades like a bad aftertaste.
贝托尔特的笑意终于收敛起来。

Bertolt: What we're going to do with Rayashki should be of no concern to you. We have made every arrangement for them.
贝托尔特：后续的处理方案并不在你的职权范围以内，你操心过头了，我们早就安排了合适的人选。

Bertolt: We aren't monsters. Before the final decision is made, we will continue to help the locals as much as we can.
贝托尔特：在真正的结论得出前，我们仍会努力地为当地居民提供力所能及的帮助。

Bertolt: Including you.
贝托尔特：当然，我们同样不会忽略对你的关怀。

Before the wild-eyed researcher can voice her dissent, Bertolt steers the conversation with well-practiced ease.
在草根学者心生异议之前，老练的负责人自然地将话题转到了一个更诱人的方向。

Wordlessly, he draws out an attractive-looking document and slides it across the table toward her.
他从书页之间抽出了一张漂亮的文书，沿着桌面滑向了北方哨歌。

Windsong: Is this ...?!
北方哨歌：这是……?!

Bertolt: You seem surprised. Isn't it what you have always wanted?
贝托尔特：别太惊讶，这不正是你心心念念的么?

Bertolt: With Zeno's endorsement, you will be able to teach your program in any university.
贝托尔特：想象一下吧，当它盖上芝诺的章，你就能在任何一所大学畅通无阻地开设你想要讲授的课程。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Bertolt: We have prepared this gesture of our good faith in you.
贝托尔特：芝诺已经向你表示足够的诚意了。

Bertolt: Now it's your turn to show yours. Forget about an armed squad. They have more important things to do.
贝托尔特：别指望那支武装小队的协助，他们有更重要的事得完成。

Bertolt: You're on your own, my friend. But prove to us that you can do this job, and bring us the best answer you can give.
贝托尔特：依靠你自己，朋友。向我们展示你的本事，给我们带来你最真实可信的成果，而不是一沓沓枯燥无味的文书。

The pale letterhead stings Windsong's fingertips.
灰白色的信笺灼痛北方哨歌的指头，令她不自觉地颤抖。

Bertolt: And this piece of paper will be yours when you complete your mission.
贝托尔特：事成之后，它自然归你了。

Windsong: I understand.
北方哨歌：……我明白了。

Bertolt: See that you do. Good luck out there, Ms. Windsong.
贝托尔特：很好，也祝你好运，女士。

Deep footprints, now half-buried in fresh snow, trace the path of the researcher's determined march behind her.
雪地上的脚步声迅速而坚定，它孤独而勇敢地朝着某个早已被占领的王国而去。

Abandoned Mine, Rayashki
来亚什基·废弃矿区

Her courage, passion, and body temperature rapidly cooling against the blizzard.
落魄学者的勇气、热情与她的体温一同，于暴雪中迅速地冷却了下来。

Windsong: Was I out of my mind?!
北方哨歌：难道我疯了吗——?

Windsong: He was just trying to get me out of his office. He threw a carrot out of the window, and I chased right after it like a blinded mule!
北方哨歌：芝诺只是在敷衍我……就像是对付一头只擅长拉磨的愚笨驴子，几根胡萝卜就能让它围着磨盘团团转！

Windsong: Still ...
北方哨歌：可——

Her hand lingers on the paper nestled within her pocket.
她小心翼翼地抚过衣袋里的那张薄薄的信纸。

Windsong: Maybe this "carrot" is too good to let go.
北方哨歌：这根胡萝卜实在太香甜了……

With a sigh of resignation, she reaches deeper.
认命般的叹息后，她小心翼翼地向着更深的地方摸索着。

Windsong: Focus. Once I fill the gaps in my data, I will be able to pitch it to Zeno, and all subsequent research won't be a problem anymore!
北方哨歌：现在，只要我补充好缺漏的证据，哪怕一点儿都好……芝诺就会相信我的理论，后续的研究也能够迎刃而解！

Windsong: The primary food sources for Hoituk are raw minerals underground. Those processed metals only keep them from starving to death. They wouldn't have gone across any icy ocean just to gnaw on old equipment and trash.
北方哨歌：霍伊图克最主要的食物来源是地底的矿石。人工改造后的铁质物对它们而言仅仅能够果腹，绝不可能吸引它们横渡冰洋来到这儿。

Windsong: All I need to do is find a trace of their activities so that I can learn about their current conditions and, from there, locate their other food sources.
北方哨歌：只需要再找到一些它们的活动痕迹，观察它们族群的整体状况，说不定就能知道是否有足以供给它们生存的其他食物。

Windsong: Stay calm. Hoituk are gentle creatures. They rarely attack humans. I just need to be cautious.
北方哨歌：冷静点儿，霍伊图克生性温和，它们很少会主动攻击人类……只要我再小心一点儿便好。

Her internal struggles will have to wait, as more practical problems loom larger.
遗憾的是，现实问题显然要比自我斗争复杂得多。

The blizzard has covered almost everything, leaving a few cans to poke out, rattling along with the wind.
疾风与暴雪几乎掩盖了这儿的一切，只有零星的几个罐头壳滚落在地。

Windsong: Crazy! Whoa!
北方哨歌：&%#！*【德涅斯特河东岸粗口】!

Windsong: Alright, change of direction.
北方哨歌：好吧，换个思路——

Windsong: If I were to look down instead of looking forward, maybe I should scan the area and follow where the ley energy is leading. Just like I did at Silbury Hill.
北方哨歌：向下挖掘，扫描这片区域的线性结构，确定这边区域的地脉能量延伸方向……就像之前在锡尔伯里山那样～

Windsong: Ahem! Of course, I hope the outcome will be different this time.
北方哨歌：咳——当然，它们的结局最好有所差异。

She surveys the expanse of boundless snow.
她环顾四周，一望无际的雪地没过了能见的所有土地，也没过了她的仪器。

Windsong: Before all that, I need to clear out this place.
北方哨歌：在这之前，先清理出一片干净的区域——

Windsong: Природа это числа и черты.
北方哨歌：Природа это числа и черты.

Windsong: Природа это мозаика цветов.
北方哨歌：Природа это мозаика цветов.

The soil churns in slurry waves along the seashore, a mix of mud, snow, and stone.
土壤像是成了海边翻涌的浪花，抖落身上覆满的雪渍。

A violent resonance spreads beyond it, one to which she is completely unaware.
剧烈的振响迅速地传了出去，但她丝毫未觉。

Hoituk?: *hiss*
霍伊图克?：嘶 %#！嘶嘶 %@——！

Clearly, these creatures harbor some discontent at these scars on their land.
显然，它们对领土遭到的破坏相当不满。

Windsong: Shoot! Now I've done it.
北方哨歌：糟了！这儿的动静似乎闹得太大了。

Windsong: Those vestigial digging teeth, the three-fingers-long tearing teeth—these are not Hoituk!
北方哨歌：彻底退化的掘矿齿，三指长的锐牙——你们不是霍伊图克?!

Hoituk?: *hiss*
霍伊图克?：嘶!

They bare their teeth and claws in a rhythmic way, like a primitive pre-feeding ritual.
它们张牙舞爪，像是在进行某种进食前的神秘仪式。

Windsong: These scaled wings must be for swimming. Then you must be ...
北方哨歌：这副便于泅渡的鳞翼，你们是——

Windsong: Mutant Kikituk from the Olga area!
北方哨歌：基基图克的奥尔加异种!

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Windsong: You should be at the Olga Strait, hunting for migrating salmon and whales, not here!
北方哨歌：你们应该逡巡在奥尔加海峡，捕食那儿洄游而过的鲑鱼与鲸，而不是待在这儿!

Mutant Kikituk: *roars*
基基图克异种：吼 &*#——！

The Kikituks can no longer contain themselves and pounce towards Windsong.
基基图克们再也按捺不住，朝着北方哨歌的方向扑了上来。

Windsong sits slumped on the ground, gasping for air.
北方哨歌瘫坐在地，大口地喘着粗气。

Their fury has not yet abated; the creatures hold their ground.
基基图克们余怒未消，迟迟不愿离去。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Windsong: Why would you come here? What inspired you to trek across the ocean, just to hunt for humans?
北方哨歌：你们怎么会出现在这儿？难道你们也有什么复兴人类捕食计划的远大航海目标吗？

Her aggressors show no signs of understanding.
遗憾的是，对方似乎无法理解她的抗议。

They inch closer, drool drooping from their mouths.
它们垂下长短不一的口涎，向着食物的方向步步紧逼。

Windsong: D**n it! It seems, while their claws and teeth have degraded, their reflexes much quicker than a Hoituk's.
北方哨歌：该死的，挖掘的齿爪退化之后，它们的触觉比霍伊图克敏锐得多了……

Windsong: They perceived my approach, even though I used my ley line reader as a dampener.
北方哨歌：哪怕是采用了人类减震工艺的采线仪，也逃不过它们的触觉。

A rumble, distant then near, drowns out her sigh.
某种由远及近的轰鸣声盖过了她的叹息。

A gunshot hammers out nearby, the shot landing on one of the snarling Kikituk.
热烈的枪声呼啸而来，准确地命中一只龇牙咧嘴的基基图克。

The bolt is drawn back. The familiar sound sends another scurrying away.
枪栓再一次被拉响，又一只基基图克落荒而逃。

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌：——！

Evgeni: Get out!
叶甫根尼：别愣在那儿！

Evgeni: Get out of here! I'll cover you!
叶甫根尼：撤出那片区域，我会掩护你！

More gunfire thunders, over and over, until the last Kikituk abandons their position.
枪声持续了许久，落荒而逃的基基图克们终于放弃了它们的堡垒。

Windsong: Thank you, sir.
北方哨歌：感谢你的救援，先生。

Composing herself, the researcher immediately returns to her work.
紧接着，她又像是突然想起了什么。

Windsong: Evgeni, the kids told me about a can pile. Is it nearby?
北方哨歌：那片……罐头园，它在这儿么？

Evgeni: Can pile?
叶甫根尼：罐头园？

He furrows his brow, motioning with his eyes to some hilly snowdrifts nearby.
他皱了皱眉，瞥了瞥不远处那片被翻得七零八落的雪堆。

Evgeni: They must be talking about our waste metal. I'm afraid it's gone, Ms. Windsong. Maybe animals dug it all out, or maybe those little monsters ate it.
叶甫根尼：或许是因为附近的野兽，又或者是那些不知道从哪儿冒出来的小怪物——我们埋下的铁块早就被啃食殆尽了。

Windsong: Do you know if that happened before or after the runium mines ran dry?
北方哨歌：它们对铁块的袭击发生在卢恩矿石枯竭之前吗……？

Evgeni: I'm not sure.
叶甫根尼：也许吧……

Evgeni's brow furrows again, this time casting a surveying glance at her scattered instruments.
叶甫根尼皱了皱眉，扫了一眼那些东倒西歪的仪器们。

Evgeni: You shouldn't be here. There's nothing of value to find in this place.
叶甫根尼：……你不该来这儿，这儿没有你要找的东西。

Evgeni: And you're not supposed to be using this arcane equipment here, either.
叶甫根尼：更不应该使用这些神秘学气味过重的装备。

Evgeni: We have a better way to deal with these fierce little monsters. What you're doing will just attract more of them.
叶甫根尼：对付这些凶悍的小怪物，应该用更传统的办法……否则，它们只会呼朋引伴，永远没个消停。

His statement rattles her.
对方的说法震撼了她的认知。

Windsong: You can drive away the Kikituks?!
北方哨歌：你们能驱赶这儿的基基图克——?!

Evgeni: Not anymore. We don't have much left to fight them off with. Zeno didn't bring any equipment for our team, let alone any weapons.
叶甫根尼：不行，我们没多少家伙了，芝诺没有给我们送来任何新装备，更别说其他重武器了。

Evgeni: Go. Leave before it's too late.
叶甫根尼：你还是趁早离开这儿吧……

He carefully checks the rifle in his hand.
他小心地检查手上的步枪，零件们咔哒咔哒，像是在接受检阅。

Windsong: What if I don't want to just give up?
北方哨歌：如果我不愿放弃呢——?

Evgeni slows down, making his inspection come across as even more deliberate.
对方的动作滞缓了下来。

Evgeni: I've seen your residence application. You say you are a researcher.
叶甫根尼：我记得你的居留申请，一位研究学者。

Evgeni: Then you should be clever enough not to go down a fruitless and dangerous path.
叶甫根尼：你的学识理应支撑你做出更聪明的决定，而不是继续从事一项绝无结果的危险研究。

Windsong: I admit that what I'm doing here is reckless, and maybe I'm just motivated by my own selfish interests. But I can't just walk away from my commitments.
北方哨歌：……我承认，这份莽撞是出于我的一己私利。但无论如何，这不是什么可以随意摒弃的东西——

Windsong: You have lived in Rayashki for a long time. You know what "commitment" means here much better than I do.
北方哨歌：你在来亚什基生活了如此之久，关于“理想”的认知，你应该要比我清楚得多。

There is a shift in his face as he turns away from her.
对方的脸色变了变，他背过身去。

Windsong: I won't give it up so easily, just like the people here won't give away their land like nothing.
北方哨歌：正如这儿的人们热爱这片土地，他们也从未打算离开。

Evgeni: It's stubbornness. That's all.
叶甫根尼：只是种令人失望的顽固罢了。

Windsong: ...?
北方哨歌：……?

Evgeni: They should have gone to other places and put their talents to good use, rather than staying here to fight for nothing.
叶甫根尼：他们应该在更广阔的地方发挥才能，而不是继续留在这里徒劳地牺牲。

Windsong holds a stare, lifting her chin to match up to him.
北方哨歌坚决地昂起头来。

Windsong: Is that why you gave away the town so easily to Zeno? Do you really even know your neighbors?
北方哨歌：所以你任由芝诺摆布这儿的一切，什么也不做——你真的了解他们么?

Evgeni: I have lived and worked together with them for decades. Don't be ridiculous. I just ...
叶甫根尼：我们共事了数十年。你不觉得这个问题太可笑了么?

Evgeni: I agree with Zeno's perspective.
叶甫根尼：……我认可芝诺的决议。

Windsong: Tsk. I've been to many places, and I have encountered many people like you—stuck-up "leader types," making decisions on behalf of other people because "it's what's good for them."
北方哨歌：啧——我走过很多地方，也见过不少像你这样的“家长”，打着为所有人好的名头，然后自顾自地付出，把一切都决定好。

Evgeni: And they should listen. Just as you should now.
叶甫根尼：无论是他们，还是你，都应该回到更适合你们的地方去。

He braces the rifle as he motions her back and scans the near horizon.
那杆始终高昂的枪屹立着。

Evgeni: It's my responsibility to protect everyone, to do right by them.
叶甫根尼：对所有人负责，这才是我的责任。

Evgeni: I will make them see it tomorrow at the hearing.
叶甫根尼：我会说服他们的，就在明天的全员大会。

Windsong: Ah!
北方哨歌：……

8#1
8#1

仅有的日子
The Only Days Left FR-10

People's Square, Rayashki
来亚什基·民众广场

People stream in from all directions.
人们从四面八方鱼贯而入。

They stand now at the crossroads of the town's fate.
不约而同地站在了小镇命运的关口。

Bertolt: *clears throat* People of Rayashki, my dear friends, good day to you all.
贝托尔特：咳咳——
来亚什基的朋友们，你们好。

Bertolt: Over the past two days, Zeno has assessed the potential risks and benefits in the area, and held hearings on what should be done about the future of this town.
贝托尔特：在过去的两天里，芝诺完成了对这一区域的全方位危险评估与价值考察。同时，我们举办了关于小镇处理方案的听证会。

Bertolt: Our hearings saw very limited attendance. We've taken that to be a gesture of approval.
贝托尔特：我们的听证会似乎响应者寥寥，这似乎说明了一件确凿的事实：各位对芝诺的决定相当信任。

Bertolt: Mr. Evgeni has put in a great effort helping to make these changes happen. We all owe him a great deal. Thank you, sir.
贝托尔特：当然，我们仍需感谢叶甫根尼先生在此次行动中的大力支持与配合。

He motions to Evgeni at his side.
他向一旁的叶甫根尼致意。

A freshly printed document unfurls before all present, Zeno's seal stamped deliberately in the most prominent position.
一页崭新的文件展示在所有人的眼前，芝诺的印章刻意地盖在了最显眼的位置。

Bertolt: Please believe that we have made the best decision we could for you.
贝托尔特：请相信，我们已做出了对各位而言最妥当的安排。

Bertolt: We all know the runium here has run dry, and the land has been exhausted of all further material wealth, now and into the foreseeable future.
贝托尔特：首先，来亚什基的卢恩矿石已经枯竭，在未来百年之内已无再生可能。

Bertolt: As a result, your local processing factory has lost its intended purpose.
贝托尔特：受此影响，当地的矿石加工厂已无继续运行的必要。

Bertolt: What's more, Zeno has changed our cooperation strategy. Though your town's loyalty will never be forgotten, we must have a sober-minded view of its costs and benefits.
贝托尔特：最重要的是，因全球形势的影响，芝诺大幅调整了对外政策。相比于继续维系缺少价值的关系，我们期待更有分量的合作对象。

Bertolt: To sum up, our final decision is that ...
贝托尔特：综上所述，我们得出了最终的结果——

Bertolt: We will be ending operations and all future cooperation between Zeno and Rayashki.
贝托尔特：来亚什基已无作为芝诺合作方的必要性与价值。

A heavy hammer swings in the square, producing a whistling wind.
一记重锤在广场上摆荡着，振出阵阵风声。

Knut: Well, Mr. Bertolt, you have just got here; perhaps you didn't have enough time to get to know us well enough. Rayashki's value is not just in our runium. We have many other factories, too.
克努特：咳，贝托尔特先生，您可能了解得还不够仔细。我们不止有卢恩矿石，我们有许多别的工厂……

Urgent words of protest flood in from all sides.
热切而急迫的话语从四面八方涌来。

Bertolt: Yes, you have a brick factory, a power plant, many forklifts, a smattering of conveyor belts. But all these were all built and suited for only the processing of runium ore.
贝托尔特：是的，你们有砖墙厂、有发电厂、有搬运铲车，甚至还有运输带，可这一切都建立在开采卢恩矿石的基础上——

Bertolt: Without the ore, they simply have no benefit to us.
贝托尔特：但现在，它们已经失去了意义。

Residents: ...
镇民众：……

The crowd murmurs, voices bubbling up and simmering like boiling water.
人群窃窃私语，不同的声音在一起呜呜，像是滚开的沸水。

Bertolt raps the table, ending the broil.
贝托尔特敲了敲桌子，遏住了这一势头。

Bertolt: Now that you have full knowledge of the situation and our intentions, we want to assure you that your loyalty has not been forgotten, so we have generously prepared two choices for the future of Rayashki.
贝托尔特：以上是对于来亚什基当下状况的说明。根据这一状况，我们为来亚什基准备了两套方案。

The assembly hushes.
会场短暂地沉寂了下来。

Bertolt: Firstly, Zeno believes that you have many valuable qualities. The determination and skills you've shown in the past year of our cooperation have proved that your people can be a great asset to us.
贝托尔特：芝诺认为，各位具有宝贵的坚定意志与非比寻常的技术能力。这是一种值得敬佩的精神……

Bertolt scans across the faces looking back at him.
贝托尔特扫过许多人的面庞。

Bertolt: Indeed, many of you already meet the entrance requirements to join Zeno.
贝托尔特：在座的不少人都符合芝诺的入职标准与需要。

Bertolt: Therefore, on behalf of Zeno Arms Academy, I wish to extend a heartfelt invitation to you.
贝托尔特：因此，我代表芝诺军备学院，向你们发出最诚挚的邀请——

Bertolt: Leave Rayashki. Join us and work for one of our other branches as members of Zeno.
贝托尔特：希望各位能够与我们一同撤离来亚什基，到芝诺各个分部任职。

Knut: What are you saying!? You want us to abandon our home for some promise of a job?
克努特：什么意思？……难道芝诺打算彻底收拢这儿的所有人吗?

Bertolt: Calm down, Mr. Knut. This is not about abandoning your home. It's about joining us in our efforts to contribute to world peace. Through a more optimized allocation of manpower.
贝托尔特：冷静点，克努特先生。我更愿意称之为一项基于理性的组织优化安排，一份为世界和平而出力的新机会。

Resident I: So you're just going to pack us all up and ship us away to work for Zeno?
镇民 I：你打算把我们所有人都糊弄到芝诺去——?

Bertolt: You misunderstand, madam.
贝托尔特：……你误会了，女士。

He closes the folder, looking conspicuously towards the children beside Windsong.
他合拢文件夹，瞥了瞥北方哨歌身旁的孩子们。

Bertolt: Every year, Zeno dismisses 4% of our employees because they failed to pass our rigorous work reviews. And the number of our colleagues that are killed in the line of duty is even larger still.
贝托尔特：在芝诺，每年因未通过考核而淘汰的人员约占整体人数的 4%，而因公牺牲的更多……

Bertolt: Working for Zeno is a privilege, not a gift.
贝托尔特：芝诺的工作并非娱乐场，我们无时无刻不在面对着战火、纷争以及随时可能发生的地区冲突。

Bertolt: That's why only a small number of you will be allowed to come and work for us.
贝托尔特：很遗憾，芝诺并不是什么滥造滥收的慈善机构，仅仅有一小部分人能够有机会入职芝诺。

Resident II: What?
镇民 II： 什么……?

Bertolt: Now, according to Article 58 in the section on "protection of arcanist rights" signed at the Event Horizon Convention ...
贝托尔特： 当然，按照《视界线公约》第二章中关于“神秘学家权利保障条例”部分的第 58 条细则——

Bertolt: We will provide basic supplies for any residents who haven't been offered a position with Zeno. They will be transferred immediately to the nearest relief station until our social workers contact them for further arrangements.
贝托尔特： 我们会在后续为没有被选上的镇民们提供基本的生存保障，将他们转移到就近的救济点，直到后续相关福利机构的介入。

Knut: So then, you're suggesting you will send our children and elderly away to some kind of refugee station?
克努特： 把小镇的孩子和老人统统扔到一边，送去某个谁也不清楚的福利院、养老院……

Knut: And the rest of us must go to work for Zeno without any questions?
克努特： ——然后咱们乖乖地当芝诺的乖狗狗?

Knut: You ****! This is total rubbish!
克努特： 你**的【来亚什基粗口】！在说什么胡话呢！

He waves off, then pushes aside the Zeno soldier in front of him.
他愤怒地挥舞着双臂，撞开抵在前面的芝诺卫兵。

Zeno Soldier: Sir, please lower your voice.
芝诺卫兵： 先生，请你冷静。

Bertolt: Well. You would be glad to know that your work experience in particular is valuable to Zeno, Mr. Knut.
贝托尔特： ……顺带一提，克努特先生，就芝诺的标准而言，您的履历相当出色。

He attempts a pat on Knut's shoulder, who shrugs him off.
他拍了拍克努特的肩膀，对方毫不客气地甩开了他。

But Bertolt acts entirely unfazed, unfolding the document further.
但贝托尔特似乎全然不在意，他不紧不慢地展开了那份文件。

Bertolt: If you're not interested in our first plan, we have another.
贝托尔特： 除此之外，我们同样准备了第二个方案。

Bertolt: If the residents in the area prove reluctant to relocate, Zeno can offer another alternative. As stated earlier, Rayashki is a remote town that possesses some significant industrial infrastructure.
贝托尔特： 如当地民众的撤离意愿较低，据前述分析，来亚什基本身仍拥有矿石加工厂基础，改造成本较低，且地处北极地区，隐秘性强——

Bertolt: Therefore, it could be considered an ideal location for a new complex of arms factories.
贝托尔特： 可作为新的军工厂设址地。

Vila: ...!
维拉： ……!

Bertolt: There would be a need to substantially upgrade the Rayashki wharf. To turn it into one of the seaports Zeno plans to build across the globe.
贝托尔特： 同时，扩建码头也已列入优先选择项之一，这一调整属于芝诺全球海港战略的一环。

Bertolt: Additionally, a radio station will be constructed within the town.
贝托尔特： 除此之外，无线电广播基地的设计同样在我们的考虑之中。

Bertolt: Which will better facilitate our communication throughout the Arctic region so as to stabilize and coordinate with other powers in the area.
贝托尔特：建立稳定的信号收发系统利于维护北极地区的局势稳定，协调这一区域的国际关系。

Bertolt: ...
贝托尔特：……

Bertolt: We will now be passing out forms, listing the options I've presented. Please fill them in with your choice.
贝托尔特：接下来，我将为各位发放意愿登记书，请各位择选出自己更期望的方案……

Vila: So your only other option is to turn Rayashki into some kind of military base under Zeno's control?
维拉：你打算让来亚什基彻底成为芝诺的附庸吗?

Bertolt: I won't put it so bluntly, but you're not incorrect.
贝托尔特：很遗憾，你可以这么理解。

Bertolt: Our resources, as much as anyone's, are limited, and they must be put to good use. We cannot afford to waste them on strategically usele- ... costly people and places.
贝托尔特：我们得把有限的人力资源投入在更关键的地区，而不是芝诺以外的地方。

Bertolt: If you want Zeno to help you, you should be able to give us something in return, don't you agree?
贝托尔特：如果你们需要芝诺的帮助，那总得付出点什么，对吧?

He folds the proposal again with satisfaction.
他满意地合上了方案书。

The crowd heaves in protest, held at bay by the soldiers around Bertolt.
人群的喧嚣与抗议被卫兵们远远地隔开了。

Knut: So, Evgeni, this is "the best choice" you made for all of us?
克努特：叶甫根尼，这就是你说的最好的选择——?

Bertolt: Ahem! I must speak in Mr. Evgeni's defense. He is committed to his duty and only wishes to do what he can for his compatriots.
贝托尔特：咳咳，我必须为叶甫根尼先生辩解几句……他是一位相当尽责的军人，也很希望能为他优秀的同胞做一些力所能及的事。

Knut: Shameless! All you've done is sold us out!
克努特：啐！你为了自己口袋里的几个子儿，就把大伙给卖了个好价钱?

Resident I: You tell them, Knut!
镇民 Ⅰ：说得好，克努特!

Resident II: Do you think it's getting a bit windy lately? Clearly, with all the hot air in Evgeni's head, his mind has been blown away!
镇民 Ⅱ：依我看，这儿的风可真够大的！要不然叶甫根尼的脑子怎么会被吹糊涂了呢!

Countless eyes fall on Evgeni. Disappointment, sadness—perhaps something more complex.
无数的目光落在叶甫根尼的身上。失望，难过，或许更加复杂。

Evgeni: ...
叶甫根尼：……

Evgeni: I swear to you, I am not doing this out of my own interest.
叶甫根尼：我向你们保证，我的行为不涉及我任何的私人利益。

Evgeni: Comrades, there are many better places in this world, and you have better purposes to fulfill.
叶甫根尼：同志们，你们有更好的地方可去，有更远大的使命可以实现。

Evgeni: You shouldn't waste your time here.
叶甫根尼： 你们不应该在这儿虚度……

Knut: Bah!
克努特： 呸——

The bear of a man puffs up with anger.
愤怒的潮水拍打在他的脸上。

Bertolt: Let's all calm down, my friends! It's time to be reasonable!
贝托尔特： 朋友们，请冷静。是时候让理性回归你们的大脑了！

Bertolt: Think carefully. Zeno has been very generous regarding the offers before you.
贝托尔特： 好好想想，芝诺已经向你们开出了极其丰厚的条件。

He readies himself, as if about to launch into a grand prepared speech, but his hand trembles.
他正打算洋洋洒洒地演讲下去，却不由得打了个寒噤。

A chill wind sweeps over him.
一道凛冽的风刮过了这位骄傲的芝诺先生。

Vila: Generous? Now that's ridiculous!
维拉： 很遗憾，你还是得出了这样一个可笑的结论。

Vila: We won't let you take away our family and friends, nor are we about to let you turn our town into a puppet state!
维拉： 我们不会放弃任何一位同胞，也不打算成为芝诺的应声虫。

Resident II: We will stay here! No matter what!
镇民 II： 咱们绝不离开这儿！

Evgeni: Comrades, I understand how you feel right now.
叶甫根尼： 同志们，我理解你们的心情。

Evgeni: But we must face the cruel reality of our situation.
叶甫根尼： 但我们不得不面对这一切，面对“撤离来亚什基”的现实。

Vila: And you're willing to send away our own people or give up on all we've built here because of this so-called "reality."
维拉： ……所以你不得不大义凛然地牺牲一部分人，又或是牺牲掉整个来亚什基。

Evgeni: It is the only way forward.
叶甫根尼： 至少我们的处境得到了改善。

Evgeni: If we continue to stay here without any help, it will be the end of us either way.
叶甫根尼： 如果继续固执地留在这里，所有人都会毫无意义地牺牲。

Vila: Do we have to turn to Zeno for this help?
维拉： 难道我们不能依靠自己吗——？

Evgeni fails to react at first, but a defeated expression comes over him.
颓丧的神情笼罩了对方的脸。

Evgeni: The truth is, just as Rayashki's economy has been dependent on runium, we remain dependent on Zeno.
叶甫根尼： 事实上，来亚什基的经济依托于卢恩矿石，依托于同芝诺的合作。

Evgeni: Without them, at the present rate of consumption, we will be out of supplies and materials within a year.
叶甫根尼： 如果没有芝诺……按照现在的消耗速度估算，来亚什基的资源将在一年内消耗殆尽。

Vila: ...
维拉：……

A silent tidal shift sweeps over those assembled.
巨大的遗憾与沉默横亘在了所有人的面前。

The researcher observes the change with harsh recognition.
一切悄悄地落在自诩见多识广的学者眼里。

Windsong: This situation looks bad.
北方哨歌：如此苛刻的条件么……

Windsong: Zeno is determined to gain control over this place.
北方哨歌：芝诺控制这儿的决心实在令人讶异。

She touches the unsealed letter. Her fingers jump away, as if it had been electrified.
她鬼使神差地摸到了那封尚未盖章的信笺，像是触电一般，迅速松了手。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Windsong: But if I complete the task as Zeno requested, does it mean ...
北方哨歌：如果我真的完成了芝诺指派的任务，这是不是意味着……

Bertolt's words echo in her ears.
贝托尔特关于小镇“化外之民”的论调言犹在耳。

Windsong: I will shatter their dream?
北方哨歌：……我也成了他人理想的刽子手。

Windsong: And what about my dream?
北方哨歌：可我同样是为了自己的理想……

The words stick in her throat.
自我的辩白如鲠在喉。

Windsong: Did the people who refused to acknowledge the study of ley lines act out of the same self-interest?
北方哨歌：那些无端排挤理线学的人，他们也是如此安慰自己的么？

Windsong: I've seen this happen so many times before.
北方哨歌：嗯，我见过这一幕……

Windsong: A simple dream is made to face a cruel reality. Where the clever ones give up and leave, and the stubborn fools remain, waiting to be crushed.
北方哨歌：只要沾上了一点和世俗格格不入的东西，就得应付类似的倒霉选择……陈词滥调的理想悲剧，聪明人的见好就收……

Windsong: "We asked for our misery."
北方哨歌：“是啊，这是我们自找的……”

She turns, her mixed feelings refusing to settle.
她拧过头去，据理力争的呼喊丝毫不曾退潮。

The wall of soldiers has suppressed most of the dissent in the square.
冷酷的芝诺阵线阻拦了在场所有的异议，人群被推搡着后退。

But still, some bravely charge forward.
但仍有人为之前赴后继。

Vila: Wait!
维拉：等等——！

Vila: I'm not finished.
维拉： 我还有话要说……

Bertolt dismisses her with his hand as he leaves the stage.
贝托尔特甩了甩手，毫不留情地走下台去。

Bertolt: But I am, Ms. Vila.
贝托尔特： 我已言尽于此，维拉女士。

The researcher remains stunned, but this potent chemistry of hope and resolve begins to catalyze something in her.
孤独的学者怔在一旁，那些奋力与坚决的呐喊声前赴后继地挤入一颗滞涩的脑袋。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Windsong: Sir! With all due respect. I can't complete this task alone.
北方哨歌： 无意冒犯，芝诺老爷。仅仅靠我一个人，是没法完成你们的任务的。

Windsong: As an ordinary researcher, I can relate to them. Please forgive me for interrupting.
北方哨歌： 既然如此，请原谅草根学者的一颗挣扎与煎熬的心吧。

She lifts her head proudly, looking out in the direction of the crowd.
她抬起头来，凝望着人群的方向。

Windsong: I have heard so much about Rayashki these days.
北方哨歌： 这些天，我听闻了许多关于来亚什基的故事。

Windsong: They started from nothing, but bit by bit, they accomplished the impossible.
北方哨歌： 一个艰难的开始，一群可爱的人们，以及无数个汗滴与鲜血熔铸的故事……

Windsong: Their voice should be heard.
北方哨歌： 他们至少应该获得一次为自己发声的权利。

Windsong: Природа это числа и черты.
北方哨歌： Природа это числа и черты.

The soil and snow under her feet becomes imbued with new life, rising up around her.
脚下的土壤与雪块仿佛被赋予了新的生命。

They clamp onto military boots and surge up and into gun barrels, plugging them up in a comical fashion.
它们钳住军靴，堵塞枪口，像是孩子顽皮的恶作剧。

Zeno Soldier: ...?!
芝诺卫兵： ……?!

Vila: ...!
维拉： ——!

The teacher seizes on this opportunity.
娇小的身体显然不会放过如此良机。

She climbs over the wall of confused soldiers and charges forward.
她翻过高大的人墙，向前追去。

Zeno Soldier: Miste- ... Mister Bertolt.
芝诺卫兵： 贝、贝托尔特先生……

Zeno Soldier: We can't hold them any longer!
芝诺卫兵：不好了，我们快要拦不住他们了！

Their conflict ceases.
冲突短暂地中止了。

Scaly palms forcefully grab Bertolt's arm, sharp nails tearing at his sleeve.
鳞片包裹的手掌用力扯住了贝托尔特的手臂，锋利的指甲撕破了他的袖口。

Vila: Now, will you listen to me?
维拉：现在，你愿意听我说了吗?

A clean, new ledger is stuffed into Bertolt's hands.
一本干净如新的登记簿被塞回了贝托尔特的手里。

Vila: We don't need your help. Your soldiers and your tyranny are no longer welcome here.
维拉：我们不需要芝诺的怜悯，也不接受芝诺的管制。

Bertolt: ...
贝托尔特：……

Vila turns around to face her people.
维拉转过身去，面向更多的人们。

Vila: Comrades, what do you say? Shall we solve the problem with the strength of our own hands and hearts?
维拉：同志们，我们能够依靠自己的智慧与双手，解决我们的问题，你们能坚信这一切吗?

Evgeni: ...
叶甫根尼：哼……

Knut: What else can we do? This is what we've always done when there was a problem!
克努特：当然，之前的每一次，咱们不都是这么过来的吗～

Resident I: There will be more solutions than problems if we work together!
镇民 I：只要我们所有人一同努力，就一定能想到好办法!

Resident II: If I must die, I will die here with all of you!
镇民 II：说得没错！就算死，咱们也得死在一块儿!

Knut: Just stop talking nonsense, you idiot! Nobody is going to die!
克努特：臭小子，别胡说，现在还远没到要叫苦放弃的时候哩!

Vila: Rayashki belongs to all of us. We will stand with it till its last moment!
维拉：来亚什基是属于我们所有人的，它当然该由我们所有人来共同坚守!

The sudden surge of conviction and unity cows the guards as they move backwards.
那团温润的水竟在人群中烧得如此炽热。

Many blush with shame.
反而更让人羞愧得面红耳赤。

Some of them quietly withdraw.
有人悄悄地退了出去。

Windsong: Huh, they might say they're just ordinary people, but they are so brave and noble.
北方哨歌：嗯……让人无地自容啊……

8#1
8#1

最后一位乡下人
The Ley Hunter FR-11

Children's Square, Rayashki
来亚什基·儿童广场

A lonely researcher aimlessly paces through Rayashki's square.
萧索的背影漫无目的地游荡在来亚什基的广场。

The town's cold wind clearly cannot smooth the wrinkles of her brow.
镇上的冷风显然不能抚平她的褶皱。

Windsong: Could I really have traded the future of these people away for my ley line studies?
北方哨歌：理线学的新大厦，一定要建立在他人的废墟之上么?

Windsong: *sighs* Zeno ...
北方哨歌：唉，芝诺……

Windsong: I was a mule chasing after a carrot on a stick. They lured me here all so I could help ruin everything!
北方哨歌：它迫使我来到这儿，用一根胡萝卜吊足了我的胃口，它毁了我的一切!

Her voice bursts up from her chest.
那激荡的心声几乎要冲出胸膛。

Vila: Heh! You seem to be in a good mood.
维拉：呵呵，你的精神看起来还不错。

Windsong: ...?
北方哨歌：……?

Vila: We taught Zeno a lesson. They were forced to leave with their devil's bargains and tails tucked behind them. We fought back, finally.
维拉：芝诺的人栽了跟头，他们被迫收拾好自己的计划书，灰溜溜地下台了……我们终于回击了他们一次。

Vila: A nice little trick, that was. Thank you, Comrade Windsong.
维拉：一个很不错的小把戏，不是么？……谢谢你，北方哨歌同志。

She smiles at Windsong, giving her a wink.
她朝着北方哨歌眨了眨眼，露出一个感激的笑容。

Vila: We all know who the mysterious hero was that gave us a helping hand.
维拉：当然，我们深知这一壮举出自某位不愿透露姓名的正义人士之手。

Windsong: I, I didn't do anything.
北方哨歌：我……什么也没做。

Vila: It's no shame to have helped your friends, not to mention to stand up to Zeno.
维拉：作为小镇的朋友并不是什么应该羞愧的事，反抗芝诺的强权更不是。

Vila: Have more confidence in yourself, Comrade Windsong.
维拉：北方哨歌同志，你应该更自信些。

Windsong: But will you really gain anything from this fight?
北方哨歌：类似的反抗会有所结果吗……?

Vila: Not sure, but we have to do something, right?
维拉：也许会，也许不会。但我们总得做些什么，不是么?

Vila: That's why I'm here.
维拉：这正是我来这儿的目的。

Windsong: To talk to me?
北方哨歌：为了……我?

Windsong: I don't know why, but Ms. Vila, you must have thought too much of me.
北方哨歌：维拉女士，尽管我不清楚原因，但你似乎对我产生了一些过高的期待。

Windsong: In fact, I'm only a simple researcher. I'm not powerful enough to change Zeno's decision.
北方哨歌：事实上，我只是一个无籍籍名的草根学者，也不具备显赫到足以影响芝诺决议的学术背景——

Vila: You are the one thinking too much, Comrade Windsong.
维拉：理解有误的是你，北方哨歌同志。

Vila: Your ley line lessons were much more popular than you think. They have had a positive effect on the children.
维拉：你的理线学并没有你想象的那般不受欢迎，它对孩子们产生了许多积极的影响……

Vila: Now, they are looking at the bigger picture and observing the world in a more detailed way. You've unleashed their curiosity.
维拉：他们开始关心更辽阔的世界，一个更立体、更细微的世界。多亏了理线学，现在孩子们总有问不完的问题……

Vila: "Is the aurora the bubbles spit out by the stars? They form such a beautiful map. Do they study ley lines, too?"
维拉：“极光是远星们吐出的泡泡吗？它们的线条也像是一张漂亮的理线图，它们也是理线学家吗……?”

Vila feigns distress, shaking her head with a pretended childlike confusion.
维拉故作苦恼地摇了摇头，童稚的疑惑在此前的无数时刻缠住了她的眉间与臂膀。

Windsong: But it remains the case that the study of ley lines has never been verified.
北方哨歌：但理线学，归根结底只是个仍然停留在理论上的学派。

Windsong: For all its ambitions. Only a limited number of people studied it in the past decades, and that number is decreasing even now.
北方哨歌：这个学派太小，野心却太大。迄今几十年来，它都只是一小撮人的自娱自乐，并且越来越少，直到现在……

Vila nods thoughtfully.
对方若有所思地点了点头。

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌：——!

Vila: What you are looking at is not some skin problem, but my past.
维拉：正如你瞧见的这样，这并不是某种难缠的皮肤病，而是我的过往。

Vila: My past as a Rusalka.
维拉：……身为鲁萨尔卡的过往。

Windsong: Rusalka? You mean the mermaid from folklore?!
北方哨歌：鲁萨尔卡……传说中的人鱼——?!

Vila: My people used to live in a far-secluded place in the north, away from the humans.
维拉：呵呵，那是我的族群，一个来自北方的避世族群。

Vila: For hundreds of years, there was only hostility, plunder, and slaughter between us and them.
维拉：几百年来，我们与人类的交集只有敌视、掠夺，以及杀戮……

Vila: We only started to learn more about each other in the last few decades, and then I was born. It's been a hard life growing up within human society, but I've become used to it.
维拉： 在最近的短短几十年，鲁萨尔卡才逐渐与人类有了更多的交集，也诞生了我……我在人类社会举步维艰了数十年，也习惯了人类的生活。

Vila: Still, some things never got easier.
维拉： 可现实并没有我想的那般顺利。

Vila: Most humans still thought I was a freak. They "welcomed" me with mocking, sarcasm, and contempt for my people, my heritage.
维拉： 对于更普遍的人类社会而言，他们并不欢迎像我这样的畸形生物。相比于接纳，鄙夷与取乐显然更符合他们的胃口。

Vila: As for the Rusalki, they too found a half-blooded mermaid unacceptable. They didn't approve of my living among the humans, forcing me to live as a fugitive in Moscow and St. Petersburg.
维拉： 而鲁萨尔卡同样无法容忍一条混迹在人类社会中的混血人鱼，他们始终不认同我的选择，不接受我在人类社会、在莫斯科、在圣彼得堡的躲躲藏藏……

"Half-blooded." It was a nauseating term, one separating the Rusalki from the "scaleless" humans who had stolen their homeland.
一个令他们作呕的名词，一片被人类夺取的家园，一个肮脏的内陆港口。

An ancient myth that was the source of the enduring hatred between Rusalki and humans.
是的，鲁萨尔卡的仇恨如此古老而长久。

Vila: They tried to catch me by every means possible, so they could wash away the "stain" they saw in me.
维拉： 他们千方百计地抓捕我，试图洗礼、净化，抹去我这颗糟糕的污点。

Windsong: That sounds very difficult.
北方哨歌： 听起来……是段相当煎熬的日子。

Vila: Humans have stigmatized and hunted the Rusalki for centuries, while Rusalki still have the instinct to attack and plunder human ships even now.
维拉： 当然，人类对鲁萨尔卡的污名化已经持续了几个世纪，鲁萨尔卡对人类船只的掠夺与捕食同样是刻在血脉中的本能。

Vila: How are they supposed to make peace in such little time?
维拉： 如此深远且长久的仇恨又怎么能在一夕之间消弭呢?

Vila: That was what I thought years ago. Then, I came to this town.
维拉： 数年前，我也认为这几乎是不可能的事……直到我来到了这儿。

She surveys the white land; the unifying cover of snow removes all distinctions, differences, and flaws.
她环顾这片洁白的土地，茫茫的大雪盖住了周遭的一切差异与缺陷。

Vila: "A wonderful world where humans and Rusalki could live in peace." I was finally convinced.
维拉： “一个人类与鲁萨尔卡共同生活的美好世界”，我终于确信了这一件事——

Vila: In Rayashki, everyone can make contributions with their skills, whether you are a human, a Rusalka, or a ley line researcher.
维拉： 在来亚什基的土壤上，每一个人都能凭借自身所学发光发热。不论是人类、鲁萨尔卡，还是你的理线学。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Vila: I don't mean to give you more stress or push you. You will always be our friend, whatever your choice is.
维拉：这并非强迫，你也不必为此感到负担。无论如何，你都是来亚什基的朋友。

Vila: But this is not an unreachable dream. It's real.
维拉：它也绝不是一场短暂而遥不可及的梦。

A familiar phrase wells up inside her again.
某种熟悉的话语又一次涌了上来。

Conjured from a long-silenced past.
一如某些早已沉寂的过往。

School of Ley Lines
理线学社

Windsong: Haha!
北方哨歌：哈哈～

The girl, then much thinner and more stubborn than now, couldn't help but cheer.
一个远比现在瘦削、顽固的少女忍不住欢呼起来。

The other ley hunters fail to take notice, as they comb through their scattered papers.
其余的理线师们似乎并没有受她干扰，他们漫不经心地整理着散乱的文件。

Windsong: The editor of the Environmental Research agreed to publish our report, finally!
北方哨歌：我成功地说服了《环境研究》的编辑，他终于同意刊登我们的报告了！

Windsong: But he only gave us 5000 words.
北方哨歌：不过字数只能在五千字以内。

Windsong: On the last few pages.
北方哨歌：版面也被严格地限制在最后几页……

Windsong: Undoubtedly, it's still a good start, our first step to reviving the study of ley lines!
北方哨歌：但毫无疑问，这是一个美好的开始，重振理线学的第一步！

Windsong beams with excitement, clumsily sprawling over the table to select from their papers with care.
北方哨歌兴冲冲地分享着，她手忙脚乱地趴在桌子上，精心挑选着最经典的那一篇论文。

Dull, dry theories shine anew, bright and vivid in her eyes.
那些枯燥的理论映在女孩的瞳孔里，显得明亮、充满活力——

A table of twinkling stars.
像是黑夜中闪烁的点点繁星。

Yet, these stars must shine against an all-consuming field of darkness.
遗憾的是，再明亮的星也无法照亮整片黑夜。

Ley Hunter I: That's it. I give up! Maybe I'll study something else, like urban planning, or landscape design.
理线师 I：我打算放弃了……去研究些别的，像是城市规划、景观设计之类的……

Ley Hunter I: At least I can make a living that way.
理线师 I：至少，它们不会让我饿肚子……

Windsong remains buried in her heap of books and manuscripts, oblivious to the loss.
北方哨歌仍埋头在层层叠叠的典籍与稿纸堆里，似乎并没有注意到对方在说什么。

Ley Hunter II: The study of ley lines is outdated. Everyone agrees now that it can't be verified by science.
理线师 II： 理线学已经被时代抛弃了，大家都说，它超出了科学验证的范畴……

Ley Hunter II: "This whole study was a dead end. Ley lines are only a baseless theory of arcanum."
理线师 II： “这是个没有出路的学派，是……毫无根据的神秘运动。”

The old papers on the table filled with nothing more than nonsense and wasted ink.
桌子上的故纸堆大多是一些失去吸引力的、毫无意义的文字与线条。

At least that's how the world received it.
至少对大众而言已是如此。

Ley Hunter III: I tried talking about our study of ley lines with other arcanists, but almost no one has ever heard of it. They are more interested in Laplace's breakthroughs.
理线师 III： 我试图参与其他神秘学家们的讨论，但几乎没有人听说过理线学，他们更关注拉普拉斯的前沿报告……

Ley Hunter III: Or anecdotes in their own fields, like the Chaotic Energy sampling mentioned in the paper written by the Butterfly of Lorentz.
理线师 III： 或是更有趣的学界逸闻，比如那篇署名为“洛伦兹蝴蝶”的文章提出的“混沌能量”采样。

The stars have dimmed.
星星们几乎全然黯淡了下去。

Windsong: So, maybe it is an unreachable dream?
北方哨歌： 理线学……只是场短暂的梦吗?

A long moment of wistful distraction falls back into reality.
片刻的恍惚令她迅速地清醒了过来。

After much hesitation, she begins to speak again.
犹豫了许久，她终于缓缓开口。

Windsong: I do wish I could help, but ...
北方哨歌： 我很希望能帮上忙，但……

Windsong: It would take a lot of resources to verify the theory behind ley lines. There may be even danger and sacrifice.
北方哨歌： 为了验证理线学当下的结论，需要耗费大量的人力与物力，也极有可能面临巨大的危险与牺牲……

Windsong: Even Zeno has paid little attention to my research. They only see it as a means to an end.
北方哨歌： 哪怕是……芝诺，在我的研究产出实质性成果前，他们也不愿意为之倾注过多的注意力。

Windsong: Researchers in other fields can stand on the shoulders of giants, while I, I don't even have a school to return to.
北方哨歌： 专家们著作等身，研究成果不可计数，他们能够互相引证，而我……甚至失去了我的师承。

Windsong: I doubt that the study of ley lines will help you much.
北方哨歌： 从可预想的结果上来看，理线学也许很难对你们产生多少帮助。

She retreats a few steps back.
她低下头，艰难地向后退缩了几步。

Vila: I see.
维拉： ……原来如此。

Vila: Well, thank you for your honesty, Comrade Windsong.
维拉： 谢谢你的坦诚，北方哨歌同志。

Vila looks away, holding the regret deep in her chest.
维拉遗憾地点了点头，没再说话。

Windsong: I'm sorry.
北方哨歌：我很抱歉……

Vila: I'll see you soon.
维拉：那么，祝健康。

Windsong: See you, Vila.
北方哨歌：再见，维拉女士。

She bows her head and turns, taking a few more difficult steps away.
她的头颅低了下去，转过身，艰难地迈开了步子。

Perhaps it was her unattainable dream of revival that slowed her, or the weight of all that had gone wrong.
也许是为那遥不可及的复兴之梦，也许是为这眼前所发生的糟糕一切。

Vila: Wait, Comrade Windsong!
维拉：请等等，北方哨歌同志——！

A burst of light steps leaps toward her once more.
轻盈的步伐又一次跃向了她。

Windsong: ...?
北方哨歌：……?

Vila: Don't forget your next lesson. The children are still waiting.
维拉：别忘了下一堂课的内容，孩子们都在等着你呢～

Windsong: But the town is ...
北方哨歌：可小镇……

Vila: Life must continue, comrade.
维拉：生活仍在继续，我的朋友。

Vila: We can't let our worries stop us.
维拉：至少现在，我们还是得大步地朝前走去，对吧?

Windsong: Okay.
北方哨歌：……好的。

8#1
8#1

晚班列车
The Night Train FR-12

Classroom, Rayashki
来亚什基·综合课堂

As the chalk marks its final stroke, the lecturer exhales a long breath.
粉笔在黑板上落下了最后一笔，讲台上的人也长舒了一口气。

Windsong: Class is over.
北方哨歌：孩子们，下课了。

Windsong: Thank goodness, I still remembered the basic premises of "Ley Lines and Biology."
北方哨歌：谢天谢地，我还没把《理线学生物考》课上的内容忘个干净……

Windsong: Feel free to ask me any questions.
北方哨歌：如果你们有任何疑问的话，欢迎向我提问。

Windsong: Cheer up, little ones. There won't be any exams for this subject.
北方哨歌：高兴点吧，小家伙们～这门课程可不需要考试。

She offers a hesitant joke to ease the awkwardness of the class.
她开了个不大不小的玩笑，试图缓解课堂的尴尬。

But their usual playful responses never emerge.
往常的玩闹声并未响起，四周静悄悄的。

Windsong: Mm?
北方哨歌：嗯……?

She turns to face a class that must be bored, asleep, maybe distracted. She's met instead by clear and focused eyes.
她抬起头来，对上了许多双清澈的眼睛。

Avgust: Ms. Windsong, are you going to dig up those potatoes alone again?
阿夫西维：北方哨歌，你还打算一个人偷偷去摘铁皮土豆吗?

Nina: Is there anything we can do to help you?
尼娜：我们能为您做些什么吗?

Nina: Ms. Vila said we will work together to beat the critters out there.
尼娜：维拉老师说，我们一定能打败外面的魔精。

Nina: That we will find their weakness as long as we finish the map with you!
尼娜：如果我们能帮您画好地脉能量图，就一定能发现它们的弱点——!

Pyotr: Just like how you taught us to!
彼得森：就像您教我们的那样!

Pyotr: "Qiqirn are not dangerous at all. They are plant-eating critters and pose little threat to humans."
彼得森：“奇肯恩一点儿也不可怕，它们是草食性魔精，不会伤害人类……”

Avgust: I have ropes, flowers, and white gloves. We will dig up a lot of potatoes together.
阿夫西维：我有绳子、花朵、白色的手套，可以挖出很多的土豆。

Avgust: Pyotr is strong. He can move any rocks that are in our way. Nina can prepare a kettle of warm water for everyone. And ...
阿夫西维：彼得森的力气很大，他能搬开路上的石头……尼娜会给大家准备暖和的水壶……还有、还有……

The children's voices rise and fall. What began as icy determination soon melts into a cascade of sobbing tears.
孩子们的声音此起彼伏，哽咽与某些湿润的液体混在其中。

Windsong: I'm sorry, little ones.
北方哨歌：……抱歉，小家伙们。

Windsong: I wish I could verify all the theories we've been working on, but ...
北方哨歌：我也很希望能确定我当前所有的研究理论，但……

Pyotr: ...
彼得森：……

She affixes Rayashki's ley energy map to the blackboard, circling an empty void.
她将来亚什基的地脉能量图贴在黑板上，圈出了某块巨大的黑色漏洞。

Windsong: As you can see, a critical part is missing.
北方哨歌：正如你们所见，这张地脉能量图并不完整。它仍缺少了关键的一角。

Windsong: It might take months to finish it.
北方哨歌：按照我一个人的精力，再快也得好几个月才能初步完成。

Windsong: Besides, there may be even more dangerous critters in that area.
北方哨歌：更何况，那儿还可能有其他更危险的魔精种群。

Avgust: Then the town will become the witch's new castle? Or perhaps an empty castle.
阿夫西维：小镇会成为女巫的新城堡吗？空荡荡的，什么也没有。

Kids: ...
孩子众：……

Her attempt to turn the mood again falls flat.
讲台下的目光们黯淡了下去。

A merciful bell rings out the dreary topic like a dirge.
新一堂课的铃声终于响了起来，中止了这个并不美好的话题。

Thankfully, the next teacher arrives swiftly to relieve her.
下一堂课的老师及时地赶来了这儿。

Vila: Quiet, children.
维拉：孩子们，请安静下来。

She holds her gaze firm, sweeping over the assembled children.
她的目光坚定，缓缓扫过台下无数的孩子们。

Vila: Wipe your tears and cheer up! Our Rayashki will stand strong!
维拉：擦擦眼泪，高兴点儿～我们的来亚什基可不会轻易地被打倒——！

Pyotr: Really?!
彼得森：真的吗?！

Windsong: But what are you going to do?
北方哨歌：……可你们要怎么坚持下去?

Windsong is taken aback at first. Then, contemplating the possibilities, she delicately weighs her words.
北方哨歌有些惊讶地望着对方，随即，她想到了一个最可能发生的结局，斟酌着开口。

Windsong: Vila, I hope you aren't seriously considering Zeno's ...
北方哨歌：维拉……你们该不会向芝诺……贝托尔特并不简单，你得小心些……

Vila: Of course not. They might try, but we will never give in!
维拉：当然不，我们绝不向他们低头！

Vila: No matter what, for now, we must find a way to protect our town. We will need a shelter from these critters.
维拉：但无论如何，让小镇维系下去，让所有人都能有个安全的去处。这才是最重要的……

Vila: We've all decided to stay.
维拉：这是来亚什基所有人的决定。

The curtains part, and sunlight pours in from outside.
窗帘升了起来，窗外的阳光洒了进来。

Vila: Look outside, children.
维拉：看看外面吧，孩子们～

Vila: Each and every one of us is doing what we can to hold our town together.
维拉： 这儿的每一个人，都在为小镇的存续做着力所能及的事。

Avgust: Knut's factory is spitting out puffy bubbles.
阿夫西维： 克努特的工厂们在吐泡泡——！

Vila: Heh heh.
维拉： 呵呵……

Vila: The workers are going to transform the abandoned factories into something useful.
维拉： 工人先生们计划改造那些早已废弃的矿石加工厂。

Vila: They are cleaning the ore and debris there. Not an easy job.
维拉： 他们正在清理加工厂的石料与碎屑，这可不是件轻松的工作。

Vila: After that, we will start new production lines and cooperate with the surrounding cities. We will grow potatoes, breed fish, and make canned food. We will find our strengths together!
维拉： 之后，我们会努力开展新的生产线，同周边的其他城市建立合作关系，鳜鱼养殖、罐头生产、土豆种植，这些不都是我们擅长的吗?

Avgust: Are we putting makeup on the factories? We can paint their faces and put beautiful garlands on them!
阿夫西维： 我们要为工厂化妆吗？扎辫子，梳好头发，戴上漂亮的花环——！

Nina: Hmm? So what is Mr. Patrik doing?
尼娜： 咦……帕特里基先生在做什么呢?

Avgust: Everyone's waiting in line. Is it the tin-hat festival again?
阿夫西维： 大家都在排队，今天是铁帽子节吗?

Vila: I'm sorry, Avgust. I think we will have to live without our tin hats and Comrade Blinchik for a long time.
维拉： 很遗憾，小阿夫西维……我想我们很长一段时间都见不到布林饼同志了。

Vila: They are signing on to a reform of our rationing.
维拉： 他们正在举行签名仪式。

Vila: To transform our factories, we need to cut down the budget for the canteen.
维拉： 为了能把工厂涂成新的模样，我们需要缩减公共食堂的后续开支……

Avgust: Oh, thank you for your sacrifice, Comrade Blinchik.
阿夫西维： 噢，谢谢你，布林同志——

Avgust: You deserve a medal and some chocolate!
阿夫西维： 你应该得到奖状，还有阿廖卡！

Pasono: Look, the bulldozers are tearing down those houses!
帕索诺： 你们看，那边的推土机正在拆掉我们的房子！

Vila: Yes. We all agreed to exchange some of our living space.
维拉： 是的，所有人都同意住得更紧密一点儿——

Vila: For more land to grow food.
维拉： 这样我们就能腾出更多的好土地，种下更多的食物～

The children crowd the window, silent but beaming with pride, as if paying tribute.
孩子们好奇而骄傲地趴在窗前，像是在告别，又像是在致意。

Windsong follows Vila's narrative to its conclusion.
北方哨歌的目光无声地跟随着维拉的讲述行进着，直到终点。

Windsong: The price is much higher than it first seemed. Is it worth it?
北方哨歌： 如此沉重的牺牲，值得么?

Vila: Of course.
维拉： 当然。

Vila: You cannot find what we have here in Zeno's barracks, or in a relief camp. You can't find it anywhere in the world.
维拉： 无论是芝诺、慈善机构，还是其他任何一个地方，都不是来亚什基人的归宿。

Vila: Think about the old comrades and the babies. They are the past and the future of Rayashki. How could we leave them behind or subject them to Zeno's whims?
维拉： 那些尚在襁褓的婴儿，那些垂垂老矣的同志们，他们也是来亚什基的过去和未来，我们又怎么能抛弃他们呢?

Mechanical sounds from outside carry across the snow from afar, as if the land itself is calling.
窗外的机械声响远远地传来，像是来自土地的呼唤。

Vila: No one shall ever be abandoned in Rayashki.
维拉： 在来亚什基，没有人应该被放弃。

Windsong: I think people out there would be envious if they saw what you are doing here.
北方哨歌： 这是块令人羡慕的土地……

She doesn't press further.
她没有再追问下去，窗外的一切映在她的眼里。

Vila: We really aren't doing anything so special. We're only doing our job, our duty to one another.
维拉： 我们并没有你所想的那么伟大……这是我们应该做的事。

Her scales and spines have risen, though whether it's a sign of pride or fear, she can't say.
北方哨歌的目光落了下来，那些细微的棘刺与鱼鳍又一次凝固在她的眼前。

Windsong: There are lots of conflicts out there, conflicts like the one between humans and Rusalki.
北方哨歌： 外面多的是类似的事，就像……夹在鲁萨尔卡与人类之间的你。

Windsong: Like the ones that mocked the study of ley lines and dissolved our school. They did so simply because it might take from their funds or steal their glory.
北方哨歌： 他们贬低、排挤着理线学，逼迫它解散……仅仅因为这个东西可能会抢走他们的研究经费、他们的名头。

Windsong: Everyone forever building walls, just to keep separated from each other—Hoarding whatever they could get their hands on.
北方哨歌： 大家继续经营着各自的护城河，直到永远。

Windsong: Then they blame the aftermath—the harm they do to others on "cruel realities."
北方哨歌： 然后一切的责任都可归咎为“当下的时代”。

Windsong: Heh, "cruel reality." It seems to be everyone's mortal enemy, the cause of all suffering, war, greed—the perfect excuse to never care.
北方哨歌： 呵，当下的时代……所有人的头号大敌，一个完美的借口。

Her voice trails into a mutter.
她愤愤不平地低诉着，坚实的力量从肩膀上传来。

Vila: But things are different in Rayashki.
维拉： 可来亚什基并不一样。

Vila: They took me in unconditionally when I came here. And they stayed friendly for a week, a month, a year, and even now.
维拉： 它毫无理由地接纳了我，从一周，到几个月，许多年……直到现在。

Vila: So naturally, it became my dream, too.
维拉： 它理所当然地成了我的理想——

Vila: Everyone here shares a beautiful dream, a dream that we can work and enjoy life together.
维拉：一个属于所有人，也依赖所有人的美好构想，一个共同劳作、共同生活的健全社会。

Vila: That someday there will be no more conflicts between people or worries about tomorrow. That everyone will be able to work to achieve their passions whatever field they wish to pursue. A utopia.
维拉：我们一同建设，也一同分享着其中的成果，不再需要与任何人勾心斗角，不需要忧心自己的未来，所有人都能够在他所希望的任何一个领域成就事业。

Vila: It's not just a way of life for now, but the future we're always trying to reach.
维拉：不仅是当下，也是未来。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Vila: I've spread the study of ley lines in Rayashki, along with its potential.
维拉：我将你的理线学与它所拥有的可能性传达给了来亚什基的许多人。

A simple invitation catches Windsong's eye, with dense, messy signatures filling every possible space.
一张朴素的邀请函落入北方哨歌的眼里，密密麻麻的签名潦草而坦率地挤满了所有的空白处。

Vila: They showed great interest. The study tells us about the secrets that could lie beneath the earth, after all.
维拉：他们对这样一个能够发掘土壤中秘密的学派相当感兴趣。

Vila: "Perhaps it will bring hope to Rayashki."
维拉：“说不定，里面就藏着来亚什基的希望呢……?”

Windsong: But, I'm not one of you.
北方哨歌：可我并不是来亚什基人……

Vila: You taught the children something new, and you helped us explore our town's potential, didn't you?
维拉：你帮助了这儿的孩子们，教授他们新知识，也同我们一起探索着来亚什基的可能性，不是么?

Vila: Everyone here is more than happy to help you. You know, Comrade Knut has been boasting about the assistance he was able to provide for your studies.
维拉：这儿的所有人都很乐意帮助你。克努特同志骄傲地告诉所有人，他在工厂也参与了理线学的研究。

Vila: And many others are envious. They want to help you, too.
维拉：许多人都在羡慕他……

Vila: More importantly, you already have a group of curious students here willing to study your theory.
维拉：更重要的是，在这儿，你的理论已经有了一批好奇的学生。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Vila: Now, allow me to ask you again, Comrade Windsong.
维拉：让我再问一次吧，北方哨歌同志。

Vila: Would you hold a lecture on ley lines for all the citizens of Rayashki?
维拉：——你愿意为来亚什基的全体镇民举办一场关于理线学的讲座吗?

Windsong: Even though my research doesn't have any endorsements or achievements?
北方哨歌：……哪怕理线学在外没得到任何的好名声，哪怕我还没有一丁点儿的实质性成果?

Vila: Of course. Perhaps we can be the first to endorse it, after your lecture.
维拉：正因如此，我们拥有了一同建设的动力。

Windsong: You're being far too obvious in your recruitment tactics.
北方哨歌：这是赤裸裸的引诱，维拉。

Vila smiles, ignoring her feigned protest.
维拉亲切地笑了笑，不顾对方微弱的抗议，继续说了下去。

Vila: The world is not a beautiful place. Poverty, privilege, egoism, exclusivism, so many problems.
维拉：这是个并不美好的世界。它有许多糟糕的问题，巨头倾轧、贫困问题、利己主义、排外运动……

Vila: But that doesn't mean it can't get better in the future.
维拉：但未来并不见得始终如此。

Vila: Perhaps, the experiment we're doing in Rayashki now will become the symbol of a better future, a new world where all races and ideas can coexist.
维拉：至少在来亚什基，我们能有一些新的试验。它说不定会成为一个未来的符号，一个新世界的预兆，一张所有种族、所有主义都能和谐共处的蓝图。

Vila: Well, of course, it may fail and end up a ruin.
维拉：当然，它也许会失败，留下一片废墟与遗憾。

Vila: But at least we've tried.
维拉：但至少——我们来过。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

She watches Vila standing proudly, as if gazing at a great ship bound for distant shores.
她注视着维拉的背影，仿佛看到一艘驶向远岸的巨轮。

Venturing all, never shrinking back.
它孤注一掷，永不退缩。

Vila: We love our home, and we're ready to devote our lives to it.
维拉：我们热爱这里，也情愿为之牺牲。

Windsong: I can't shake the feeling you're inviting me aboard a leaky boat that could sink any moment.
北方哨歌：我这算是上了一艘摇摇欲坠的新船?

Vila: Maybe, Comrade Windsong. But should we sink, remember your friend is a Rusalka, and we do well underwater.
维拉：或许吧，北方哨歌同志。
但在这儿，鲁萨尔卡不是你的敌人，而是朋友。

Windsong blinks, half-wondering if her new friend has gone mad.
对方不置可否地眨了眨眼睛。

And finding it madder still that she is reaching out to solemnly accept the invitation.
一双手郑重地接过了那封邀请函。

Windsong: What an honor.
北方哨歌：荣幸之至。

8#1
8#1

别了芝诺！
So Long, Zeno! FR-13

People's Square, Rayashki
来亚什基·民众广场

The crowd has gathered together again.
人群又一次汇聚在了这里。

Windsong: I ...
北方哨歌：我……

It is a familiar place—one she's visited in dreams before.
她又一次登上了魂牵梦萦的地方。

This time, though, her watchers seem more curious than doubtful.
好奇抵过了鄙夷，期待漫过了指责。

Their eager eyes follow her every move.
无数热忱的目光落在她的身上。

Windsong: Today, I am going to introduce the study of ley lines.
北方哨歌：接下来，我将为在座的各位介绍我的学派，理线学——

Windsong: And the progress of my research on Rayashki.
北方哨歌：以及对来亚什基当前状况的研究进程。

Windsong takes a deep breath, pulling out a few pages of research notes.
北方哨歌深吸了口气，从笔记本里抽出了几页“古老”的研究笔记。

The pages are passed from hand to hand, stirring excitement.
它们在一双双振奋起来的手掌间传递着。

Windsong: Thanks to your help, I have finished a draft of the town's ley energy map.
北方哨歌：多亏了在座各位的帮助，我绘制出了一张初具雏形的地脉能量图谱。

Windsong: And I have confirmed the presence of many precious resources.
北方哨歌：也确认了来亚什基地区的大部分资源存量情况。

Knut: Through these colorful lines?
克努特：就凭着这些五颜六色的线条……？

Windsong: These lines and spots show us the state of local ley energy. Each color represents a different concentration of creatures or minerals.
北方哨歌：不同颜色的线与光点昭示着地脉能量在不同生物及土地矿物中的留存状态。

Windsong: Simply put, this area covered in frozen earth and frost contains many rich resource veins.
北方哨歌：简而言之，冻土与冷霜覆盖着这一区域的绝大部分土地，它们的资源量相当富裕。

Windsong: These gray marks symbolize them. They are located in most of the corners of the map, all of them outside of town.
北方哨歌：象征着它们的冷灰色痕迹铺满在了能量图的大部分角落，但它们始终没能入侵小镇的内部。

Resident I: Oh! Maybe that's why Grandpa said we couldn't grow anything here in the beginning.
镇民 I：噢！爷爷辈总念叨着这事，最早的时候，小镇一无所有，连半颗种子也种不活……

Resident I: They eventually solved that problem by importing rich black topsoil for our fields.
镇民 I：后来，咱们从遥远的北方运来了一方方丰沃而柔软的黑土，它们成了小镇的基石。

Windsong: As for the runium you've mined to make a living, look at the dark gray marks.
北方哨歌：而这儿赖以生存的卢恩矿石，则是铅色的。

Windsong: According to the map, they are becoming increasingly scattered and faint, so it can be hard to see them.
北方哨歌：根据图谱显示，这儿呈现出的铅色痕迹越发模糊，我们几乎无法观测到它的存在了。

Knut: ...
克努特：……

Windsong: Besides resources, we can also find concentrations of different creatures using the map.
北方哨歌：除了本身的自然资源，我们同样能根据地脉能量图确认生物痕迹的存在。

Windsong: The navy blue marks represent the Qiqirn, while the aqua green ones represent the mutant Qiqirn from the wharf. They feed on plants, and you can find their traces in many corners of the town.
北方哨歌：深蓝色的痕迹属于奇肯恩，而湖蓝色则属于出没于港口与海湾的奇肯恩变种，它们以植物为食，小镇内部的各个角落都能发现它们的痕迹。

Windsong: The red brown marks are the Kikituks, an aggressive species. They're vicious by nature and prey on just about anything arcane they can find, even other creatures.
北方哨歌：而红棕色的痕迹则属于基基图克，它们生性凶狠，喜欢一切神秘动物与神秘学气息丰裕的“食物”。

Knut: I feel as though my head is going to explode from all this new information. Can you explain a little simpler for this old workhorse, Comrade Windsong?
克努特：这些东西快把咱们的脑袋给挤满啦～咱们可记不住这么多东西。北方哨歌同志，你有什么更简单的法子吗?

Windsong: Of course.
北方哨歌：当然。

She proudly produces a small handful of fluff.
她自信地点了点头，小心翼翼地掏出了一小撮绒毛。

Windsong: This sample comes from a Kikituk in the mine. I took it with Mr. Evgeni's help.
北方哨歌：它来自一头在矿区活动的基基图克，在叶甫根尼先生的协助下，我完成了取样。

Evgeni: ...
叶甫根尼：……

Knut: Seems like just a normal piece of fluff, no matter how I look at it.
克努特：可再怎么观察，它看上去不也就是一撮普通的软毛吗?

Windsong: Yes, and in most people's eyes, it's nothing more than that.
北方哨歌：在旁人看来，这甚至不能做成一把小刷子。

Windsong: But in a ley hunter's eyes, it reveals a great deal of information.
北方哨歌：但在理线师的眼中，它呈现出了巨大的信息量。

Windsong: Ah. The navy blue marks and the red brown ones seem to mix together. And there are also dark gray ones popping out among them.
北方哨歌：嗯……深蓝色与红棕色交织在了一起，还掺杂了些许铅色的光点。

Windsong: So it looks like our Mr. Kikituk ate well. Perhaps he had a Qiqirn soup with runium-flavored kefir.
北方哨歌：看来这位基基图克先生的伙食还不错，说不准是一顿奇肯恩肉汤配卢恩矿石特调开菲尔。

Knut: Hahaha, looks like these critters have realized our dream long before we could.
克努特：哈哈，看来咱们率先在魔精群体中实现了共同理想。

Resident II: But what about those black marks?
镇民 II：可那些黑色的小玩意是……?

Resident II: If my memory serves me right, the map you just showed us had those black marks, too.
镇民 II：如果我没记错，北方哨歌同志，你刚才给咱们展示的能量图也有一大片类似的黑色痕迹……

Windsong: Yes, but they don't match any creature or resource we know.
北方哨歌：是的，它们与目前已知的任何一种生物或非生物都无法匹配。

Windsong: I believe it represents a new kind of resource.
北方哨歌：我认为，它属于一种新的资源。

The Other Resident: Oh! Well, where is it then?!
普通镇民：噢……可这种新玩意儿在哪儿呢?!

The mood has intensified, residents clamoring around to see.
场上的气氛明显地热烈了起来。

Windsong: We can only find the answer in this area here.
北方哨歌：我想，这一问题的答案，只能在那一块区域才能找到了。

Knut: You mean in the depths of the mine?
克努特：……是矿区的最深处?

Windsong gives a slow affirmative nod.
北方哨歌点了点头，继续说了下去。

Windsong: The ley energy is emanating from there. Afterwards, it flows throughout the "food chain," passing through all kinds of creatures and materials before eventually returning to its source.
北方哨歌：也是地脉能量的源头。地脉能量从那儿蒸腾而出，附着在所有生物与非生物之上。经过食物链的演化与循环，它们又无一例外地朝着那儿回流。

Windsong: Then our new resource is probably somewhere there.
北方哨歌：而我们所尚未勘测到的大片新资源，也极有可能出现在那儿。

Knut: So we need to find it! Then we won't have to put up with Zeno anymore!
克努特：如果咱们能找到它们，就再也不用受那芝诺的鸟气了!

The audience sparks up. Rippling murmurs turn into a burst of questions and excitement.
像是抛入了一颗闪烁的火星，人群开始窃窃私语。

Knut: But, do you have any other proof?
克努特：你……还有别的证据么?

He lays out his hands, as if expecting Windsong to put something there.
他激动地搓了搓手，像个等待糖果的单纯孩子。

Windsong: Of course. Remember the critter you found in the mine, Mr. Knut?
北方哨歌：当然。克努特先生，你还记得之前在矿场里挖出的魔精么?

Knut: Yes, you said it was called, em, a Hoi-Hoitoo.
克努特：你提到过它的名字，叫霍、霍伊……

Windsong: Hoituk, a subspecies of Kikituk. They live underground and feed on minerals.
北方哨歌：霍伊图克，基基图克的亚种。与基基图克相反，它们活跃于地底，喜食一切矿石。

Knut: That was around the time we had begun to run out of runium.
克努特：可那时候，咱们的卢恩矿石已经不剩多少了。

Windsong: Is that so? But they were still there, perhaps even more active than usual. That could only mean they were attracted by some other mineral or energy source, right?
北方哨歌：但它们并没有因此离去，反而愈发活跃了起来。显然，有别的东西吸引了它们，不是么?

Windsong: And even though I didn't find any further Hoituks during my research, I did find the Olga mutants, one of their close relatives.
北方哨歌：而在我之前的调查中，尽管没有发现它们的踪迹，但我确实找到了与它们关系密切的另一种魔精，奥尔加异种。

Windsong: Since they are social creatures, my discovery must prove the presence of some of these Hoituks, even if we cannot find them yet!
北方哨歌：而对于这类群居性魔精而言，这至少能佐证霍伊图克的存在！

The surrounding cheers swell again, prompting Evgeni to clear his throat.
四周的欢呼声越来越大，叶甫根尼干咳了两声。

Evgeni: But in the end, this is all just conjecture. Are we really going to waste all our time and money on your assumptions?
叶甫根尼：就为了一个缺乏实证的猜想，我们就得浪费无数人力去开凿冻土层叠的地底么？

Evgeni: Or can you prove it's something more than conjecture?
叶甫根尼：你的说法有完整的论证吗？

Windsong: I would call it a preliminary conclusion.
北方哨歌：这只是初步的结论。

Evgeni: But could it be endorsed by any authorities or proven theories?
叶甫根尼：它们是否得到任何一种官方学说的支持或引证？

Windsong: So far, no.
北方哨歌：目前……没有。

Evgeni: So then, it is little more than a fairy tale. Am I right?
叶甫根尼：所以，它们只是如同童话故事般的臆想与猜测，对么？

Windsong: I admit it's a gamble.
北方哨歌：我承认，这确实是场风险极高的豪赌……

Evgeni's now-infamous brow furrows once more.
叶甫根尼的眉头皱得更厉害了，嘴角挂着一丝冷笑。

Evgeni: It's never easy to dig, you know.
叶甫根尼：开采并不是件轻松的事情。

Evgeni: And Zeno has already withdrawn all their own equipment. All we have left in Rayashki are some outdated machines.
叶甫根尼：芝诺撤走了他们的挖掘设备，只给来亚什基留下了一堆过时的老家伙。

Evgeni: Besides, Ms. Windsong mentioned the critters. Maybe their presence there is some kind of proof, but they are themselves a danger.
叶甫根尼：而刚才北方哨歌女士提到的魔精……它们确实能作为证据，但无可否认的是，它们同样代表着危险。

Evgeni: It is obvious that there will be many more critters there than near the town.
叶甫根尼：那儿的魔精显然比小镇周边泛滥得更加厉害。

Evgeni: And you would have us waste time—perhaps even sacrifice our comrades—to pursue what could just be a fairy tale?
叶甫根尼：难道你们打算为了一个虚无缥缈的理论浪费时间，然后眼睁睁地看着同胞们牺牲在那儿吗？

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

He advances closer, step by step.
对方步步向前逼近。

Windsong's mouth opens silently. The look on his face far too familiar.
北方哨歌无声地张了张口，眼前的一切变得更熟悉了。

The moment before the collapse of ley line academia.
理线学轰然倒塌前的那一刻。

Yes, that is the look.
是的，正是这样的眼神。

The suffocating weight of questions and regrets.
质疑、痛惜，压得人几乎喘不过气来。

Examiner I: There is no doubt, the cost is simply too high.
考评员 I： 毫无疑问，这是个验证成本极高的理论。

Examiner I: Who would be foolish enough to dig some holes in the wild just to see if there are critter bones in there?
考评员 I： 有人乐意去那些荒郊野岭，再挖出几个深坑，来确认里面有没有什么魔精骨头之类的吗?

Harsh sounds of laughter come from everywhere and nowhere all at once.
四周有低低的窃笑声传来。

Examiner I: The answer is very clear. We don't need a new kind of geography mixed with arcanum. Let's save everybody some trouble.
考评员 I： 答案已经很清晰了，我们并不需要一个掺杂了神秘学的地理学分支，也没有必要浪费不必要的人力。

Examiner I: Conclusion: the application for Project: Ley Line should be rejected.
考评员 I： 关于理线学的正式立项申请：不予通过。

Examiner II: Agreed.
考评员 II： 附议。

Windsong: I ...
北方哨歌： 我……

Examiner II: Heh, even cranks can apply for research funds nowadays.
考评员 II： 呵，现在谁都想挂个乱七八糟的学科名，然后试图在这儿分一杯羹么?

She staggers back.
她踉跄着退了几步——

Bumping into something solid.
撞在某个结实的物体上。

A strange yet familiarly cool sensation lands on her shoulder.
某种陌生而熟悉的水润触感从肩膀后头传来。

Vila stands behind her.
不知什么时候，维拉站到了她的身后。

Vila: Keep moving, Comrade Windsong. Keep moving.
维拉： 往前走，北方哨歌同志——往前走。

Vila: The people of Rayashki don't back down in the face of their problems.
维拉： 遇到一丁点儿困难就退缩，这可不是来亚什基人的作为。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Vila: Whatever it is, we can fix it together, right?
维拉： 困难也好，问题也罢，我们都能一同解决它，对吧?

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Vila: I approve of Comrade Windsong's proposal.
维拉：我同意北方哨歌同志的计划。

Residents: Me too!
镇民众：我们也是——！

Her surging ship launches forward, plowing through stubbornness and doubt.
激荡的巨轮驶向前来，它压倒一切顽固与质疑——

Never looking back.
也弥补一切不甘与遗憾。

Windsong: That's right.
北方哨歌：没错！

Windsong: This is not a gamble or a fairy tale.
北方哨歌：这并不是孤注一掷的勇敢。

Her hands tremble as she opens her backpack.
她翻开背包的手甚至有些颤抖。

Windsong: Here's a ley line simulator.
北方哨歌：这是一台理线拟态仪。

Windsong: It can simulate the creatures on the ley energy map, so we can do further analysis.
北方哨歌：它能帮助理线师们模拟当下环境里生物的习性，让我们更从容地分析它们。

Vila: Is it able to simulate the critters, too?
维拉：它也能模拟那些张牙舞爪的魔精们么？

Windsong: Certainly. Simulating critters is lesson one in the ley line textbook.
北方哨歌：是的，对于一位成熟的理线师而言，模拟魔精只是简单的第一课。

Windsong: We can use the simulation to carry out targeted training against the critters.
北方哨歌：换而言之，我们同样能够用它来做一些应对魔精的训练。

Vila: Looks like the study of ley lines is more organized than I thought.
维拉：看来，理线学的探索并不莽撞……

Vila: Congratulations, Comrade Windsong. You will have the manpower you need.
维拉：恭喜你，北方哨歌同志，你获得了充足的人力。

Windsong turns as more and more fists are raised into the air.
北方哨歌转过身去，无数热切的拳头高举着。

Resident I: Turn it on, comrade!
镇民 I：快打开吧，同志！

Resident II: We can't wait!
镇民 II：咱们都迫不及待啦～

A deep breath, a glance to confirm that all is ready, then ...
北方哨歌点了点头，深吸了一口气。

click
“啪嗒。”

"Kikituk": *roars*
“基基图克”：&*% 吼……！

Evgeni: ...!
叶甫根尼： ——！

Evgeni instinctively positions himself in front of everyone.
叶甫根尼条件反射般地挡在所有人的前面。

Knut: Hahahaha, it's like digging the mine all over again!
克努特： 哈哈，这就像是回到了最开始垦荒的时候！

The Other Resident: That was the biggest achievement of my life!
普通镇民： 那可是能吹嘘一辈子的成绩～

Knut: Let's do this, comrades!
克努特： 加油干吧，同志们！

Knut: Digging like this is no easy work!
克努特： 重新开垦矿区可不是件轻松事。

They roll up their sleeves, pressing forward confidently.
人们挽起袖子，热烈地拥上前来。

Knut: Phew! That was one powerful blow. Hahahahaha!
克努特： 呼……刚才那一记可真有力，哈哈～

The square is now pocked by groups of disheveled workers, resting after their rigorous exertion.
广场上的人们东倒西歪，显然经过了一场强度颇高的锻炼。

Windsong's back is soaked, and her simulator creaks with stress.
北方哨歌的后背浸得湿透，拟态仪也不堪重负，吱呀作响。

Vila: I think we can draw our conclusions now.
维拉： 现在，我想我们能够得出结论了。

creak
“嘎吱——”

The old bench groans beneath her boots as she nimbly propels herself onto its narrow back.
老旧的长椅发出剧烈的呻吟，一双靴子踩上了最高处。

Vila: Everyone! We have to admit this is going to be a risky operation, but it's also our last chance.
维拉： 我们必须承认，这是一次危险而大胆的行动，但它同样是最后的机会。

Vila: To protect our land and our people!
维拉： 为了我们的土地不至沉睡，为了我们的同胞不必四分五裂。

Vila: We must explore the mine!
维拉： 我们必须得前往那片矿区。

Vila: There will be danger; yes, some of us may get hurt, but we may also find this new resource and save our Rayashki.
维拉： 当然，那儿也许有危险，也许有受伤，但同样可能有新的资源，有拯救来亚什基的希望。

Vila: For you, for me, for everyone!
维拉： 为了你，为了我，为了他、她、他们。

There is no cheer that rises to meet her. The only thing audible now is the distant sea breeze buffeting the shore.
四周静悄悄的，仿佛只能听见遥远彼岸寄来的风。

Vila: We can already expect that critters have occupied the mine. We'll just have to work together to drive them away!
维拉： 魔精们占领了矿区，那我们就协力打败它们！

Vila: We dug this mine with our old machines once, and we'll do it again!
维拉： 就算只有老旧的设备，我们也能重新挖掘矿区——！

Vila: This is how we've made it so far.
维拉： 我们正是如此前行至今。

The crowd rises, pulling in together. Windsong looks up and outward.
北方哨歌无声地抬起头来，像是在见证一面飞扬的旗帜。

Knut: However old they are now, they will always be our children, right?
克努特： 再老古董的钢铁家伙们，不也是我们的孩子吗?

Knut: Yuri, you are good at assembling, huh? Nikita, you're going to be busy with the engines. Valeriya, we need you for the screws!
克努特： 尤里，你擅长组装零件，对吧？——尼基塔，引擎这块可有的你忙了……瓦列里娅，小螺丝的设计少不了你!

Residents: ...
镇民众： ……

More and more stars light up.
越来越多的星星亮了起来。

They outshine the twinkling snow.
像是点亮了整片雪原。

8#1
8#1

从现实到现实 · 1/2
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Days Later
数天后

Children's Square, Rayashki
来亚什基·儿童广场

Nina: Ms. Vila, they've been doing strange things.
尼娜： 维拉老师，大人们似乎一直在做奇怪的事。

Pyotr: Father took out a lot of old books, and he spends most of his time looking over his blueprints now. He said, "They will be the key to saving the town."
彼得森： 父亲搬出了好多旧书，他每天晚上都在摆弄螺丝和图纸。他告诉我：“这些都是拯救小镇的关键。”

Pyotr: Shame I can't read those books or help with anything.
彼得森： 可是，我看不明白那些书，也帮不上大人的忙……

Nina: My dad was acting strange, too. He started fiddling with the bottles from under his bed again.
尼娜： 我的爸爸也是，他又开始捣鼓那些藏在床底下的玻璃瓶了。

Nina: But Mom didn't scold him this time. She even took out some of her treasures from the cabinet.
尼娜： 不过这次，妈妈没有再拧他的耳朵，还拿出了锁在几个柜子里的珍藏宝贝……

Nina: Reindeer horn, Noisy Birch sap, Golden-Teeth Seal whiskers.
尼娜： 驯鹿的断角、胡闹桦木的黏液、金齿海豹的胡须……

Nina: Dad said his potions would keep everyone energetic for a whole day.
尼娜： 爸爸说，调制出来的药剂能让人一整天都充满力气。

Pyotr: Even Mr. Miser took out his wand from the safe box!
彼得森： 就连吝啬鬼叔叔都拿出了他锁在箱子里的宝贝术杖呢！

The children cluster around Vila, pleading for answers.
孩子们凑在维拉的身边，好奇与疑惑写满了每一张稚嫩的脸。

Vila: Heh heh.
维拉： 呵呵……

Vila is about to speak when hurried laboring footsteps interrupt her.
维拉刚想说些什么，急匆匆的脚步声打断了她。

Patrik: Move, kids.
帕特里基： 让一让，孩子们～

Patrik: Good luck, Comrade Vila.
帕特里基： 祝健康，维拉同志。

Regrettably, his march cannot proceed.
遗憾的是，这支来自于公共食堂的急行军显然没能如愿行进。

As he's now become the children's newest focus.
他们成了孩子们的新目标。

Nina: Mr. Patrik.
尼娜： 帕特里基先生……

Nina: Are you doing strange things, too?
尼娜： 您也在做奇怪的事吗?

The book bag on his shoulder cannot elude the children's scrutiny.
肩上扛着的书袋显然逃不过孩子们的目光。

It is not a cookbook he carries, but something far weightier.
它并非菜谱，而是某些更厚重的东西。

Nina: How to Use and Maintain Model Э-050, Operation Manual of Model CK-1562 ...
尼娜： 《Э-050 型挖掘机的使用及维修说明》《CK-1562 型起重机操作指南》……

Nina: These dusty books ... They look older than me!
尼娜： 上面有好多灰尘……它们看上去比我的年纪还要大呢～

Patrik: Hahaha, these "old friends" are our textbooks.
帕特里基： 哈哈，这些“老古董”可都是我们的学习资料。

Pasono: Do adults take exams, too?
帕索诺： 大人们也要考试吗……?

Patrik: We're doing something far more important than exams, kids.
帕特里基： 这可比考试重要得多啦，孩子们。

Patrik: We haven't used these old fellas since Zeno brought the new ones. Most of our comrades don't know how to operate them.
帕特里基： 自打芝诺带来了更新的设备，这些久经沙场的老将很久都没派上用场了。大部分工人同志们对它们相当陌生。

Patrik: Now is the time to put them back into use. Comrade Knut has been teaching us how to use these "outdated" technologies.
帕特里基： 但现在，是时候拣起它们了。克努特同志每天都在组织我们学习这些“过时”的技术呢……

Vila: That's right. All the adults have been divided into many groups.
维拉： 是的，大人们被分成了很多个小组。

Vila: Knut is leader of the engineering group, and Pasono's uncle is in the investigation group, while Nina's father has joined the potion group.
维拉： 克努特带领着工程小组，帕索诺的叔叔加入了调查队。而尼娜的爸爸，则是魔药恢复小组的一员。

Vila: All of them take part in the critter combat training at dusk every day, and we share our combat experience with each other.
维拉： 每天傍晚，所有人都得参加模拟的魔精训练，分享对付它们的经验。

Vila: And everyone is working hard to explore the mine.
维拉： 为了重新开发我们的矿区，每一个人都在为之努力。

The children burst into questions, seeking the current whereabouts and activity of every single adult they can think of.
孩子们高声地询问着，寻求身边的每一位大人的去向。

Patrik: Haha! We will be able to live on our own without Zeno!
帕特里基： 哈哈～没有芝诺，咱们靠自己也能凿出一片天来。

Pyotr: Ms. Vila, I want the town to be proud of me, too!
彼得森： 维拉老师，我也想成为小镇的骄傲！

Nina: Is there anything that we can do?
尼娜： ……我们能做些什么呢?

Pasono: I have lots of metal toy trains. Can we make components out of them?
帕索诺： 我有很多铁皮列车的玩具，它们能变成大机器人的零件吗?

Pasono: They can spin and whistle like a mine cart!
帕索诺： 它们也会打转……还会像矿车一样呜呜响！

Vila: That's a great idea. I'm sure it will inspire everyone.
维拉： 这是个很棒的想法，它一定能鼓舞更多人。

Pyotr: No! Let them use mine first!
彼得森： 不行，先用我的！

Hands shoot up among the children, each a ready volunteer.
孩子们争先恐后地举手，像是一位位勇敢的战士。

Patrik: Calm down, children. I know you want to do your bit.
帕特里基： 别着急，孩子们……现在理应是我们付出的时候。

Patrik: But our future needs you.
帕特里基： 但未来，总归是你们的。

Patrik: Now, your job is to study hard, so Rayashki can rely on you in the future.
帕特里基： 你们现在的工作，就是好好学习，成为来亚什基未来的支柱。

Patrik: Understand?
帕特里基： 明白了吗?

Nina: Oh. What about Avgust? We can't find him.
尼娜： 可是，阿夫西维同学呢？我们都找不到他……

Nina: He'll be so sad if he doesn't get to have a job too.
尼娜： 如果他没有得到自己的工作，他一定会很难过。

Vila: *chuckles*
维拉： 呵呵～

Vila: Don't worry, Nina. He's helping the town in his own way.
维拉： 别担心，小尼娜……他也在为小镇帮忙，以他的方式。

Abandoned Mine, Rayashki
来亚什基·废弃矿区

Kikituk: *roars*
基基图克： &*%# 吱——！

Avgust: Ears!
阿夫西维： 耳朵！

A gunshot sounds, and a Kikituk swiftly scurries away.
一声枪响后，一只基基图克迅速地逃窜开来。

Kikituk: *roars*
基基图克： 呜*/#……

Avgust: Whiskers!
阿夫西维： 胡须！

The boy is a conductor of a symphony of arms.
而指挥家乐此不疲。

Gunfire and the noise of battle follow in the wake of the little sunflower's hands.
接连不断的振鸣，像是一首宛转而悠扬的乐章。

Resident I: It's only been a few months. Can't believe the monsters have already occupied the whole place.
镇民 Ⅰ： 真不敢想象，这才几个月的功夫，这儿就彻底成了那群怪物们的游乐场。

Resident II: Well, not a problem as long as we got our mischievous little comrade. He always knows exactly where they will come out.
镇民 Ⅱ： 哈哈～多亏了这位古灵精怪的小同志，他总能发现那些不知从哪窜出来的小怪物们。

Resident I: Things wouldn't have gone nearly as smoothly without him.
镇民 Ⅰ： 不然的话，咱们的垦荒队可没法推进得这么顺利。

Resident II: I would never have believed he could do this if Comrade Windsong hadn't endorsed him.
镇民 Ⅱ： 要不是北方哨歌同志打包票，真不敢相信他还有这样的才能。

Resident I: "Never underestimate any of our comrades, big or small." Do I need to repeat that again?
镇民 Ⅰ： “别小瞧任何一位同志”，这话可不用我再复述了吧……？

Of course, Avgust is securely guarded, despite his dangerous mission.
阿夫西维被紧紧地护在当中。

Windsong: Well done, Avgust. You protected everyone.
北方哨歌： 你做得很好，阿夫西维……你保护了大家。

Avgust: Protected?
阿夫西维： 保护……？

Avgust: But I was just teaching our monster friends how to dance right. They are slow learners.
阿夫西维： 可我明明在教授那些跳错舞步的坏朋友呀……它们学得可真慢，一点儿也不聪明。

Windsong: Yes, that's what we want you to do.
北方哨歌： 是的，这正是你要做的——

She struggles to match her words to her little friend's own imaginative interpretations.
北方哨歌努力组织措辞，试图跟上对方的理解。

Windsong: A performance with the Kikituks.
北方哨歌：一场与基基图克们的联合演出。

Windsong: Your job is to tell which critter, emm, I mean, which friend, is dancing wrong.
北方哨歌：你的任务是，指出每一个掉队的魔精……咳，朋友的不足之处。

Windsong: That's your talent, isn't it? Just like you showed us before!
北方哨歌：你擅长这个，不是么？像在旅馆时一样！

Avgust: Oh!
阿夫西维：噢——！

Avgust: But, what if they dance right?
阿夫西维：可是，如果它们做得很好呢？

Windsong: Mmm.
北方哨歌：嗯……？

Avgust: Then, they deserve some Alenka chocolate, don't they?
阿夫西维：那它们应该得到奖励，对吧？

Indeed, for all those scattered, many more come slinking in behind them.
是的，总有聪明的魔精能够跟上队伍。

They shadow every move, intent on repelling their intruders.
它们如影随形，试图赶走所有入侵者。

Avgust: Comrade Sergiyan, our new friend is right beside your boots. I think he is hoping to kiss them. Will you dance with him?
阿夫西维：谢尔吉同志，那位新朋友正在你的脚下……它希望亲吻你的靴子，你愿意和它跳舞吗？

The Other Resident: What?
普通镇民：……什么？

Windsong: Watch out!
北方哨歌：小心！

Kikituk: *roars*
基基图克：吼吼 &*%#——！

加快脚步
Walk faster 小径

We should take these components to the appropriate comrade. With my years of experience in mining, I can assure you that they are still usable and will be put to good use.
镇民 I：咱们得把找到的零件拿给哪位同志瞧瞧……我敢拿这么些年头的矿工经验担保，它们还能派上用场，肯定的！

Maybe they contain traces of runium, explaining their pristine appearance. In these times of steel shortages, every little contribution counts ...
镇民 I：说不定里头是加了些卢恩矿石，瞧上去才崭新着。总之，钢材紧缺的时候，多找一点是一点……

I imagine Comrade Vila is with the children right now, making sure they don't miss their lessons.
镇民 II：维拉同志这会儿大概和孩子们在一起，她可不会允许他们落下课程。

Could it be that the miners have returned to the abandoned mine? Maybe we should take the shorter route to the hotel and let Comrade Evgeni investigate.
镇民 Ⅱ： 在废矿忙活的同志们兴许回来了呢？我看，我们还是往旅馆那边赶近路，让叶甫根尼同志来瞧个明白。

Alright, let's do that.
镇民 Ⅰ： 行，就听你的。

...
……

Shh, see those people walking in front of the hotel? Are they from Zeno? Let's not talk about them behind their backs.
镇民 Ⅰ： 喂，你瞧。那几个是芝诺的家伙吗？走在旅馆前面的——嘘，得小点声。咱们这可是在背后议论别人。

Yeah, I see them. Isn't Comrade Evgeni negotiating with Zeno? They must be looking for him.
镇民 Ⅱ： 瞧见了，我瞧着是挺像。叶甫根尼同志不是在和芝诺谈判吗？肯定是找他的。

They left. It looks like Comrade Evgeni isn't there. We'll have to come back later.
镇民 Ⅰ： 他们走了，看样子叶甫根尼同志不在。我们得晚点来。

Tomorrow or the day after, perhaps.
镇民 Ⅱ： 那就明天，或者后天。

...
……

Honestly, this is not the way I want to leave this town.
镇民 Ⅱ： ……老实说，让我就这么撤离镇子，我是不愿意。

Ugh, I still have the scars from shoveling snow on my legs, and we just fixed the windows at home. Who wants to leave just like that?
镇民 Ⅰ： 呿，头些年铲雪落的疤还在我腿上，家里边也才补过窗户，说走，谁愿意！

But what Comrade Evgeni said was reasonable, and he is always truthful ...
镇民 Ⅱ： 但叶甫根尼同志说的是有些道理，他向来讲实话……

You're afraid he'll hear you! We may be close to the meeting room, but—
镇民 Ⅰ： 你是怕他听着啦！这儿离会议室是挺近，但——

I'm not afraid, or I wouldn't have made the decision to come here. We weren't afraid in the pioneer days either. What Comrade Vila says is exactly what everyone said back then.
镇民 Ⅱ： 不不，我要是怕什么，当初就不会来这边！拓荒咱们都没怕过，我是想说，维拉同志的话正像是大伙儿搁拓荒那时候说的。

The town has been built, and we have been living here for a while now. Our days are not as hectic as they used to be, but it is invigorating to see the resurgence of the pioneer spirit after such a long time!
镇民 Ⅱ： 镇子建起来了，住得久了，没像以前那样忙得慌了。这还是头回拿出当时的干劲，挺叫人高兴！

Hey, alright! That's the attitude we need! If we walk a little faster, we can still make it back to work on time!
镇民 Ⅰ： 嗨，行！那再加把劲，走快些还赶得上回去干活！

Walk faster
加快脚步

从现实到现实 · 2/2
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zap
“刺啦——”

The Other Resident: Ah!
普通镇民： 唔……

Evgeni: Back off!
叶甫根尼： 闪开！

Evgeni surges forward, white light piercing the last Kikituk's nostrils.
叶甫根尼冲上前来，白光穿过了最后一只基基图克的鼻腔。

Kikituk: ...!
基基图克： ——！

Evgeni pushes the carcass aside, allowing blood to drip onto the snow.
叶甫根尼甩开对方的尸体，任由鲜血滴落在雪地之上。

He fixes intently on Windsong.
他直勾勾地盯着北方哨歌。

Evgeni: There are many more critters than we can deal with here.
叶甫根尼： 这儿的魔精数量显然超出了我们的应付能力。

Evgeni: Many of us are injured. We must retreat.
叶甫根尼： 很多人受伤了——我们必须撤出这里。

Faint moans rise from a stretcher, bandages and bloodstains accumulating in a small mound on the snow.
细微的呻吟声从担架上传来，绷带与血渍在雪地上堆成了一座小山。

Knut: We made the decision to come here together, Comrade Evgeni.
克努特： 这可是我们所有人的决定，叶甫根尼同志。

Knut: We are so close to the depths. We must not give up now!
克努特： 我们距离那片黑乎乎的地方越来越近了，可不能在这时候放弃！

The Other Resident: Hiss, ah! I know everyone's wounded, but look how far we've gone. It's been worth it, don't you think?
普通镇民： 嘶……尽管大伙身上都挂了彩，但我们可不是毫无收获的，不是么？

Windsong: This is all my fault. I'm sorry.
北方哨歌： 这是我的责任。

Knut: Don't be, Comrade Windsong. You've given us a workable plan and helped us recognize our little comrade's potential, no?
克努特： 别这么说，北方哨歌同志……你为我们提供了一个切实可行的方向，甚至还为我们发掘了一位同志的潜力，对吧！

He ruffles Avgust's head.
他摸了摸阿夫西维的脑袋。

Evgeni: He's only a child.
叶甫根尼： 无论如何，他只是个孩子。

Knut: He's one of us, Comrade Evgeni. I will keep him safe.
克努特： 他同样是我们的一份子，叶甫根尼同志。我们会照顾好他的。

Knut: We aren't just digging a mine now.
克努特： 这可不是简单的垦荒……

Knut: If we manage to find this resource, no one will have to leave, and we can continue to live together, right?
克努特： 如果我们成功了，那大伙就不用离开这儿，不必担心无家可归，也不需要放弃任何一个人，不是么？

Evgeni: Hmph!
叶甫根尼： 哼……

Scattered applause burst up like firecrackers, until it becomes a thundering display.
周围响起了稀稀拉拉的掌声，而后像抛入干草堆的火苗，迅速地蔓延开来。

Rifles, refurbished and polished, rise in harmony with pickaxes and tools.
一杆杆翻新打磨的步枪，它们与矿锄合奏，像是一首激昂的进行曲。

Knut: These wounds are nothing compared to the glory of our future.
克努特： 为了咱们所有人，这些伤根本算不上什么。

Evgeni: Again, I think this is a foolish idea.
叶甫根尼： 我重申一次，我一点儿也不支持你们的莽撞。

He says nothing else, then turns to leave without looking back.
他把脚下的雪块踩得粉碎，头也不回地离开了。

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌： ……！

8#1
8#1

哦草根，草根
O, Grass-Roots FR-15

Evgeni: It's me.
叶甫根尼： 是我。

Windsong: Oh, you!
北方哨歌： 噢——是你！

Evgeni: I want to talk.
叶甫根尼： 我想和你谈谈。

Hotel, Rayashki
来亚什基·旅馆

Windsong: I was just about to look for you, Comrade Evgeni. I've found more details!
北方哨歌： 你来得正好，叶甫根尼同志，我找到了更详细的资料！

Windsong: Here.
北方哨歌： 它们在这儿……

Windsong turns away and begins to search through the mountainous piles of documents.
北方哨歌背过身去，开始翻找如山的资料堆。

Windsong: Trust me, they will ease your mind, more or less.
北方哨歌： 相信我，这一定能解除你的顾虑……至少一小部分。

A cold wind rushes between them through the open window.
一阵冷冽的风突兀地袭来。

Evgeni: Let's skip to the point.
叶甫根尼：直入正题吧——

Evgeni: I want you to stop your research.
叶甫根尼：我希望你能终止目前的研究。

Windsong: What?
北方哨歌：……什么?

Evgeni: Our exploration has only just started, yet many of our people have already been hurt.
叶甫根尼：开垦矿区已经让许多人受伤了，而这只是个开始。

Evgeni: Can you promise there won't be further injuries, or worse, before we've found this fairy-tale treasure?
叶甫根尼：你能保证未来不会有人因此牺牲么?

Evgeni: Your so-called new resource is still unconfirmed, yet the price we've paid looking for it is already mounting. We had other options, safer options for all of us.
叶甫根尼：你所称的新资源只是个未知数，而我们不得不为之支付高昂的代价……他们本应在更好的地方参与建设。

The snow has turned to wet rain; it splashes up from the windowsill and on to her as they speak.
雨点密密麻麻地淋了下来，把北方哨歌浇了个通透。

Windsong: We just need to be better prepared. We will arm ourselves with more knowledge for next time.
北方哨歌：我们会用更充分的知识武装自己……

Evgeni: I know what you're after here: the study of ley lines, right?
叶甫根尼：我理解你的诉求，为了你的理线学，是么?

Evgeni: The people here may be enthusiastic, but they are only laymen. I've spoken with someone who can help you far more.
叶甫根尼：比起这儿只有满腔热情的门外汉，我为你找来了更合适的人选。

The unhurried steps of expensive boots mark an unfortunately familiar guest.
不紧不慢的脚步声踏入了房门。

Bertolt: It is good to see you, Ms. Windsong.
贝托尔特：很高兴见到你，北方哨歌女士。

Bertolt: Our proud scholar of a budding, if still informal, school.
贝托尔特：或者说，一位来自非正式学科的敏锐学者。

His expression is genuine and surprised, as though this is the first time they've ever met.
他的面庞显得真诚而惊喜，就像是他们从来没见过似的。

Windsong: And you, the Big Shot from Zeno. Should I feel flattered you stopped by?
北方哨歌：你好，芝诺的大人物先生……不得不说，你的态度真让人受宠若惊。

He feigns obliviousness to Windsong's teasing.
对方像是根本没意识到北方哨歌刻意的揶揄。

Bertolt: I read your files, as Mr. Evgeni suggested.
贝托尔特：在叶甫根尼先生的强烈要求下，我向芝诺申请调阅了你的详细资料。

Bertolt: You know already that Zeno has investigated many arcane cases and been deployed to many places related to arcanum, but we have never met anyone quite as obsessive in their study as you are.
贝托尔特：芝诺追踪过许多神秘现象，也勘察过不少的神秘学环境，但从未见过对神秘现象的研究如此执着的年轻人。

Windsong: What now? Have the big shots decided they are going to trust my studies?
北方哨歌：那现在呢？……高高在上的大人物打算信任一门乡野学派了？

Bertolt smiles. He always smiles, brimming with all the joy of a crocodile.
贝托尔特不置可否地笑了笑。

Bertolt: Well, while I might admire your perseverance myself, no, they're not convinced.
贝托尔特：尽管我个人十分欣赏你的坚持，但暂时还不行。

Bertolt: We just wonder what you and your school have gained from this long journey?
贝托尔特：我更好奇的是，遍布全世界的足迹为你和你的学派带来了什么收获吗？

He looks past her, assessing the mounds of scattered papers.
他的目光穿过北方哨歌，打量着她身后散落一地的资料与纸张。

Windsong: Enough with the crap.
北方哨歌：说正事吧。

Bertolt: As you wish. First, I believe you owe Comrade Evgeni some thanks.
贝托尔特：感谢叶甫根尼同志吧～

Windsong: Huh?
北方哨歌：……？

A fresh letter of recommendation is handed to Windsong.
一封崭新的推荐信递到了北方哨歌的手上。

Bertolt: The less than satisfactory results from your study may not have earned this letter from Zeno, but Comrade Evgeni insisted on us offering it to you.
贝托尔特：尽管你的成果在芝诺看来并不足够，但叶甫根尼同志主动将自己的名额出让给你。

Bertolt: Once you have our recommendation, you will be able to communicate with all the renowned scholars in our lab. Your long wait for recognition will be over. A once-in-a-lifetime opportunity.
贝托尔特：在他的举荐下，你获得了一个难得的新机会——芝诺的试验场地，与知名学者的交流机会，一封正式的盖有芝诺印章的推荐信。

His tone is calm. His victory is assured.
他的语气不紧不慢，仿佛胜券在握。

Evgeni: All I ask is stop this farce.
叶甫根尼：我唯一的要求是……你能放弃这场不切实际的闹剧。

Windsong: Heh!
北方哨歌：……

Windsong: Well, I am so grateful. I think I might cry.
北方哨歌：真让人感激涕零……

Windsong: All we have to do is wait for Zeno's grace to be bestowed on us. We should be moved to tears by your mercy, no?
北方哨歌：大家一起巴巴地望着，等着芝诺大发慈悲，为我们分好一个个去处，然后我们再为此滴下几滴热泪来，对么？

Bertolt: Putting aside your sarcasm, I would suggest you consider the danger of throwing away this opportunity.
贝托尔特：撇去你发言中那些情绪化的成分，我不认为这一选择有什么问题。

Bertolt: You are wasting time, effort, maybe even lives on some foolish wild goose chase. We can offer the people here a much safer and more feasible way forward. Don't you see?
贝托尔特：相比于前赴后继地扑倒在可能性不大的矿区，让所有的精英都能走上正轨，这有什么问题吗?

Bertolt raises an eyebrow. He presents his case less as reason than as indisputable truth.
贝托尔特挑了挑眉，像是在宣布一条颠扑不破的社会真理。

Windsong: And what about Rayashki?
北方哨歌：那来亚什基呢……?

He looks at her pitifully.
对方古怪地看了她几眼。

Bertolt: All things come to an end. It will disappear quietly, overtaken by the wilds of this land, when the time comes.
贝托尔特：对于一些过时之物而言，悄无声息的消失是最好的结局。

Bertolt: At least, it may leave a small place in the historical records.
贝托尔特：……当然，它们将会留在历史长河中的某个角落，不是么?

Bertolt: No offense intended, Mr. Evgeni.
贝托尔特：无意冒犯，叶甫根尼先生。

Evgeni: We cannot solve the problems we're having without Zeno's help.
叶甫根尼：……如果得不到芝诺的帮助，我们显然无法解决当下的所有问题。

Windsong: All of these problems will be solved as long as we find this new resource.
北方哨歌：只要找到新的资源，一切的问题都会迎刃而解——

Bertolt: Ahem! I'm afraid you're mistaken, Ms. Windsong.
贝托尔特：咳咳——你误会了，北方哨歌女士。

Bertolt: As far as Zeno is concerned, the value of this land is exhausted, fairy-tale resources notwithstanding. Once we've transferred the arcanists away, Rayashki will be abandoned.
贝托尔特：这片土地对于芝诺的意义在于其中的神秘学家，而不是一个孤零零的空壳。送走所有的镇民后，我们便会将这儿彻底封闭。

The crocodile smile cracks again, growing annoyed at his now long-overdue victory.
他终于露出了些许真实的愠怒。

Bertolt: We are aware of the danger that staying here poses to these people, and it is our responsibility to save them. Whether they wish to resist us or not. That's the only reason for our decision, understand?
贝托尔特：这是出于芝诺的责任感与危机意识，而非什么别的可能性，你明白了吗?

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌：——!

Windsong sets down the ley energy chart, the culmination of her countless efforts, without saying a word.
北方哨歌放下了那张凝聚着无数人心血的地脉能量图，什么也没说。

Bertolt: Let's be practical.
贝托尔特：还是关注些更现实的问题吧～

Bertolt: Zeno has many outstanding young people, a strong academic atmosphere, a better future. You will get your opportunity to revive your school of ley lines, if you pass the exam.
贝托尔特：芝诺有许多出色的年轻人，有良好的环境……也有更好的未来。如果你能通过考核，你就能得到一个真正重振理线学的机会。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Her fingers press onto the paper, tracing a newly embossed seal.
她的手指按在那张信纸上，手指从新印的纹章上缓缓划过。

The "carrot" is sweeter and more fragrant than before.
一根比之前更为甘甜与芳香的“胡萝卜”，它无声地倒映在北方哨歌的瞳孔中。

How long now had she imagined this moment?
在过去的许多时间里，她曾不止一次地想象过类似的画面。

In dim, stuffy basements, in underpaid editorial offices, under faceless, nameless, scrutinizing gazes.
在幽闭而沉闷的地下室里，在薪水微薄的编辑社里，在无数促狭而冷冽的目光里。

Bertolt: This will be a better choice for all of you.
贝托尔特：这是为了你们所有人好。

Windsong: Haha.
北方哨歌：呵……

Windsong: Mr. Big Shot, could you use your rusted brain to think of a more noble reason than consumerism and elitism?
北方哨歌：这位高不可攀的先生，放下你那被消费主义和精英主义彻底销蚀掉的脑袋瓜，你就没理解到点更高尚的原因吗?

Windsong: Do you really think our desire for a better life is the only reason why we refuse to leave?
北方哨歌：我们不愿放弃这里，难道仅仅是因为对个人优渥生活的向往?

Windsong: You used ordinary people as a stepping stone to power and privilege, and even now you take our sacrifices for granted.
北方哨歌：你们理所当然地踩着普通的人们跃升，将我们这样的草根芦苇视为理所当然的代价。

Bertolt: Reality is cruel: not you, not Rayashki, and not even Zeno can save everyone. You will have to deal with that.
贝托尔特：你得面对这个残酷的现实，尽管是芝诺，我们也没法拯救所有人。

Bertolt: You should take what is to come as an inevitable optimization of our society's development.
贝托尔特：倒不如说，这是一种社会运转中必然发生的自我优化。

Windsong: I know. Life may still get harder even if we find this new resource.
北方哨歌：是的，就算找到了新的资源，他们也不得不面临着更贫乏的生活、更艰难的前路。

Windsong: So what?
北方哨歌：但那又如何呢?

The defiance in her voice reignites her long-lost courage.
她终于拾回了某种久违的勇敢。

Windsong: Your brand of elitism may have invaded every corner of the world, but not this town, not yet.
北方哨歌：精英主义的旗帜插满了一切随处可见的角落，但至少它还没能打败这儿。

Bertolt: I see, most scholars like you hold the same naivete.
贝托尔特：我理解你，草根学者大都保有如此朴素的认知。

Windsong: They refuse to leave any of their "comrades" behind, even if the price is their own future.
北方哨歌：他们不愿抛下任何一个同胞，不愿为个人的美好未来而放弃没能搭上新快艇的同胞们。

Evgeni: ...
叶甫根尼：……

Windsong: What we would sacrifice ourselves for is not the study of ley lines, or any other personal goals.
北方哨歌：让各位前赴后继的并非理线学，也绝非某人的个人理想。

Windsong: But our dream to thrive together!
北方哨歌：——而是千千万万个携手并进的夙愿。

Windsong: To live in a bright future we all can share!
北方哨歌：一个光明的未来。

Windsong: As for this ...
北方哨歌：至于这个……

She scrunches up his gaudy recommendation.
她卷起了那张精致的推荐信。

Windsong: I don't need it.
北方哨歌：我不再需要它了。

Bertolt: ...!
贝托尔特：……！

Bertolt: *spits* A leopard never changes its spots.
贝托尔特：呸——草根永远都是草根。

Bertolt leaves his final words hanging in the room, departing without looking back.
贝托尔特丢下最后一句话，头也不回地离开了。

The crumpled letter rolls out of the window. It lands in the snow, slowly being covered until there is no trace of it left.
揉皱的信轻飘飘地飞出了窗外，它落在窗外连绵的大雪中，消失得无影无踪。

Will things get better?
一切会变得更好么？

Windsong, too preoccupied to care, slumps back in her chair, gulping in the crisp air of her new world.
北方哨歌无暇他顾，她瘫坐在椅子上，大口地汲取着新新世界的空气。

Evgeni: I envy your innocence, Ms. Windsong.
叶甫根尼：……我很羡慕你的单纯，北方哨歌姑娘。

Evgeni: For many years, I believed that our mission was to change the world.
叶甫根尼：在过去的许多年里，我也曾相信过我们是历史性的人物，肩负着改造世界的重大使命。

Evgeni: But when I looked up, the gate to the new world was already closed. Little Rayashki just coasted along, and I tried to keep everything the way it was.
叶甫根尼：当我抬头看的时候，新世界的大门已经关闭了。来亚什基在惯性中继续向前，我试图维护现在的一切……

Evgeni: But I failed.
叶甫根尼：但我失败了。

Evgeni: Rayashki is doomed. All our efforts, our will, our dreams—nothing can change the creeping reality. We attempted to achieve something meaningful, something that could make history, but ...
叶甫根尼：来亚什基已经走上一条注定的路，与所有的努力无关，与我们是否有着坚决的意志无关。我们曾试图生产一个真正的、具有历史意义的东西，但……

Evgeni strains to lift his head, his face obscured in a kind of darkness beyond the reach of light.
叶甫根尼努力昂首，他的面庞隐没在灯光照不到的黑暗里，看不清表情。

Evgeni: The spirit of the times stands against what we are building here, not just Zeno, but the whole world.
叶甫根尼：不仅是芝诺，对于整个世界而言，保守才是当今的主流。

Evgeni: That's what reality is like: boring, cruel, disappointing.
叶甫根尼：现实正是这样，寡淡无味，了无生趣，令所有人失望。

The scene falls into a wordless, motionless quiet.
场面一时间陷入了无言的沉默。

After a long while, Windsong rises.
许久，北方哨歌终于慢腾腾地直起身子。

She has shed all other burdens, and the tantalizing carrot is gone.
她终于蜕去了沉甸甸的外壳，甩开了那颗本就不属于她的胡萝卜。

Windsong: You are too pessimistic, Comrade Evgeni.
北方哨歌：你太悲观了，叶甫根尼同志。

Evgeni: Huh?
叶甫根尼：……?

Windsong: Zeno has tried to recruit me several times. Do you know what I've learned from all their efforts?
北方哨歌：芝诺如此反常的积极招徕让我至少确定了一件事。

Windsong: They don't want us to explore that mine.
北方哨歌：——他们不希望我们继续下去。

Windsong: They belittled our efforts, offered pity for Rayashki, and then planned out a promising future for us.
北方哨歌：他们努力地贬低我们，为来亚什基的灰暗前路而痛惜，为我们谋划了一条无比远大而光明的前程。

Windsong: Yet they didn't give us a hand, even when our people were injured or died.
北方哨歌：可哪怕有人负伤，甚至因此牺牲——他们也不愿意为来亚什基提供任何多余的帮助。

Windsong: Do you really think they are so eager to stop us just because they don't want any more sacrifices?
北方哨歌：难道高高在上的老爷们是出于慈悲的关怀，才如此迫切地希望我们停止探索吗……?

Evgeni: ...!
叶甫根尼：——!

Windsong: Of course not, my friend.
北方哨歌：当然不是，我的朋友。

Windsong: A lesson I learned from living in their society ...
北方哨歌：就我这些年摸爬滚打得出的经验而言……

Windsong: Never do what your enemies want you to do.
北方哨歌：——永远别做让你的敌人满意的事。

She grasps his shoulder, giving it a shake to pull him up to his senses.
她用力地拍了拍对方的肩膀，陌生而熟悉的狡黠又回到了她的脸上。

Windsong: Zeno is afraid of us.
北方哨歌：芝诺在害怕我们——

Windsong: They are afraid that we may discover a new kindling to relight our fire, that we may burn so brightly that we grow out from their control to create our own future.
北方哨歌：他们害怕我们找到新的火种，害怕我们不受蛊惑，拥有只属于我们的、他们无法操控的未来。

Evgeni: You ...
叶甫根尼：你……

Windsong: But they can't have it their way. Rayashki belongs to us, as does the future!
北方哨歌：可他们战胜不了我们——来亚什基是我们的，未来也是我们的！

Faint flickers of that fire seem to be there, somewhere in the man before her.
那团早已燃尽的灰似乎又冒出了些微火星。

Evgeni looks up with a complex expression.
叶甫根尼神色复杂地昂起头来。

Evgeni: I, I will give it some thought, Ms. Wi- ... Comrade Windsong.
叶甫根尼：我会慎重考虑你的看法，北方哨歌……同志。

8#1
8#1

分歧点
Point of Divergence 小径

Hello, gentlemen.
贝托尔特：……你们好，先生们。

Hello, comrade of Zeno.
镇民 Ⅰ：您好，芝诺的同志。

Comrade.
镇民 Ⅱ：您好，同志。

If you're here to see Comrade Evgeni, we can wait a little. Or is there something else important you'd like to discuss?
镇民 Ⅱ：如果您是来找叶甫根尼同志，我们可以一同等一会儿。或者，您有其他重要的事?

We talked, and Ms. Windsong was there.
贝托尔特：我们聊过了，北方哨歌女士也在。

Comrade Evgeni is doing what's best for everyone, we all know that. But I'll tell you, I personally don't want to leave this place. Even if he ...
镇民 Ⅰ：叶甫根尼同志是为大伙儿好，咱们都知道。但——跟您说吧，我个人是不想离开这地方的。即使他——

No, the lady turned down my proposal. And Comrade Evgeni didn't seem too invested in it either.
贝托尔特：不，那位女士拒绝了我的提议。而叶甫根尼同志看上去也不够坚定。

Isn't Zeno's help good news for all of you?
贝托尔特：芝诺的援助对你们来说难道不是个好消息吗?

I can't comprehend the reasoning behind rejecting an abundance of food, a suitable climate, and comfortable housing.
贝托尔特：我不明白，和供应充足的食物、适宜的气候还有舒适的房屋作对，究竟能有什么好处。

It's not easy to leave something you've built with your own hands, comrade. I doubt you've ever experienced living in a home you built yourself, let alone living in this way!
镇民 Ⅰ： 丢下亲手造出来的东西不是件简单的事，同志！您恐怕从没住过自己盖的屋子，也没有这样生活过！

Chances are you have never even touched freshly mined ore in your life!
镇民 Ⅱ： 我想您甚至都没摸过刚采出来的矿石！

That's true, gentlemen. But why do you insist on doing everything yourself?
贝托尔特： 的确如此，两位先生。为何你们这样执着于亲力亲为?

It seems that our conversation has come to an end. I will stay here until Evgeni arrives and gives an answer, which should be soon.
贝托尔特： 看来我们没有什么可谈的了。我在这儿等叶甫根尼的答复，他稍后会到的。

Point of Divergence
分歧点

团结的手
United Hands 小径

An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.
《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告

> Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
> TEL: 847-6861XXX
>
> Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!
> 赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
> 电话：847-6861XXX
>
> 又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。

昨日的滋味
The Taste of Yesterday 小径

Identical long tables, matching chairs, and potatoes, potatoes, and more potatoes.
帕特里基： 许多张样式统一的长桌，配得上它们的椅子，还有土豆、土豆，和土豆。

In the past, we had access to tin cans and even jam and flour. It was a challenge to transport supplies, but fortunately the weather was cold enough that nothing spoiled during the trip. Time was not an issue in those days, we had an abundance of it.
帕特里基： 有一段时间咱们有铁皮罐头，连果酱和面粉都能弄到。要把物资运过来总是很艰难，但天气够冷，无论什么都不会在路上坏掉。时间算得了啥！我们最不缺时间。

The little ones used to come and ask for Alenka. While we couldn't indulge their every whim, a treat now and then was fine. Being too strict does no one any good.
帕特里基： 以前小家伙们会来讨阿廖卡，虽然不能惯着他们，但偶尔来点没问题。做事太死板，对谁都不好。

Had I known the true value of Alenka, I would have been more careful about giving them away. Maybe I could have kept a few. Oh well, too late to regret now.
帕特里基： 要是早知道阿廖卡会变成这么宝贝的东西，我就会再分得仔细点，兴许现在还能省出一两块呢，嗨！

At first, we gathered around a single table to portion out the canned food, meticulously sopping up every last drop of broth. But now, there are more tables, but a lot less variety in our meals. And it's not like we can go hunting for critters to supplement our meals.
帕特里基： 最开始，大伙儿围着一张桌子仔细地分罐头，汤汁都要抹干净。现在桌子多啦，可吃的花样少了！魔精又没法抓来做菜。

Why can't people live off ore like they do?
帕特里基： 您说，人为啥不能像它们一样吃矿石活呢?

I have an urge to give a detailed account of my past and present experiences because Rayashki is exceptional; it is the most remarkable town I've encountered, although my travels have been limited.
帕特里基：我要细致地描述过去的生活，还有眼下的，为的是……来亚什基很好，它是我见过最好的镇子，尽管我到的地方少得可怜。

But I'm worried that it will one day disappear.
帕特里基：我担心它会消失。

That's for sure. If Comrade Evgeni agrees to Zeno's proposal, this place will soon be a land of snow again. The factories, the machines, everything will be covered with snow, just as it was when we first arrived ...
帕特里基：这是肯定的，假如叶甫根尼同志答应了芝诺的提议，这里很快就会重新变成一片雪地，那些工厂、机器，都会被雪盖住，就像我们刚来的时候那样……

I have to remember to write down all the details in case the kids ask me. I want to be able to tell them about everything that disappeared. Of course, it's not going to be written down in any textbooks ...
帕特里基：我得记下很多的细节，万一孩子们问起我，还能给他们讲讲消失的东西。是的，课本里头不会写这个……

There are countless unsung heroes in Rayashki, a place filled with ordinary people just trying to make ends meet. That's the reality of our lives here.
帕特里基：有太多英雄排着队等着被写进去，但我们只是生活在来亚什基的人、一群努力过日子的人。就是这样的。

The Taste of Yesterday
昨日的滋味

前进进行曲 · 1/2
Marching March · 1/2 FR-16

New Mine, Rayashki
来亚什基·新开采区

The steel behemoths rumble.
钢铁巨兽们轰隆作响。

They have plowed through snow, mud, and soil to reach their target.
它们驶过压平的雪原，驶过临时开凿的泥浆池，终于驶入了理想之地。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Windsong: I haven't done any field investigation of ley energy since our school fell apart.
北方哨歌：自从理线学被取消资格之后，我似乎就再也没有进行过关于地脉能量的实证研究了。

Windsong puts away her tools, hands trembling slightly.
北方哨歌收起改线尺，双手微微颤抖。

Knut: Don't worry, Comrade Windsong. Look, these stones are still the same stones we've always known.
克努特：别紧张，北方哨歌同志——你瞧瞧，这儿的石头还是咱们再熟悉不过的样子。

He catches the worry in Windsong's expression.
他看出了北方哨歌眼里的隐忧。

Knut: And don't be afraid to fail. My father told me that failure is just success in progress, hahaha!
克努特：也别害怕失败，北方哨歌同志。成功是建立在无数次失败之上的。

Knut: Even if we cannot find this new resource or save our Rayashki ...
克努特：哪怕我们没能找到新的资源，也没能保住来亚什基……

Knut: We've come back here together and worked for our common goal. We have nothing to complain about.
克努特：对咱们来说，能重新回到这儿，一条心地干一件事儿，已经没什么可抱怨的哩～

Windsong: Alright.
北方哨歌：……好。

Knut: Whatever the result, we thank you for your efforts.
克努特：无论最后的结果如何，咱们都感谢你的付出。

Knut: Now leave the rest to us!
克努特：接下来就交给咱们吧——！

He turns his head and shouts toward the drilling machine.
他拧过头，朝着钻塔的方向大喊。

Knut: Comrade Yuri, check the connection status.
克努特：尤里同志，确认管线连接状况。

Knut: Don't forget to check the drill, Comrade Elena.
克努特：可别忘了检查钻机状态，埃琳娜同志。

Worker I: Relax. It's much easier than opening a can with only your fingers.
工人Ⅰ：放心吧，这可比徒手开罐头简单多了～

Workers: Hahahahaha!
工人众：哈哈～

The excited queue flows like a steady river.
兴奋的队列流动了起来，像一团明亮的火。

People crowd together, shovels, hoes, and picks ringing out in unison.
这儿人头攒动，铁锹、锄头和铲子们协力遮蔽了天空。

Magnificent drilling machines emerge up from the snow.
宏伟的钻塔在雪中坚决地探出头来。

They roar as their drills pierce the earth.
钢铁巨兽们相互组合，钻机轰鸣，缓缓向下推进。

The stubborn frozen soil does nothing to hinder their progress.
顽固的冻土没能阻碍钻头的推进，天空与土地的缝隙间似乎只剩唯一的鸣响。

Their resonance is a sound that echoes in Windsong's ears, the sound of impassioned unity of purpose and vision.
某种高亢而热忱的声响又一次萦绕在北方哨歌的耳边。

This place is like the square, like their public canteen, like their factory.
这儿像是广场，像是公共食堂，像是工厂。

Like every corner of Rayashki.
像是来亚什基的每一个角落。

Clearly, it is a scene worth capturing.
显然，这是值得画下的一幕。

Avgust: Knut had grown a slender arm. One that reached places no one could and picked up stones there.
阿夫西维：克努特长出了细长的手臂儿，它伸进大家都够不着的地方，捞起地下的石头。

Avgust: They are not like the soft, transparent stones from the sky; these are hard as chocolate!
阿夫西维：不是天上落下来的软绵绵的、云朵儿一样的透明石头，是像阿廖卡一样坚强的石头。

Avgust: I think they are good stuff, too. Vila said we could make them into cans and houses to help the town!
阿夫西维：我想，它也是一种很好的东西……维拉告诉我，它能变成罐头，变成房子，变成小镇的力量！

Avgust: But maybe we will irritate the owner of the stones?
阿夫西维：……可是，石头的主人们不会生气吗?

The busy adults pay no heed to the child's mutterings.
忙碌的大人们无暇顾及孩子的呓语。

They gather around the newly collected core samples.
他们围着新采集上来的岩芯管面面相觑。

Worker I: Am I right that this sample is from 100 meters underground?
工人 I：这是 100 米深度的岩芯管成分……?

Worker II: Yes. Usually, we don't need to reach that deep to find runium ore.
工人 II：没错，如果是找卢恩矿石，咱们一般可打不到这么深的地方。

Knut: Relax, comrades. At least, it proves there is something new under Rayashki.
克努特：别太紧张，伙计们，这至少证明了来亚什基的底下确实有咱们不知道的新东西。

Worker II: Hmm, I have been a miner for forty years, and one thing I know for sure is this: this is not bedrock.
工人 II：奇怪，我以从业四十年的经验担保，这看起来可不只是普通的基岩……

Windsong: It's a Kikituk's hair.
北方哨歌：是基基图克的体毛。

Windsong carefully scrapes the colorful powder from the rocks and places it into a test tube.
北方哨歌小心翼翼地将岩石上的斑斓粉末刮进试管里。

Windsong: The black marks are the new resource we're looking for, the red brown ones are the Kikituks, and the bright yellow ones are their mineral-eating relatives, the Hoituks.
北方哨歌：黑色的痕迹正是我们寻找的新矿石，而红棕色的是基基图克，明黄色的是它喜食矿石的亚种，霍伊图克……

Windsong: Hmm. The machine will show us the stability of the ley energy in a minute.
北方哨歌：呼……只需一点儿时间，反应仪就能够直观地体现地脉能量的稳定程度。

Windsong: We are at the source of the ley energy now, so the lines should have been pure.
北方哨歌：……这儿是地脉能量的源头，它理应是一种纯净的线性能量。

Knut: If my eyes serve me right, I think I see bad news.
克努特：如果咱们的眼睛没糊弄人的话，这看起来可不是什么好消息。

Windsong: You're right. This source is like an estuary polluted beyond recovery.
北方哨歌：没错，这儿的地脉源头就像是被污水与泥垢过度污染的入海口……

Windsong: It is carrying too many traces, both from creatures and non-creatures. Besides, the "black" ore down there seems to have attracted a large number of critters, which has only worsened the pollution.
北方哨歌：它似乎承载了过多的生物与非生物的痕迹。不仅如此，藏在地底的“黑色”矿石吸引了大量的魔精，这加剧了地脉能量的污染……

Windsong: A senior of mine said in his notes that in this case, it will take a push for the core to activate its self-purification system.
北方哨歌：根据理线师前辈们的笔记推测，当这一现象发生时，只需要一点儿小小的动力源，地脉能量核便会触发自净机制。

Knut: Huh?
克努特：……？

Windsong: Shoot, we got a big one!
北方哨歌：糟糕，我们挖到大家伙了！

Avgust: Waves! It's seawater!
阿夫西维：海浪！是海浪！

Avgust: We should have prepared swimming floats.
阿夫西维：我们都应该准备游泳圈。

Avgust: Yes, but the waves won't reach us if we ride the sled!
阿夫西维：是的，戴好游泳圈，坐上雪橇，海浪就追不上我们了！

There is a slight hum from the vibration.
某种微不可察的震动声悄悄地响起。

Windsong: "If the ley energy materializes, put in a 7.62cm sea serpent bone, 3 drops of common vervain sap, and 20mg of snail sawfish embryo ..."
北方哨歌：“若地脉能量凝成实体，请置入 7.62 厘米长的海蛇前肢骨，3 滴马鞭草的汁液，20 毫克的蜗壳锯鳐胚胎……”

The Emergency Ley Energy Handling Guidelines (Trial) booklet in her hand is thrown to the ground and stamped aggressively.
《地脉能量应急处理指南（试行）》被粗暴地扔在地上，又狠狠地覆上了几个鞋印。

Windsong: Crazy! Whoa!
北方哨歌：&%#！*【德涅斯特河东岸粗口】！

A colored slime continues to ooze out.
彩色的黏液仍在源源不断地渗漏而出。

No longer a mere note in her reference materials, but an observable substance.
它们不再是参考资料上模糊的笔记，而是古怪而完整的实质。

The clever dreamer continues his observation.
眼尖的孩子仍然继续着他的观察。

Avgust: It has a beautiful stone on its neck, too!
阿夫西维：它的脖子上也挂着一颗漂亮的石头——！

Avgust: Did your father also fall asleep in the mine?
阿夫西维：你的父亲也睡在矿洞里了吗……？

Windsong: D**n! Is that the raw runium ore that Zeno has been looking for? The energy is so pure. No wonder it materialized into such a huge body.
北方哨歌：这该不会就是芝诺一直在找的卢恩原矿吧……该死的，如此精纯的动力源，难怪这儿的能量实体能膨胀得这么厉害……

Drawn in by the spectacle, more creatures emerge from nearby mine shafts.
受此吸引，一颗颗硕大的头颅从周边的废弃矿洞里探出头来。

Kikituk: *roars*
基基图克：吱吱！@#%@——！

Enticed by the potential for a feast.
它们显然也受到了如此丰裕盛宴的吸引。

Vila: Comrades, defense formation.
维拉：同志们，列队防御。

Vila: Miners, stay behind us and evacuate!
维拉：负责前期勘探工作的生产队员先撤出这里！

Knut: Comrades! Stand with me if you've got a weapon! No matter if it's a rifle, a staff, or a shovel. Grip them tight. This is our Rayashki's future we're fighting for!
克努特：手里拿着家伙的同志们跟我来！把它们拿稳，不管是步枪、术杖，还是随便什么能够防身的家伙……这可是小镇的希望。

Knut: We've been waiting for this, haven't we?
克努特：……咱们早就准备好了，不是么？

The Other Resident: That's right.
普通镇民：没错！

More "weapons" are raised, clanging together as they begin their battle march.
越来越多的“武器”举了起来，它们叮叮当当，像是某首进行曲的开篇。

Vila: Dear comrades.
维拉：亲爱的同胞们——

Vila: This is the critical moment for our town.
维拉：如今正是小镇生死存亡的危难关头。

Vila: No good weapons, no external support, but we have our friends, our family ...
维拉：我们没有优良的武器，没有外界的支持，但我们拥有无数的人们——

Vila: And each other, who will never leave anyone behind!
维拉：无数不愿抛下任何一人的同胞们。

Windsong: Yes!
北方哨歌：……是的。

Windsong: There's nothing to be afraid of.
北方哨歌：没什么可怕的。

Windsong: We can always figure it out, so long as ...
北方哨歌：我们总能想到办法的，至少，至少——

Vila: So long as we still have hope.
维拉：至少我们仍怀揣着希望。

Voices ring out one after another as they reach the end of their march.
响应的声音此起彼伏，恢弘的进行曲终于抵达了最盛大的高潮。

被留下的
A Heartfelt Legacy 小径

You're here, Comrade Vila.
克努特：……您来了，维拉同志。

Comrade Windsong and Comrade Raisa helped me take the children home; it took some time.
维拉：北方哨歌同志和拉伊莎同志陪我一块儿把孩子们送回了家里，花了些时间……

What did you find?
维拉：您找到了什么？

Comrade Evgeni once mentioned that he kept some things in the cabinet in the meeting room.
克努特：不算是找到的。叶甫根尼同志曾经提过一次，他有些东西放在会议室的柜子里头。

He said to take them out when the time was right.
克努特：他说，碰见合适的机会，就把它们取出来。

...
克努特：……

Here. This is all of it.
克努特：给您。这就是所有的了。

A Heartfelt Legacy
被留下的

采掘者们
Dodgy Excavators 小径

An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.
《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告

> Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
> TEL: 847-6861XXX
>
> Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!
> 赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
> 电话：847-6861XXX
>
> 又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。

针脚与面包
Needles and Loaves 小径

Comrade Vila frequents this place, always looking great in her poneva dress.
拉伊莎：维拉同志常来这儿，她穿起巴努哇很是那么回事。

I taught her how to sew, and other comrades would bring piles of torn coats and socks for us to mend. This is something I have always done.
拉伊莎：我教她缝衣服，其他同志也会把磨破的外套呀，袜子呀，成筐成筐地送来，我一直在干这个。

No matter how catchy our slogans are, we still need clothes to wear and bread to eat, right? The rest is not within my realm of concern.
拉伊莎：……不管口号喊得多好，我们还是得有衣服穿，有面包吃，对吧？剩下的不是我考虑的……

Thankfully, Comrade Vila has been diligently caring for the children. My main worry was that once the teachers were gone, there would be no one to check on them and ensure they were looked after.
拉伊莎：还好维拉同志把孩子们照顾得挺不错。之前，我最担心的一桩事就是老师走了之后，没有人肯来，可也没人有空顾着他们。

Leaving children to run amok on the streets will not lead to their healthy development.
拉伊莎：只把孩子丢到街道上，由他们到处跑，他们是不会长得好的。

I'm very grateful that she's here.
拉伊莎：真感激她。

...
拉伊莎：……

This place has become a second home to me. Despite the challenges and endless tasks, I feel content knowing that our efforts benefit our fellow comrades.
拉伊莎：我在这里觉得很自在。虽然辛苦，而且有忙不完的活……但我们是为自己的同志在努力。

This experience is priceless to me. Anyone who has ever sat at a long table, sharing butter and conversation with people from different countries and working together to form friendships would understand the value of this way of life.
拉伊莎：这种体验非常宝贵，如果谁曾经在长桌上分享过黄油，和来自不同地方的、活生生的人交谈，劳作，握手，彼此称呼对方为同志……谁都会相信这样的生活。

It has a powerful effect, my friend. It reminds me of dark bread - rough, but filling.
拉伊莎：它是有力道的，朋友。摸上去就像黑面包一样，很粗糙，也很能填饱肚子……

Whether it is Comrade Vila or ... Comrade Evgeni, I trust in their abilities. This town will not simply disappear.
拉伊莎：不管是维拉同志还是……叶甫根尼同志，我都相信他们。这个镇子不会轻易消失。

Rayashki will always be here, steadfast and unwavering.
拉伊莎：来亚什基就在这儿，来亚什基总是在这儿。

Needles and Loaves
针脚与面包

广场聚会

Town Square Meet-Up 小径

Side by Side
并肩而行

英文 / ENGLISH

Miners, covered in a layer of dust and wielding their picks, hurry over as others join them after washing off their bandages. In the square, some take shelter under the statue and read books, while children are led by loving hands through rows of coats and boots. A strong sense of camaraderie unites everyone in the square; they are all part of the same tight-knit community.

The conversations begin and spread like a hurricane, sweeping from one end of the square to the other as everyone tries to engage with those around them. But then another voice joins in. The town's teacher has arrived, embodying the ideals we hold dear. She is like a character from a legend who has come to our town from a faraway place. Because of our strong will, even legends can become reality here. If the teacher had not said, "See you tomorrow!" this would have gone on all night.

As a community, we each have a voice in shaping the future of our town. It's inspiring to see so many people come together to make a difference. There is a sense of pride that radiates from within, uniting us all towards a common goal.

Oh, how powerful it is when we come together as one!

中文 / CHINESE

有人带着矿镐和灰尘赶来，有人抱着洗好的绷带，有人在广场的雕像下边读书。孩子们站在队伍最前面，许多双友善的手轻轻拍着他们的背，保证他们能穿过大衣和靴子的方阵。“广场上都是自己人！”

谈话就此开始，一发不可收拾，像飓风从广场这头吹到那头，每个人都在努力地和旁边的人说话……直到有别的声音亮起来。镇上的教师到了，她是这儿的理想最好的佐证——一位从遥远的地方，从传说里走到镇上，走到我们中间的同志。瞧，我们的意志连模糊的故事都能打动，都能变为现实。如果不是她拍拍手，宣布“明天见！”，这一切可以持续整个白天和夜晚。

是啊，我们都对镇子的明天有一份决定权。希望聚集起来，数量是相当惊人的。有这么多双手出力！一股强烈的、滚烫的自豪感烧热了每个人的心……

噢，团结！

前进进行曲 · 2/2
Marching March · 2/2 FR-16

The nosey critters have all disappeared, and the strange entity has slumped down.
聒噪的魔精们统统不见了踪影，巨大的实体也陷入了肉眼可见的萎靡。

The gathered warriors are exhausted, but alive.
仍有余力的人们大口喘着粗气。

Vila: Did we make it?
维拉： 我们……成功了么?

Windsong: After we drove the critters away, the self-purification system began to run slower.
北方哨歌： 在我们驱赶了那些魔精之后，地脉能量的自净机制明显放缓了不少。

Knut: Haha! Time to go all out. Let's go, comrades!
克努特： 哈哈——！该轮到咱们进攻了，同志们，冲呀！

Worker I: For a brighter future!
工人 I： 为了美好的明天！

The crowd redoubles their strength as they follow Knut forward.
人群争先恐后地涌上前去，他们手中的武器炽热，而他们的心更甚。

Ley Energy?: ...!
地脉能量?: ——!

Deafening sounds reverberate all around them.
震耳欲聋的鸣响远远地传了出去。

A brilliant red splashes across the snowfield.
漫漫雪原里泛起一片鲜艳的红。

Worker II: Oh!
工人 II： 唔……

Vila: Comrade Yuri! Get a few more comrades here. We need to move him to the back!
维拉： 尤里同志！——再来几个同志，把尤里抬到安全的地方！

Many comrades are wounded, blood soaking their arms, but their hearts have not faltered.
我们的同志负伤了，我们的臂膀汩汩冒血，可我们的心仍彼此扶持着。

Never retreat, never surrender.
绝不退缩，绝不屈服。

Windsong: Its energy has not run out yet. What on earth ...
北方哨歌： 它的能量竟然还没有耗尽……这到底是……

Ley Energy?: *roars*
地脉能量?: ！@#%……

Windsong: That's the ore! D**n it! Don't tell me it's still powering this thing!
北方哨歌： 是那颗卢恩原矿——该死的，它不会还在供给能源吧！

Worker I: I see. So we just break that stone, and it's over, right?
工人 I： 我明白了——只要把那颗破石头打碎就行了，对吧?!

Windsong: Yes, theoretically.
北方哨歌： 理论上是这样……

Windsong's voice wavers as she catches her breath.
北方哨歌大口喘着粗气，语气游移不定。

Guard I: Leave it to me. I am the marksman here! Just need to get a little closer, a little closer.
保卫队员 I： 让我来，我是这儿准头最好的！——只要靠近一点儿，再一点儿……

Guard II: Comrade Adrian, Comrade Daniel, and I will go with you. There may be something we can do!
保卫队员 II： 我和你一起去，还有阿德里安同志、丹尼尔同志……多个人多份力气！

Guards: Okay!
保卫队员众： 好——！

Vila: Comrades, watch out!
维拉： 同志们，小心！

They charge ahead, their spirits unwavering.
战士们冲上前去，他们面不改色，脚步没有丝毫迟疑。

Vila: No!
维拉： 不——！

Knut: Fall back, fall back!
克努特： 撤回来，快撤回来——！

Bullets fly through the air, their sound like a relentless pounding hail.
子弹噼噼啪啪地落下，有如豆大的雨点，溅起一阵阵红色的水花。

Ley Energy?: ...
地脉能量?： ……

Knut: S**t! Our attacks cannot break that stone at all.
克努特： **的【来亚什基粗口】，咱们的子弹完全打不破那颗石头……

Vila: Comrade Windsong, wh-what is going on?
维拉： 这、这究竟是怎么回事……北方哨歌同志?

The red splashes around them, so vivid against the white snow, halt her words.
越来越多的红溢满了维拉的双眼，令她几乎失声。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Windsong: The cycle of ley energy is long. It may take months, years, or even longer than that to return to its source.
北方哨歌： 地脉能量的蒸腾、回流是一个漫长的演化过程。它的自然回落也许需要几个月、几年，或是更长的时间……

Windsong: As long as that ore remains on its neck, the ley energy will continue with the purification until it wipes out everything around.
北方哨歌： 只要我们没法摘掉它脖子上的那颗卢恩原矿……地脉能量就会一直维持自我净化的状态，直到扫空周围的一切。

Windsong's voice is low, despite the din of battle.
北方哨歌的语气比预想的更加低落。

Knut: So all we can do is wait?
克努特： 那咱们就只能干等着吗——?

Windsong: For our own safety, we'd better stay out of this area until it completely returns to the source.
北方哨歌：出于安全考虑，在它彻底回流到地下前，恐怕我们都无法在这块地区开采了……

Windsong: I should've seen this coming. I'm so sorry.
北方哨歌：是我的预估不足，我很抱歉……

Surrounded by fallen comrades and dark red streaks, Windsong attempts to conceal the fear in her voice.
四周歪倒的人们与周围暗红的冻痕让她的声音不自觉地低了下去。

The wind rises, sharp and howling.
凛冽的风又一次刮了起来。

Knut: Comrade Patrik, Comrade Nikita, you're not done yet, right? Anyone else?
克努特：——帕特里基同志、尼基塔同志，你们还有力气吧，还有没有人和我们一起?

Knut: We still got the digger, the crane, and our own strength! Let's try harder! It's nothing more than a stupid stone! We can do this!
克努特：我们还有挖掘机，有起重机，我们还有力气！
再使把劲，只是颗破石头，我们能做到的——！

Knut: It's our last chance!
克努特：这可是我们唯一的机会了——！

Rough hands stubbornly rise once more, defying the cold wind and danger.
一双双粗糙的手仍然倔强地高举过头顶。

Trickles of blood seep down their arms from cuts and wounds.
创口汩汩地冒出血来，疼得他龇牙咧嘴。

Warm words cover them like a bandage, offering some solace to their pain.
温润的话语浸透了血迹斑斑的手臂。

Vila: Stop this senseless sacrifice, Comrade Knut. It's pointless to keep going.
维拉：……别再作无谓的牺牲了，克努特同志。

Knut: But, to save Rayashki is also your dream, no?!
克努特：可……让来亚什基继续发展下去不也是你的理想吗?!

Knut: Our little one from afar swore she would unite all of us, no matter who we are or where we're from.
克努特：远道而来的小个子信誓旦旦地说会把所有人团结在一块儿，不论身份，也不关乎种族……

Knut: We must keep all that in our minds. How can we give up now?
克努特：大伙们可一直都记着呢，我们怎么能这个时候放弃——！

The massive creature stands unmoving, like an unyielding mountain.
巨大的能量实体沉默地矗立着，有如一座无法逾越的高山。

Vila: ...
维拉：……

Vila: I'm so happy I came here and made friends with all of you, comrades. You each have a kind heart and a strong will.
维拉：来到这儿之后，我结识了你们，各位善良而坚定的同志们。

Vila: Before I met you, my dream was only a joke to the other Rusalki, but you've shown me it isn't unreachable. Now it feels so real and heartwarming.
维拉：多亏了你们，我那被无数鲁萨尔卡嘲笑的理想似乎不再是遥不可及的梦……它如此真实，如此炽热……

Vila: Sometimes, I almost forget that you see the fins and scales on my body.
维拉： 甚至令我遗忘了身上的棘刺与鱼鳞。

Vila: That's why I don't want you to sacrifice yourselves for nothing. I don't want to lose you.
维拉： 正因如此，我不愿你们的牺牲毫无价值，不愿你们如此仓促地离开。

Her smile is a ray of light breaking through the clouds.
她的笑容温暖而满足，像是一束透过乌云的光。

Vila: What we want is to stay together. That's why we are fighting to save Rayashki, right?
维拉： 我们希望来亚什基得以延续，不也是基于这最朴素的愿望么？

Knut: F**k this world!
克努特： 干这**的世界——！【来亚什基粗口】!

Avgust: *sobs* The swans have lost their feathers.
阿夫西维： 呜呜，天鹅们的羽毛都被折断了……

Avgust: Are we still able to reach the sky?
阿夫西维： ……我们还能飞上天空吗？

Snow begins to fall again, as if casting a veil over the dead—over Rayashki.
茫茫大雪落了下来，像是要为来亚什基的葬礼蒙上最后一层轻纱。

The roar of the wind grows, but there is something else groaning with it. Clouds are pushed aside, and a distorted voice calls out from above.
愈发清晰的轰鸣声推开了乌云，失真的声音从其中遥遥坠了下来。

Evgeni: I must thank you, Comrade Windsong. You've rekindled something in me, in us—a new hope, just as you promised.
叶甫根尼： 感谢你，北方哨歌同志，你为这儿的所有人找到了新的火种，正如你所承诺的那样。

Evgeni: I will tell you that I read some papers on your ley lines after that night. It holds some great ideas, I admit. You and Rayashki deserve a better future.
叶甫根尼： 那天夜晚以后，我读了理线学的部分论文。这是个很有想法的学派，你们的未来理应更光明。

Windsong: ...!
北方哨歌： ……！

Avgust: Wow, sea swallow, our brave friend!
阿夫西维： 哇，勇敢的海燕朋友～

Evgeni: Comrades, I want you to know I recommended you to Zeno only because I was worried for your future. I did not want you to be stuck in a dying town.
叶甫根尼： 因为我个人对于小镇未来的判断，出于为各位的前程着想，我选择向芝诺推荐了你们。

Knut: Comrade Evgeni?
克努特： 叶甫根尼……同志?

Evgeni: And it gives me pain to see how brave and determined you all have been. I won't let any of you die here.
叶甫根尼： 直到现在，我仍痛心于你们的勇敢与坚决，更不希望看到任何一位同胞在这里倒下。

Vila: Evgeni, what are you doing!
维拉： 叶甫根尼，你要做什么——！

Evgeni: The sad thing is I took a very different path long ago. But what does it matter now?
叶甫根尼： 令人遗憾的是……我似乎早已走上了与各位相悖的道路。但这又有什么关系呢?

Evgeni: Rayashki is proud of you. I am proud of you. You will continue to build the new world of your dreams—our dream, no matter where or when.
叶甫根尼：你们是这片土壤的骄傲，也将会继续建设这个世界……在任何地方、任何时候。

Evgeni: I will always be there with you.
叶甫根尼：——连同着我的这一份。

Evgeni: Seize the opportunity, Vila, Windsong, my comrades!
叶甫根尼：抓住机会，北方哨歌同志，维拉同志！

Windsong: Природа это числа и черты.
北方哨歌：Природа это числа и черты.

The trails of the old machines wore deep into the frozen ground, forming a raised pathway that led up and away from the scene.
显眼的推进痕迹刻在了冻土之上，像是某种永恒的通路。

The children, finally coming to grips with what they've seen, begin to cry.
孩子们抽泣声起起落落，仿佛河水化冻。

Vila: Comrade Evgeni.
维拉：……叶甫根尼同志。

Do fish mourn? Can a Rusalka cry?
鱼会流泪么？

No one can really answer this question.
似乎没人能回答这个问题。

Yet around the Rusalka, a ring of salty water seems to rise.
这尾来自遥远北方的鲁萨尔卡周围似乎漫起了一片咸涩的汪洋。

Knut: D**n it! This is not fair!
克努特：该死的！这一点都不公平！

Knut: Just because he was the only pilot here doesn't mean he could make that decision alone! We should have had a vote!
克努特：他凭什么仗着自己是这儿唯一会驾驶军机的家伙就自作主张！咱们应该投票——！举手表决！

Worker I: We fixed that fighter together!
工人 I：那台飞机还是咱们一起修好的呢！

Worker I: That a*****e left us behind.
工人 I：这个混球，他把我们都扔在这儿了……

Worker II: But he will always be our comrade, right?
工人 II：咱们永远都是同志，对吧？

Time appears to stand still, as all present stand unmoving, unspeaking.
时间在无数的沉默中缓缓流过，像是永不回头的长河。

Until one, and then many, trembling hands rise triumphantly into the sky.
终于，许多双手在颤抖中缓缓地举过头顶。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Residents: To Comrade Evgeni, salute!
镇民众：向叶甫根尼同志敬礼——！

Avgust: But where is the sea swallow?!
阿夫西维：海燕……去了哪里呢?！

Vila: He flew into the future, child.
维拉：……他飞去了未来，孩子。

Vila: The future we'll all reach one day.
维拉：一个我们终将抵达的未来。

8#1
8#1

雪与雪之外的
Snow, and the Others FR-17

New Mine, Rayashki
来亚什基·新开采区

The unsupported ley energy returns to the earth.
失去支持的地脉能量重新回归了大地。

The soil is smoothed out, a canvas for a new painting.
土壤的褶皱也被迅速抹平，像是为一幅崭新的油画铺好底色。

Knut: Take heart, comrades.
克努特：打起精神来，伙计们。

Knut: Everything he did was for Rayashki.
克努特：这一切都是为了来亚什基。

Vila: We shared the same dream, didn't we?
维拉：我们的愿望总归是一致的，不是么？

Vila: To do all we can for the good of the people.
维拉：……为了更多的人们。

She faces toward the silent cliffs.
她望向那片寂静的山崖。

Worker I: Reporting: drilling rig clear, ready for new exploration.
工人 I：报告，钻塔已经清理完毕，随时可以进行新一轮的勘探活动。

Knut: ...
克努特：……

He stomps firmly on the ground beneath his feet.
他用力踩实脚下的土地。

Knut: That's the spirit! We must keep going! Let's get some wiggles!
克努特：没错！咱们得一直向前，向前，然后还是**的【来亚什基粗口】向前！

Knut: Yuri, start the machines!
克努特：尤里，开启机器！

Worker II: On it!
工人 II：是——！

A loud call resounds, and the huge drill churns once more.
洪亮的呼号声响起，巨大的钻机缓缓掘入矿坑的更深处。

The steel behemoths roar.
钢铁巨兽的震响声又一次盖过了这儿。

Their sound covering up the sorrow and the gloom of the moment.
它盖过悲伤，盖过阴郁，盖过一切的不可能。

After some time, the children carefully and cautiously approach the cliff's edge.
不知什么时候，孩子们悄悄来到了山崖边上。

Avgust bends down, placing his sunflower on the edge, as tenderly as a mother tucks in their child.
阿夫西维弯下身子，为勇敢的、陷入常眠的战士拢上被子。

Avgust: Take this. It's my best friend.
阿夫西维： 这朵向日葵，送给你……它是我最好的朋友。

Avgust: I think it will be glad to have another best friend.
阿夫西维： 我想，它很愿意成为你的第二位好朋友。

Pyotr: I will become a great hero like you. It's a promise, a man's promise.
彼得森： 我也会成为像你一样的大英雄，这是……这是男子汉的保证。

Avgust: Why are your feathers wet, Pyotr?
阿夫西维： 你的羽毛打湿了吗？彼得森。

Pyotr: ...
彼得森： ……

Avgust: You have water on your face, Ms. Windsong. Can kids still cry after they grow up?
阿夫西维： 北方哨歌湿漉漉的……长大了的孩子也会哭吗？

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Windsong: I should've known ...
北方哨歌： 我准备得还不够……

Windsong: The abnormal fluctuation of the ley energy, and how much of an attraction it is to the critters ...
北方哨歌： 既没能预料到地脉能量的反常波动，也对它对魔精们的吸引力估计不足……

Windsong: I should've noticed they were different from my theory.
北方哨歌： 一切都与理论中的有所偏差……

Her words are met by murmurs, but a familiar hand wraps hers gently.
喃喃自语间，有人轻轻拍了拍她的后背。

Vila: At least this experience will be valuable for the study of ley lines, won't it?
维拉： 至少理线学收获了一次宝贵的经验，不是么？

Vila: Take it in, and make something of it. I'm sure it will be of more help in the future.
维拉： 将这一成果发扬光大吧……我坚信，它能帮上未来更多人的忙。

Vila: You're not only doing this for yourself or for me, but for those who sacrificed for all of us.
维拉： 这不只是为了你我，也同样是为了逝去的人。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

boom
“轰隆——！”

Worker I: We found it! This must be the new resource!
工人 I： 挖上来了！新的石头挖上来了！

A stream of black rocks rises from the pile, one by one.
沉重的矿石堆里，一颗颗黑黢黢的矿石升了起来。

In a short time, they are picked up and passed through countless hands.
它们在空中纷飞着，在无数人的手中传递着——

The air is thick with black dust that covers coats, gloves, boots, and faces.
像是盛开的礼花，又像是来自新世界的致意。

Knut: COAL!
克努特：煤炭——！

Knut: It is coal! We did it!
克努特：是煤炭！我们真的发掘出了新的资源。

Patrik: This is our coal! Comrades, we will use it to cook our meal tonight!
帕特里基：我宣布，今晚的晚饭即将使用我们的煤炭作为燃料。

Resident II: And it will be the best meal I've ever had!
镇民 II：那将会成为我此生吃到的最美味的一顿饭！

Patrik: Is that so, Comrade Nikita? You got a problem with my food, huh?
帕特里基：这可算不上什么好话，尼基塔同志——！
听起来你对我之前的厨艺颇为不满啊……

Resident I: Hahahaha!
镇民 I：哈哈～

Knut: I made a rough estimate. The reserves here should last hundreds of years!
克努特：我估摸着，这儿的煤炭还能让来亚什基不眠不休地开采几百年呢！

Windsong: For the first time in history, the theory of ley lines has been verified.
北方哨歌：……直到今天，理线学终于完成了第一次实证。

Vila: There is no doubt your work deserves a fair assessment now.
维拉：毫无疑问，你们应该得到一个更公正的评价。

Windsong: Thank you for your help, Ms. Vila.
北方哨歌：感谢你的帮助，维拉女士。

Vila: We achieved this together, didn't we?
维拉：这并非某一个人的功劳，不是么？

Windsong: Of course.
北方哨歌：当然。

Cheers travel forward and back over the crowd and out into the boundless tundra.
欢呼声远远地传了出去，穿过人群，翻越无垠的冻土。

They echo against the cliffs.
在那沉寂的、不再言语的山崖久久回响着。

Windsong: The glory goes to every one of us.
北方哨歌：这场胜利属于我们每一个人。

Their joy reaches back to the town, carried in by the victorious comrades-in-arms.
喜悦又重新占领了小镇的每一处角落。

Unfortunately, their now-unwelcome guests seem unable to share in the enthusiasm.
遗憾的是，不请自来的客人们似乎难以共情。

Bertolt: I'm very glad to see you again, Ms. Windsong.
贝托尔特：北方哨歌女士，很高兴见到你。

Windsong: Hmph! Are you? You don't look glad at all.
北方哨歌：是么？你的表情可一点儿也看不出来。

Bertolt: Heh. I admit, I underestimated the people here.
贝托尔特：呵……我不得不承认，我低估了这儿的所有人。

Bertolt: Especially you, Ms. Windsong.
贝托尔特：当然也包括你，北方哨歌女士。

Bertolt: The great heroine who found coal deep beneath the town.
贝托尔特：你找到了深埋在地底的煤矿，成了这儿的大英雄……

Windsong: So, did I manage to ruin Zeno's little plans?
北方哨歌：还让芝诺的小算盘扑了个空～

Bertolt: ...
贝托尔特：……

Her sharp tongue breaks the cool of the no longer smiling crocodile.
伶牙俐齿的草根学者在语言交流上从不示弱。

Bertolt: We have nothing left to do here. Zeno will leave soon.
贝托尔特：芝诺在这儿的行动结束了，我们很快就会离开这里。

Bertolt: I know we disagree on many things, our future included. Still, Zeno looks forward to working with you again, hopefully in a more friendly way.
贝托尔特：尽管你我意见不一，但芝诺仍然期待着与你的下一次合作。
——以更和谐的方式。

He extends his hand on his own initiative.
他自顾自地伸出手来。

Windsong: I hope so, too.
北方哨歌：但愿如此。

Windsong: You don't wanna be embarrassed by another lowly researcher again, do you?
北方哨歌：你也一定不希望我再做出什么草根学者的无理举动。

Bertolt's hand awkwardly hangs in the air, unanswered.
贝托尔特的手尴尬地悬在空中，无人问津。

Bertolt: Goodbye, Ms. Windsong.
贝托尔特：再见，北方哨歌女士。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Windsong: Wait! I have one last question!
北方哨歌：等等——！我还有最后一个问题！

Bertolt: Please, I'm at your service.
贝托尔特：请问。

Windsong: Zeno confirmed the existence of Hoituks in Rayashki months ago, but you just took care of them without letting anyone know.
北方哨歌：几个月前，芝诺便在这儿确认了霍伊图克的踪迹。你们三缄其口，无声无息地扫清了它们……

Windsong: You already knew there would be a large reserve of coal here, didn't you?!
北方哨歌：你们早就知道这儿可能存在大量的煤炭资源——?!

Bertolt: ...
贝托尔特：……

He shrugs and leaves without another word.
对方耸了耸肩，什么也没说，头也不回地离开了。

8#1
8#1

一如既往
Same as Before 小径

I've always believed it! We can dig through the frozen layers and find ways to survive here. Even when the harsh northern winds gnash their teeth, we can overcome any challenge!
埃琳娜：我从来没怀疑过！我们可以挖穿冻土，可以在这地方想法子过下去，连北风都咬着牙往肚子里灌——还有什么我们不能去战胜？

Zeno will have its own specific guidelines that I doubt I'll be able to adapt to, but just like this particular component, we are already refined and capable enough!
埃琳娜：假使说，芝诺也有他们的一套规矩要拿出来，我习惯不了。跟这枚零件一样，我们已经被磨好了，已经足够了！

Yes, we can live on our own without relying on other leaders.
埃琳娜：是的，我们自己能过生活，不需要寻找其他带头的家伙……

...
埃琳娜：……

Let me be honest, I am not much of a fighter. The only tools I know how to use are a wrench and pliers. But when push comes to shove, I will make do with whatever I can get my hands on. We need weapons to defend ourselves, and we are not afraid to use them.
埃琳娜：说实话，要是打起架，我只会用扳手和钳子……但我会把手边的工具用起来，总得有武器。我们不怕他们。

It is crucial for children to explore the world. I came here at a young age, on a whim with a friend. We had no experience in shaping workpieces or handling raw materials. Now, my skills are highly valued in this community.
埃琳娜：孩子们倒确实该出去看看，我也是趁着年轻，和朋友拍了下脑袋，到了这里。之前谁磨过工件，捡过矿石？现在我的手艺在镇子里排得上号。

We did not come to Rayashki to have fun. They've got it all wrong.
埃琳娜：我们不是为了享受才到来亚什基的。他们想错了。

Same as Before
一如既往

无管辖地带
No Man's Land 小径

An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.
《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告

> Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
> TEL: 847-6861XXX
>
> Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!
> 赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
> 电话：847-6861XXX
>
> 又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。

你好，来亚什基
Hello, Rayashki FR-18

People's Square, Rayashki
来亚什基·民众广场

The people gather again.
人们又一次汇聚在了一起。

This time, though, there are no more disputes, no resentment.
但值得庆幸的是，没有争端，没有怨愤。

This is a gathering of joy.
这是一场属于所有人的会议。

Vila: After thorough discussion, the people of Rayashki have made their final decision.
维拉： 经过审慎的讨论，来亚什基全体居民都做出了最后的选择。

Vila: I stand here to declare the future direction of Rayashki.
维拉： 现在，我正式宣布关于来亚什基的处理方案——

Vila: As of today, Rayashki will be no longer affiliated with any organizations, and all factories dedicated to processing of runium ore will be shut down.
维拉： 来亚什基从即日起不再附属于任何组织，关停所有卢恩矿石的相关工厂。

Resident I: What are we going to do for our work, then?
镇民 Ⅰ： 那咱们能做些什么呢——？

Resident II: I don't want to sit around at home living on benefits!
镇民 Ⅱ： 我可不想闲在家里，每月巴巴地等着救济金。

Vila: There will be many things to do, Comrade Valeriya.
维拉： 我们能做许多事，瓦列里娅同志。

Vila: As the elites above us struggle for power, we ordinary people suffer in darkness.
维拉： 绝大多数的能源被屈指可数的寡头们把持，他们利用战争、权力操控着属于普通人的一切。

Vila: But now, there will be a new source of power, one built to lift up the people not to take from them. And it will run on Rayashki coal.
维拉： 而现在，至少人们多了一处新煤矿。

Vila: We will start new factories in Rayashki and explore the possibilities of working with other coal producers nearby.
维拉： 我们将在来亚什基开展新的工厂线，并积极探索与周边地区的煤炭工业的合作可能性。

Vila: We will mine with our own hands and feed ourselves.
维拉： 我们可以依靠自己的双手，开采煤矿，发展效益。

Knut: Maybe we can even build a dock and sell our products far away.
克努特： 没准、没准咱们还能建造船坞，把它们送到更遥远的地方。

The people chatter excitedly.
人们七嘴八舌地议论了起来。

Vila: We will raise a new banner above Rayashki, one welcoming all ordinary people ...
维拉： 我们希望来亚什基能够成为一面新的旗帜——

Vila: ... to come to a livable place with abundant power and job opportunities for their future.
维拉： 一个为更多的普通人们供给低价煤炭、发光发热的地方。

Arms and smiles intermingle, then a rising wave of applause.
无数热切的目光交织在一起，唤起如潮般的掌声。

The wave washes over everyone, including Windsong.
潮水漫过了所有人，当然也包括北方哨歌。

Vila: What about your plan, Comrade Windsong?
维拉： 那么你呢？北方哨歌同志。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌： ……

Windsong: I think I'm going to stay for a while.
北方哨歌： 我打算暂时留在这儿。

Vila: You need to know that for now we must tighten our belts. Everyone's rations must be cut for some time until Rayashki gets back on its feet.
维拉： 为了缩减成本，我们必须得作出短暂的牺牲……之后，所有人在来亚什基的待遇都会被削减，直到来亚什基步入新的轨道。

The researcher does not waver, not in the slightest.
但对方似乎丝毫没有动摇。

Windsong: At least for now, the study of ley lines belongs here, not in the fancy halls and symposiums of human academia.
北方哨歌： 相比于光鲜亮丽的学术舞台，至少现在，理线学更适合呆在这儿。

Windsong: This place still holds many possible research avenues: monitoring the changes in the environment, further detailing the local ley energy map, maybe even studying the mutation of the Kikituks.
北方哨歌： 关于这儿环境的演变，地脉能量图的进一步完善，以及基基图克们的生物性变化……

Windsong: I must finish them to further develop the study before it is ready for academia again.
北方哨歌： 它们都是理线学亟待解决的重要课题。

Vila: Then it sounds like you may be with us for a long time yet, good.
维拉：听上去，你要在这儿呆上一段不短的时间。祝你成功。

They exchange smiles.
两人相视一笑。

Vila: And don't forget, you are expected to cut the ribbon at the ceremony.
维拉：也欢迎你来参观来亚什基新的剪彩仪式。

An enthusiastic hand reaches out to Windsong once again.
这只热情的手又一次伸到了北方哨歌的面前。

Now, the little arctic town is covered in a strange mix of black coal soot and bright yellow flowers, a warm wind blowing over every inch of soil and each wall, old and new.
现在，这座漂亮的北极小镇被黑色的炭球与明黄色的花朵覆盖着，暖和的风途经每一寸土壤与砖墙。

It flows like blood through snow-white skin and fluffy pores. A scene like a hand-drawn picture.
像是雪白肌肤下流动的血液与蓬松的毛孔，又像是未经修磨的手绘图画。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Windsong walks alone through the town, feeling the energy of the earth beneath her.
北方哨歌独自走在小镇上，她走得很慢，像是融入了这片土壤。

Townsfolk pass her.
形形色色的人们从她的身旁经过。

They nod and greet her with hopeful smiles.
点头，致意。

Pyotr: Ms. Windsong, I want to apologize for being rude to you during class.
彼得森：北方哨歌老师——我为当时课堂上的无礼向您道歉。

Pyotr: I'll bring you some Friendship cheese next time, to apologize. I promise!
彼得森：下次我一定请您品尝最好的友谊牌奶酪，我保证！

Knut: You will always be our comrade.
克努特：你永远是咱们的朋友。

Knut: Hats off to you!
克努特：向你致敬～

In the distance, children cluster around a vibrant field of sunflowers.
远处，成群结队的孩子们簇拥着一位鲜艳的向日葵。

Avgust: Ms. Windsong!
阿夫西维：北方哨歌——！

Avgust: I think we performed very well at the ceremony!
阿夫西维：我们的剪彩仪式表演得很好！

The boy, bright as any other sunflower, waves to her as he hops joyfully in the snow.
向日葵朝她挥手，在雪地上蹦蹦跳跳。

Avgust: Will you come teach us again?
阿夫西维：你还会给我们上课吗?

Nina: We want to learn more, too!
尼娜：还有我们——！

Pasono: Same here!
帕索诺：我也是！

Avgust: ♪~♪♪~
阿夫西维： ♪～♪♪～

Avgust: Ms. Windsong, the sunflowers we planted are blooming!
阿夫西维： 北方哨歌姐姐，我们种下的向日葵长出来了——！

Avgust: We protected the town!
阿夫西维： 我们成功地保护了小镇！

Windsong wants to say something, but a sudden creaking draws up her attention.
北方哨歌想说些什么，突然的轰鸣声吸引了所有人的注意。

She looks up to see a construction crane looming over the town.
她抬起头来，巨大的起重机正低头俯瞰着这座小镇。

The new coal refinery, a school, a hockey field, the dormitories ...
新的煤矿工厂，来亚什基小学，冰上曲棍球场，集体宿舍……

In the boundless future ahead for Rayashki, these buildings will be like speckled grains of sand cast over the tundra.
在来亚什基，或者说，在更广袤无垠的理想未来里，它们都像是粒粒斑驳的沙砾。

Windsong: We begin the next chapter of Rayashki today.
北方哨歌： 这儿有许多希望汇入其中的沙砾。

Windsong: I'm so glad we will build it together.
北方哨歌： ……我也一样。

Windsong: Hello, Rayashki.
北方哨歌： 你好，来亚什基。

8#1
8#1

转瞬即逝
An Instant 小径

I stumbled across some components. Lately, it seems like everyone is looking for them in their spare time. These little things can definitely come in handy.
克努特： 我找到了零件，最近大家闲下来的时候都在找这个。是，它总能有点用处。

The little thing was hidden just behind the base of the statue. It seemed that our resilient bear had found a new home here. The old statue had to be moved to make way for it, but its base remained. I suspected it had left some of its components behind.
克努特： 这小东西就在雕像的基座后头。没错，我们那头健壮的小熊来了，旧的雕像给它腾了位置，但座子还在……我猜到他会把零件搁在这儿。

Comrade Evgeni ... he did not notice the changes in Rayashki, but change is inevitable and ongoing. He was still holding onto memories of when things were tough and rough.
克努特： 叶甫根尼同志……他没发觉来亚什基在改变，事情总是会变的。他还记着它起初不太像样的时候。

In those days, this square didn't even exist. We painstakingly dug it out with shovels and carried each stone ourselves.
克努特： 那时候这里可没有这么大的广场，我们用铲子一点点挖，所有石头都是我们亲自搬来，放下。

No one expected Rayashki to end up so beautiful. We were never ones for making plans or dreaming big; we simply rolled up our sleeves and got to work.
克努特：没人想到过来亚什基会变成现在这么漂亮。我们很少预想，也很少做梦，我们只是动手去做。

Now, Rayashki might change once more. What will it become? Everything is changing so fast. We have a pool and a school; it all seems to have been built in the blink of an eye.
克努特：现在，来亚什基或许又要变化了。它会变成什么样子？一切都变得太快。我们有了泳池和学校，都好像是突然间建起的……

As soon as a project is completed, the difficulties and sacrifices made along the way are quickly forgotten. The immense sense of accomplishment makes us believe that all the hard work was worth it.
克努特：在工程做完的瞬间，我们立刻忘记了它花了多久才变成这样，忘掉了受过的苦，巨大的喜悦让我们觉得流汗和血都值得。

I don't want to leave. I'm afraid I'll change faster than this town did. Those who come back later feel like strangers themselves.
克努特：我不想离开，我害怕我会比这座镇子变得更快。那些再回来的人自己也觉着成为了陌生人。

It's incredible, isn't it? How things can change in what feels like an instant ...
克努特：你知道的，一切……往往只是一夜之间。

An Instant
转瞬即逝

工厂精神
The Factory Spirit 小径

Factories, ores, and Rayashki!
阿德里安：工厂，矿石，来亚什基！

To me, Rayashki seems almost like another name for Runium. Perhaps it is because I am the one responsible for sifting the ore.
阿德里安：来亚什基——在我的记忆里它几乎是卢恩矿石的另一个别称，这可能因为我恰好是个负责筛矿石的。

While most people came here with grand ideals, I simply signed my name on the list without much thought. It wasn't long before I found myself stepping off the train and into this unfamiliar land. Fortunately, aside from the wild Critters roaming about and the stubborn terrain, life here has been relatively simple.
阿德里安：大部分家伙到这来，身上都背着伟大理想，而我，不知道要做些啥，稀里糊涂就把名字填上了单子。转眼就下了车，就到这啦。好在除了周围的魔精和硬得啃不动的土地，事情都算简单。

Regardless, it's all laborious work. And I understand that even Critters have to eat and survive. I forgive them.
阿德里安：反正成天是做些体力活儿，嗯？但魔精也要讨口饭吃，我原谅它们！

But back to the here and now. The factory is finally complete, and we have surpassed our wildest expectations. These accomplishments are not gifts from some higher power, but of our own making!
阿德里安：还是说现在的事。新的工厂建起来了，我们完成了几乎不可能的目标，我们创造了奇迹！

These are true miracles, not bestowed by any divine entity but created by our own hard work and determination. Just take a look around!
阿德里安：不是由哪个存在施舍的，而是大伙儿造出来的——实打实的奇迹啊！您瞧瞧这事！

There was a time when I felt nothing, just going through the motions of everyday life. But now I finally feel like I am making a difference. It may not be extraordinary, but it's more than most people achieve in their lives.
阿德里安：从前我没什么感觉，过日子嘛，每天就这样。但现在我相信我在做些有意义的活计。没那么伟大，比人类通常能实现的多一点儿……

Yes, I couldn't have done this alone. It's a rare opportunity to find others willing to work alongside you, swinging hammers and building something meaningful together.
阿德里安：是的，一个人做不来！一生里头很难有这样的机会，上哪儿去找和你一起拼命挥锤子的同胞?

I hope to turn our experiences here into a legend, like the stories of Comrade Evgeni. With a little exaggeration, of course. Young people need these legends to inspire them.
阿德里安：我会努力把这些讲成一个传奇，跟叶甫根尼同志的事迹一起。当然，适当稍微夸张些。年轻人们最需要这种传奇故事了。

So let's raise a glass to the new factory and all that we have accomplished here together!
阿德里安：为新工厂干杯！

The Factory Spirit
工厂精神

一个承诺

A Promise 小径

Vibrant Snowy Square
明亮的雪地

英文 / ENGLISH

Take another good look at the square. It hasn't changed much—a polar bear stands in the center, outlined by a faint light, while children eagerly reach out to touch its paws. The snow dusts the bear's head, giving it a serene quality that contrasts with the lively setting. Flowers bloom amidst the white snow, covering most of the stones on the ground. The bear appears to be at peace against the mustard yellow background.

This is an important place in Rayashki, as the town kitchen cannot accommodate such a large number of people. It is often used for public discussions and will continue to serve that purpose. Recently, it was decided to allow children to venture outside and explore the world beyond. The road leading there is bathed in sunlight, decorated with red ribbons that sway in the gentle breeze from the trees.

People find familiar images here that evoke nostalgia and memories of past lives, yet those who come here rarely speak of their homeland. This is the true essence of Rayashki—everything they hoped to see in their homeland, but never did. It's like the distant horizon that Rusalka dreams of as she braves the icy waters, or the intricate illustrations created by traveling ley hunters, or even the homes of Foundation visitors who have long since disappeared. It's what previous generations promised the next: a glimpse of their idealized homeland.

The more impossible an ideal seems, the stronger it becomes—unbreakable in its perceived perfection.

Despite this, there is still so much to strive for and achieve in life.

中文 / CHINESE

再好好瞧瞧广场。它变得不多——中间有一只轮廓柔和的北极熊，孩子们伸手去摸它的脚爪。雪覆盖了熊的头顶，使它显现出一种与愉快气氛不符的沉思感。在整片地面上，花朵几乎盖去了所有石头和白雪，熊安静地生活在一片灿烂的明黄色中。

这是来亚什基最重要的场所之一，也许因为小镇的厨房里挤不下那么多人。许多公开决议都在这儿举行，此后也将继续下去。不久前，人们决定接受另一份邀请，让孩子们走到外边看看。沿着那条道路——被阳光映亮的道路，树上缠绕的红布条在风里上下飘动。

人们在这里找到了自己熟悉的影像，一些过往生活的痕迹。尽管踏上这片土地的人很少谈论起他们的家乡。来亚什基应该是这样的，是他们曾经期望能在故土看到但从未实现的样子。就像穿越寒流的鲁萨尔卡远远望见的地平线那样，像四处奔波的理线师描绘的图景那样，像造访的基金会成员不复存在的故乡那样，像上一代人向下一代许诺的那样。

理想越难以实现，就越伟大，因不可实现而不可摧毁。

生活中还有更多事等着人们去做。

致后代
To Descendants FR-19

The river of time has moved swiftly in the passing months.
激昂的时间河流在这儿悄无声息地摆荡了数月。

Rayashki is bustling with the sounds of a busy and hopeful community.
熙熙攘攘的人声此起彼伏。

Crowds of people, lively and spirited, weave to-and-fro.
人群在这里合流，又在这里分散，奔向各自的位置。

Swimming Pool, Rayashki
来亚什基·游泳馆

A disheveled figure hurries into the scene.
一个灰头土脸的人影急匆匆地挤进了这里。

Windsong: Thank goodness! I was hoping you'd be here!
北方哨歌：万幸——你果然在这里！

Windsong: Oh, erm, is this a bad time?
北方哨歌：……不过，我是不是应该回避一下？

Vila: Heh heh, no, it's alright. Have a seat.
维拉：呵呵，没什么好奇怪的，随便坐吧～

Vila: I'm not a pure Rusalka. As you can see, I must get in touch with water every once in a while to replenish my power from the ocean.
维拉：我并不是血统纯正的鲁萨尔卡。如你所见，每隔一段时间，我都要回到水中，汲取海洋所赋予我们的灵感与养分。

Windsong: Ahem. Hello, Comrade Vila.
北方哨歌：咳——你好，维拉同志。

Vila: It's been a while, Comrade Windsong.
维拉：好久不见，北方哨歌同志。

Vila: They say you're working hard in the mine, and the study of ley lines is getting popular among the workers.
维拉：我听说你整天在矿区里奔波，越来越多的工人们认可了理线学。

Windsong: They have helped a lot. My research on the environment wouldn't have gone nearly so smoothly without them.
北方哨歌：他们帮了我很多忙……如果没有他们，对来亚什基环境的研究不会这么顺利。

Windsong: It's given a second life to my studies, and it is growing so well. It has even gained some recognition beyond Rayashki.
北方哨歌：理线学在这里重获新生，生根发芽……甚至得到了外部的认可。

Windsong: I, I'm truly happy that I came here.
北方哨歌：我……很高兴能来到这儿。

Vila: I never thought the Comrade Windsong would be so bashful over her accomplishments. I thought you were more stubborn and confident than that.
维拉：真没想到，对自己所研究的理论顽固而自信的北方哨歌同志也会露出如此羞怯的一面。

Windsong: ...
北方哨歌：……

Vila: I'm only teasing, comrade. It's a matter of fact that you are not as fearless as you pretend to be, isn't it?
维拉：我并没有取笑你，北方哨歌同志。事实上，你远不如看上去那般无所畏惧，不是吗?

Vila: That's why we must all stick together to make up for each other's weaknesses and make Rayashki proud! Sorry, speeches have become an occupational habit.
维拉：这也正是人们紧紧团结在一起的理由，我们弥补不足，也……
抱歉，我的职业病又犯了～

Windsong: Fine, you got me. But it's not a big deal. Just as you are not quite the gentle and demure school teacher that you appear to be, are you, comrade?
北方哨歌：好吧，我承认。
但这没什么好奇怪的，你也远没有表面上那么温柔，是吧?

Windsong: We're even!
北方哨歌：——我们扯平!

Windsong clears her throat and hands the letter to Vila.
北方哨歌补救性地轻咳了两声，将手中的信件递给了维拉。

Windsong: Actually, I've come to say goodbye.
北方哨歌：我是来向你告别的……

Windsong: Laplace has invited me to give a lecture for their European branch. They want me to give a lecture on how I combined environmental analysis with the arcanum based on what we've done here in Rayashki.
北方哨歌：科算中心邀请我参加即将在欧洲分部举办的讲座，他们希望我以来亚什基为案例，介绍理线学是如何将神秘学与环境分析学结合起来的。

Vila: Sounds like a very promising new beginning for your studies.
维拉：听起来是个良好的开始。

Windsong: How are things going in the town?
北方哨歌：来亚什基发展得如何?

Vila: We are getting more visitors now. It seems people are eager to see something different.
维拉：到这儿来参观的游客们变多了，他们相当热情，希望见证某些不一样的东西。

Windsong: I'm sure they will.
北方哨歌：我敢肯定，他们会得偿所愿的。

Vila: We've also begun cooperating with many governments and agencies near us, including the Foundation.
维拉： 我们与周边的许多地方都达成了合作，甚至包括基金会。

Vila: They hope to carry out some short-term training on the arcanum for the children.
维拉： 他们希望为孩子们进行一些简单的神秘学短期培训。

Another letter is passed on.
另一封湿漉漉的信被递了上来。

Windsong: What's this?
北方哨歌： 这是……？

Vila: Open it. It's from the Foundation.
维拉： 拆开看看吧，这是从基金会寄来的。

Vila: Mr. Name Day invites me to visit the Foundation and discuss further cooperation. The children are also waiting for me there.
维拉： 命名日先生邀请我到基金会去，与他们商谈更多的合作方案，孩子们也在那儿等着我。

Vila: It seems they mentioned you all the time during their training.
维拉： 在基金会学习的时候，他们也一直念叨着你。

Vila: "Did we miss the ley line exam?"
维拉： “我们错过了理线学的考试吗?”

Vila: "The Foundation has all sorts of incredible things."
维拉： “基金会里有许多神奇的东西……”

"Avgust": Like biting coins, noisy coal balls, a glass pen with rainbows inside. So much fun!
“阿夫西维”： 这儿有会咬人的金币、咋咋呼呼的小煤球、捕捉彩虹的玻璃笔……还有很多很多好玩的东西。

"Pasono": I've mastered a lot of incantations!
“帕索诺”： 我学到了许多神秘学咒语！

"Nina": I miss the town and everyone.
“尼娜”： 我很想念小镇的大家……

"Avgust": Yeah. We miss Comrade Alenka, Comrade Blinchik, and Comrade Piroshki!
“阿夫西维”： 没错，我们想念阿廖卡同志，想念布林同志，还有友谊同志！

"Pyotr": They say we will be able to go home in a few months!
“彼得森”： 几个月后，我们就能回家了！

"Pyotr": I must master the most powerful arcane skills by then, so I can use them to protect the town!
“彼得森”： 我一定能学会最厉害的神秘术，保护好小镇的安全！

"Avgust": We'll transform into sea swallows!
“阿夫西维”： 我们也会变成海燕！

"Avgust": Then we'll be able to fly and fly to far, far away!
“阿夫西维”： 飞呀～飞呀～飞到更远的地方！

Radio Broadcaster I: The Kaslinska University Hospital received a rare case today.
电台主播 I： 今日，卡斯林斯卡医学院附属医院接收了一例罕见病例。

Radio Broadcaster I: The patient's veins irreversibly transformed into electric wires. As of 18:00, all arterial, venous, and capillary tissues throughout the patient's body have undergone necrosis.
电台主播 I： 某患者血管呈现出了不可逆的电线化特征。截止至 18：00 时，该患者全身的动脉、静脉及毛细血管组织均已坏死。

Radio Broadcaster I: The director said they would invite more professionals to the consultation to decide on further research directions.
电台主播 I： 卡斯林斯卡医学院院长受访时称，他们将邀请更多专业人员参与会诊，商讨后续的研究工作。

Radio Broadcaster I: Global Variety News has claimed the case may become one of the greatest unsolved mysteries of the era.
电台主播 I： 《世界新奇报》声称，“电线人”症状将会成为新的未解之谜。

Radio Broadcaster I: They started a new column to analyze possible compatibilities between the patient's new wired veins and different appliances.
电台主播 I： 同时，他们发起了专栏活动，旨在分析该“电线人”的血管构造对不同电器的应用频率。

Radio Broadcaster I: Please stay tuned for more details.
电台主播 I： 本电台将持续为您报道——

Radio Broadcaster II: The Flying Carpet Travel Agency is starting a tour around Northern Europe ...
电台主播 II： 近日，“飞毯旅行社”将组织一场巡游北欧的浪漫之旅。

Radio Broadcaster II: ... where you will be able to see the breathtaking aurora borealis, pet fluffy Qiqirns, and even enjoy a flying carpet race.
电台主播 II： 在那里，你们能见证浪漫的极光，与毛绒绒的奇肯恩们亲密接触，享受雪地飞毯竞速赛……

Radio Broadcaster II: The destination of our tour is Rayashki.
电台主播 II： 最后，我们将会抵达一座神秘的小镇，来亚什基。

Radio Broadcaster II: A mysterious town, the warmest place in the Arctic Circle, sitting atop many rich veins of coal.
电台主播 II： 那儿有丰富的煤矿，是北极最温暖的地方。

Radio Broadcaster II: When you get there, we suggest that you abide by the town's wishes and work to earn what you need instead of buying it. Though this is not an obligation, of course.
电台主播 II： 在那儿，相比支付金钱，我衷心希望各位参与一些力所能及的劳动来换取所需。当然，这并不是强迫性的。

Radio Broadcaster II: But why not have a try when you are given the opportunity to experience a new and better lifestyle? Trust me, you won't be disappointed.
电台主播 II： 但是，倘若我们能见证一种崭新的、更美好的理想生活，为何不亲自试一试呢？……我相信，它不会令你们失望的。

???: Heh heh.
???: 呵呵……

???: Where should I start, dear readers?
???: 我该从何说起呢？UTTU 的读者们。

???: Rayashki is like a sparkling gem embedded into the permafrost. And above flies an eye-catching banner. Perhaps it will draw even more attention in the future.
???: 它是一颗镶嵌在永恒灰白色冻土上的珍贵宝石，也是一面鲜红的旗帜，或许未来会更加鲜红。

???: Through the past decades, the citizens there have been trying to achieve something different for themselves.
???: 在过去的许多年里，这里的居民希望建立一种不太一样的东西。

???: A great cause which may take the work of generations to achieve.
???: 这是一场漫长的奋斗。

???: But now they are no longer a nameless town in the far north, nor is their dream a passing fad bound to be forgotten.
???: 终于，他们不再是位于某个极北之地的一处历史的注脚，不再是一个将被悄然忘记的遗憾。

???: I sincerely hope all of us will be able to witness its history and its future.
???: 我很希望各位能够见证它的当下与未来。

???: That's why I knew I must write down this story. In the hopes that their dream will remain in your heart forever.
???: 因此，我设法记下了它，也希望这段岁月能够留存在你的心中。

8#2
8#2

潮湿的纸张
Damp Paperslip 小径

Lost Export Plan Found at Port
一份遗失在口岸上的出口规划

英文 / ENGLISH
Raw Coal:

Commonly used as a fuel for combustion. Suitable for heating and power generation. High priority for direct export (but can cause resource waste and air pollution).

Coal Gasification:

Can be converted into clean fuel gas for synthesis (related technology and facilities are expensive – consider collaborative production methods).

Coal Ash:

Produced from boiler combustion. Can be recycled for use in road construction. No need for export.

Coking Coal:

Important material for iron smelting (perhaps the ironworks could be rebuilt?).

In addition: It is reported that there is technology to produce refined coal after it is washed, and there is a high demand for refined coal in the south. Should be prioritized.

What is the source of this report? Who could have predicted that we would uncover a coal mine, or that we had been to the south?

—Comrade Evgeni listed more than a dozen common uses and export directions for energy in his letter, and we found one that we could use.
中文 / CHINESE
原煤：
一般作为燃料直接燃烧，可供暖及发电，直接出口优先度高（但易造成资源浪费和空气污染）。
原煤汽化：
可制成清洁燃料水煤气（相关技术设施较为昂贵，可考虑采取合作生产方式）。
煤灰：
锅炉燃烧后产生，可回收利用于道路基建。无出口必要。
焦煤：
冶铁重要原料（炼铁厂或可重建?）。

另：据悉存在洗煤后制成精煤的技术，南方精煤需求量大，建议优先考虑。

“据悉”是根据哪儿？谁早就知道咱们会开出来煤矿，还去过南方？
——叶甫根尼同志在信里列举了十多种常见能源的用途和出口方向，我们找着了一条能用上的。

狭路相逢
Narrow Path 小径

An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.
《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告

Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
TEL: 847-6861XXX

Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!
赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
电话：847-6861XXX

又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。

必读书目
Essential Reading 小径

Miners' Code and Appendix
《矿场职工操作行为守则》及附录

英文 / ENGLISH
Part One: Standard Training

1. Must complete safety knowledge training and pass a test before working.

2. Must be familiar with the site survey and operating procedures for the appropriate type of work.

....

9. Anyone under the age of 16 or over the age of 60 is absolutely prohibited from entering the mine.

Part Two: Practical Operations

1. Arrive at the site on time for shift changes.

2. Check the safety of the site, the quantity and quality of materials, and remove any obstructions that may impede operations.

....

9. Prepare a written record of the mine's safety conditions prior to shift changes, and regularly update and review this record.

Part Three: Safety Instructions

1. Must start engines according to standard procedures and perform reverse checks to ensure equipment reliability.

2. If abnormalities occur while operating winches, locomotives, or pickup vehicles, stop and investigate immediately.

3. Bring all necessary tools with you before entering the mine. Sharp tools must be carried in protective covers.

...

19. Fill out the logbook carefully and check it regularly.

Appendix - Index of Self-Manufacturable Components at the Factory

...

17. Cross Slides (process temporarily missing)

Comrade Evgeni extracted the method from the book. We have enough raw materials, approved for production. —I. I. Novikov

It's hard to make, but let's try anyway. —Bo. F. Braginskaya

中文 / CHINESE

第一部分 规范培训

1.必须经过安全知识学习及考试后持证上岗；

2.必须熟悉对应工种的实地勘察和操作流程；

……

9.全面杜绝年龄低于 16 岁及高于 60 岁者下井。

第二部分 实际操作

1.准时抵达作业地点交接班；

2.检查作业位置安全状况、材料数量与质量，并清理可能影响作业的障碍物；

……

9.交班前必须留下当时的矿井安全情况书面记录，并定时更新、核查该记录。

第三部分 安全须知

1.发动机器前必须按照规范流程启动，逆向检查设备运行质量；

2.绞车、机车、摘挂车发动过程中，如遇异常，须立即停车，再行检查；

3.下井前必须带齐所需工具，尖锐工具需配备防护套；

……

19.认真填写工作日记，并定期整合检查。

附录-工厂可自产元件索引

……

17.十字滑轨（工序暂缺）

叶甫根尼同志从书上摘抄了办法，我们也有足够的原材料，批准生产。——伊·伊·诺维科夫

这东西很难做，总之先试试吧。——波·弗·布拉金斯卡娅

嘿，明天！
Hey, Tomorrow! 小径

Kiril, it's time to get back to work! Please remind Bogina to come down from the forklift and stop playing Sudoku. We have to deliver the wood for reinforcing the mine roof by tonight.
伊利亚：基里尔，午休结束了！快让波金娜别坐在铲车上玩数独了，加固矿井顶梁的木材今晚就得送到围场上。

Oh, Knut! What brings you here? It's not yet time for the shift change.
伊利亚：哦——克努特！什么风把你吹来了？就算你是过来换班，那也太早了。

I'm not here for the shift change. I'm actually just dropping off some parts and a toolbox we found. Take a look, it's fully stocked.
克努特：是没到交接班的时候，我这就是来送些零件，还有翻出来的工具箱……瞧瞧，里面东西齐全着呢。

I couldn't help but notice Comrade Kiril standing off to the side, spinning in circles. It almost made me dizzy when I first arrived.
克努特：基里尔同志为什么站得那么远？还转着圈，我过来的时候都快把我绕晕了。

He's been acting like this since the lunch break started, while Bogina is engrossed in her usual game. I wonder what's going on with Kiril ...
伊利亚：他和波金娜从午休开始之后就这样了，波金娜在玩她的老太太游戏，基里尔嘛……

Illia, you haven't had the chance to read Comrade Evgeni's letter, so you don't know.
基里尔：——伊利亚，你没看到叶甫根尼同志的信，所以你不知道。

...
克努特：……

Looking at the stains on my hands from the coal dust, I can't help but think of his letter again. I find myself pacing back and forth, imagining how my comrades will lay me to rest when my time comes. It would be a great honor, but also ...
基里尔：看着手上的煤灰，我又想起他的信。然后我走来走去，想着到时候大伙儿会怎么把我埋掉。老实说，这很光荣，可也……

I can't help but feel that Comrade Evgeni deserved a different fate than this.
基里尔：我总觉得叶甫根尼同志不该是这样的结局。

He did not deserve to end his journey in this place.
基里尔：他不该停在这里。

Kiril ...
伊利亚：基里尔……

Comrade Knut was the first to find the letter. Later we all took turns touching it, like passing around a flag, remember?
???：你面前的克努特同志就是第一个发现那遗书的人。之后那封信我们也都亲手抚摸了，像交接一面流动旗帜，你忘了？

You shouldn't talk like that to Illia, and you shouldn't think like that about comrade Evgeni.
???：你不该这样对伊利亚说话，也不该那样想叶甫根尼同志。

But you said the same thing earlier, Bogina.
基里尔：可先前你也是这样说的，波金娜。

Yes, I said that. But I also said—
波金娜：是的，我是这样说了。但我同时也说——

"Comrade Evgeni ended his journey here, but we must go on."
波金娜：“叶甫根尼同志停在了这里，可我们不能停下。”

With only one square left to fill in the Sudoku, it's clear that this is the only way to go.
波金娜：数独有可填写的唯一空格，现在摆在我们面前的也是唯一的道路。

"Keep moving forward, to a better tomorrow."
波金娜：“继续前进，走向明天。”

This is not the end of our journey, Comrade Kiril.
伊利亚：不能停在这里，基里尔同志。

Right ... I may not be good with words, but I wholeheartedly agree with comrade Bogina.
克努特：是的……是的。我不会说话，但就是波金娜同志说的这样。

This must have been Comrade Evgeni's true wish.
克努特：这也一定是叶甫根尼同志真正的期望。

Hey, Tomorrow!
嘿，明天！

雪

Snow 小径

Snow and Other Possibilities
雪与其他可能

英文 / ENGLISH

To the town, she is a familiar figure. But to herself, everything is so drastically different.

She's used to walking in the snow. The poplar fluff floating through Moscow's streets reminds her of Rayashki; it's like snow, but it doesn't make her cheeks turn red or her hands and feet cold; it doesn't melt on the skin, nor can it hide anything. Canned goods, even sausages and fresh meat, are available in stores, and one doesn't have to count the days just to exchange for everyday items ... The first time she made soup in her new home, it felt surreal. Another vivid memory was when she got off the train, holding her child's hand in fear. Outside the small town, in Moscow, there were so many people, all seemingly full of hope.

But she boarded the train back to Rayashki anyway.

Rayashki had changed, too. There were faces in the town she didn't recognize, and the statue in the center of the square had changed. The school was still the same, and the children played games in the small playground. The townspeople's greetings were a bit awkward; no one mentioned her hasty departure as if it was not important, as if anyone could leave at any time and also return whenever they wanted.

Snow fell on her hair and collar, turning her fingers and nose red—this was real snow.

中文 / CHINESE

对小镇来说，这是个熟悉的身影。对来者自己而言，一切都如此陌生。

她习惯了在雪中穿行。莫斯科街头飞舞的杨絮会令她想起来亚什基，它与雪很相近，却不会使人脸颊通红，手足冰冷，不会在皮肤上化开，也无法遮掩任何事物。商店里能买到罐头，甚至香肠和新鲜的肉，想置换些日用品也不必掰着指头数时间……第一次在新搬的屋子里炖汤的时候，她感觉这不真实。另一件让她印象颇深的事是刚下火车时，她吓得攥紧了孩子的手——在小镇之外的地方，在莫斯科，竟然有这样多的人，而且瞧上去也都充满希望。

但她还是踏上了回来亚什基的火车。

来亚什基也变了。镇上多了她不认识的脸，广场中央的雕塑换了模样。学校，学校还是老样子，孩子们在小操场上做游戏。镇民们的问候略显局促，没人提起她此前匆匆告别的事，似乎这并不重要，所有人随时都能离开，也随时能回到此地。

雪落上了她的头发和领口，让她的手指和鼻尖发红，这是真正的雪。

当下的路
The Path Ahead 小径

It's good to see you again, Comrade Ulyana. I heard that you have returned.
维拉：很高兴再见到您，乌里扬娜同志……

Did you get a chance to go to see the children? They've been going on about you for so long.
维拉：大家刚告诉我您回来的消息，您去见了孩子们吗？他们有很长一段时间总念叨着您。

It's been a while since I've been back to this town. How are the little ones doing? With you watching over them, I'm sure they're doing fine. You've always been such a caring teacher.
乌里扬娜：我刚到镇上没多久。那些小家伙们……有您看顾，一定过得挺不错，您一直是一位细心的老师。

But there is only so much that one person can do. It would be great to have another comrade to lend a hand.
维拉：可一个人总忙不过来，要是多一位同志搭把手就更好啦。

So, will you stay this time, Comrade Ulyana?
维拉：所以，您这次会留下吗，乌里扬娜同志?

Right. I wanted to talk to you about that ...
乌里扬娜：我正是想来同您谈谈这件事……

We can take our time to talk, no need to rush. By the way, did little Vasya come with you?
维拉：当然，您可以慢些讲，不必着急——对了，小瓦夏也同您一块儿来了吗?

Now that our supplies are fully stocked, we can take the children to the square tomorrow for some sketching ...
维拉：我记着，以前他很想要一盒彩色画笔。现在物资足够了，明天我们能和孩子们一块儿去广场写生……

It's just me this time, Comrade Vila.
乌里扬娜：只有我回来了，维拉同志。

...
乌里扬娜：……

Back in Moscow, my thoughts kept returning to Rayashki. Those who have chosen to stay here are incredibly determined and tenacious. They are genuinely sincere and kind, but they are very stubborn in their beliefs. Does that make any sense?
乌里扬娜：在莫斯科我也还是记着来亚什基。我会想留在这里的人们真是固执，虽然大家都诚挚、善良，但也都固执得很——您明白吗?

In Moscow, you don't have to worry about cold temperatures or lack of resources. If children need pencils, they can simply go to the nearest store and buy them.
乌里扬娜：不用担心天太冷，不用仔仔细细地考虑物资分配，孩子想要画笔，也能想法去商店里买。

That sounds like a dream come true! We're doing everything we can to make Rayashki just that.
维拉：这真好！我们所做的努力正是希望让来亚什基也变成这样的地方。

It was really beautiful, but when I sat next to Vasya's bed, when he was fighting his asthma, with the poplar fuzz in the air ... And then children's gravestones and coffins, so tiny and fragile, almost like toys ... I could hardly believe they were real.
乌里扬娜：是的，这的确很好。但……当我坐在瓦夏的病床前——他有哮喘，您知道——那些杨絮……给小孩子的墓碑和棺材原来也都那么小，就像……就像玩具。它们简直不像真的。

I clung to the hope that life would get better in Moscow. I believed that if I just endured and persevered a little longer, things would turn around.
乌里扬娜：我以为在莫斯科生活会变好。只要坚持，只要稍加忍耐，事情总会好起来……

But that was not the way it turned out.
乌里扬娜：但其实不是这样。

My sincerest condolences, Comrade Ulyana.
维拉：……抱歉，乌里扬娜同志。

It's alright, I brought it up myself. When I was in the house in Moscow, I couldn't stop crying. But eventually I realized that I had to pull myself together and do something.
乌里扬娜：没关系，是我主动对您提起的。待在莫斯科的房子里，我一直哭……然后，我想，我该想办法振作起来，做点什么。

Is it still possible for me to reunite with everyone? Looking back, I regret leaving in such a selfish manner.
乌里扬娜：我还能和大家站在一块儿吗？那时候……我不该只想着自己，就这么离开。

The future is unknown and unpredictable. All we can do is take one step at a time on the path that lies ahead of us.
维拉：我们没法预知未来，只有走在脚下的路上，努力踩得稳当些。

You will always have the ability to move forward on this path, with all of us.
维拉：任何时候，您都可以踏上这条路。

The Path Ahead
当下的路

欢迎回家！
Welcome Home! 小径

Don't all crowd around us at once, kids. Give us some space so that Miss Ulyana, your teacher, can greet you, okay?
维拉：小调皮鬼们，别一股脑儿挤过来。稍稍散开些，乌里扬娜老师好挨个儿跟你们打招呼，好吗？

Hooray! We're super happy you're teaching again, Miss Ulyana! Tee-hee!
尼娜：嗯！太好啦，我们又可以叫您“老师”了，乌里扬娜老师！嘿嘿～

Miss Ulyana! There are soo many new things in town that I can't wait to show you!
帕索诺：乌里扬娜老师！镇子上有这么——这么多新东西，我可以带您去看！

Me too! I know this town like the back of my hand, and I've got a sneaky shortcut to the mine to show you!
彼得森：我也可以！我对那些可熟了，我还知道去矿场的近路呢！

Of course, my little bears, my patient little comrades.
乌里扬娜：当然，小熊们，我耐心的小小同志们，别着急……

Here. I received this as a gift from the square, and I want to share it with you. Vila always tells us to share with others.
阿夫西维：给你。这是广场送给我的，我把它分享给你～维拉说我们应该学会分享。

What a beautiful sunflower. Thank you, Avgust. Say, you seem much happier now.
乌里扬娜：多漂亮的向日葵。谢谢你，阿夫西维同学，你看起来比之前开心。

I notice that my mom and everyone else around me are smiling, so I can't help but smile too.
阿夫西维：妈妈和其他人都笑得更多啦，所以我也和大家一块儿笑起来。

You're smiling too, Ulyana.
阿夫西维：乌里扬娜，你也笑啦。

Haha, yes. I, I really missed you all.
乌里扬娜：哈哈……对呀，我……我真想念你们。

Aw, don't rub your eyes with your hands, kids. Here's some handkerchiefs for you ...
维拉：别用手揉眼睛，孩子们，这儿有手帕……

It took you kids a long time to come up with that welcome. Don't forget to actually say it to Miss Ulyana.
维拉：你们花了很长时间认真想好的欢迎词，可别忘记告诉乌里扬娜老师喔。

—Welcome home, Miss Ulyana!
孩子们：——欢迎回家！乌里扬娜老师！

...!
乌里扬娜：——！

The welcome and the celebration, all arranged on the same day ... Rayashki is slowly gaining momentum again, but there's still so much to do. I hope you don't mind.
维拉：欢迎会和庆祝会安排在了同一天，来亚什基刚刚重新迈开步子，还有许多事儿……希望您别介意。

No, not at all. How can I be of help? Just let me know.
乌里扬娜：不，完全不会。我能帮上什么忙吗？请一定要告诉我……

Would you mind taking care of the children for a while? I have to go check on the port soon, and some friends from the Foundation are coming over for their regular lectures. Please make sure they are held to the same standards as our agreement. And finally ...
维拉：那我现在可就要麻烦您照顾孩子们啦。稍后我得到港口看看，还有……嗯，这段时间都会有基金会的朋友们按时来听课，请用教师的标准要求他们，这是合作协议里商量好的。此外……

Welcome home, Comrade Ulyana!
维拉：欢迎回家，乌里扬娜同志。

Welcome Home!
欢迎回家！

远方
Toward the Distance 小径

I've finished folding it, Comrade Pyotr. It's time to make our paper planes fly. Can you move a little? Just a bit!
尼娜： 我折好了——彼得森同学，我要让纸飞机飞起来啦！你可以往旁边站一点儿吗？就一点儿！

Alright! Let's see whose plane can fly the farthest!
彼得森： 行，看看我们谁飞得更远！

Three, two, one!
尼娜： 三，二，一！

The swallow dives into the snow pile. Pyotr wins.
阿夫西维： 海燕钻进了雪堆里头。彼得森赢啦。

He hasn't flown his yet, Comrade Avgust, maybe ...
尼娜： 他还没飞呢，阿夫西维同学，说不定……

Hey, Pasono, are you not going to play with us?
尼娜： 咦，帕索诺，你不和我们一起玩儿吗?

... I've been thinking about what Miss Vila said.
帕索诺： ……我，我在想维拉老师说的事。

Are you scared? Don't you want to go out and see? After all, our parents agreed, and adults always know better than we do.
彼得森： 你害怕啦，你不想出去瞧瞧吗？而且，爸爸妈妈都同意了，大人们可比我们懂得多。

I'm not scared! But... Miss Vila said she will not go with us, neither will Miss Ulyana.
帕索诺： 我没害怕！但是……维拉老师说她不会跟着我们一起走。乌里扬娜老师也不会。

Vila has a lot to do. After the slow turtles left, many new friends came to town. Vila wants to talk to them.
阿夫西维： 维拉有好多好多事要做。慢吞吞的乌龟们走了以后，又有好多新朋友到镇子来，维拉要和他们说话。

I don't think we need to worry so much. The teachers have allowed these friends of the Foundation to attend our classes, play with us, and take notes ...
尼娜： 我觉得，我们不用那么担心。老师们让基金会来的朋友们和我们一起上课，和我们一起玩儿，还要记笔记……

They don't seem like bad people. If they were bad, Miss Vila would shoo them away.
尼娜： 他们看上去不像坏人。如果是坏家伙，维拉老师会把他们赶出去的。

That's right, Pasono! Even Avgust isn't as anxious as you are!
彼得森： 没错，帕索诺！连阿夫西维都不像你这么紧张！

I'm not nervous, I just want to learn how to transform things. Like turning a sunflower into a towering soldier or a bear with round ears ...
阿夫西维： 我不紧张，我也想学会变东西。把向日葵变成高高的哨兵，变成圆耳朵的小熊～

We could turn snowmen into us to keep Vila company. Mom always said that when we miss her, we should build a snowman.
阿夫西维： 把雪人变成我们，陪维拉一起。妈妈说过，想她的时候就做一个雪人。

—And Vila will definitely miss us when we're gone.
阿夫西维： ——维拉肯定会想我们的。

Yes, we should leave a gift for Miss Vila! Let's go make some snowmen!
彼得森：对呀，我们应该给维拉老师留下礼物！那——我们现在就来堆雪人吧！

Alright!
尼娜：好呀！

Yes, let's find the prettiest twigs to decorate them with!
帕索诺：好，我们要用最好看的树枝做装饰！

Let's go, everyone. Split up to find materials and come back as quickly as we can!
彼得森：走吧，大家分头去找材料，要用最快的速度回来集合！

Toward the Distance
远方

捡树枝行动
Twig Collecting Initiative 小径

An advertisement from the ads page of Wall Street Journal.
《华尔街新闻日报》中缝的一则广告

> Come to C.C Critter Pawnshop to make extra money!
> TEL: 847-6861XXX
>
> Are the cunning, ubiquitous critters annoying you again? Don't take that as bad news, because if you have a critter, you just found yourself enough money to pay your rent! We offer the best, the most precise, and the most honest pricing options you'll ever find! Our shop will buy any critters from the cheapest Carbuncles to the expensive yet delicious Rubberados that keep diners bouncing about! C.C swears on its name that every critter we buy will be treated like a family in compliance with internationally recognized standards of humane treatment!
> 赚外快，就来 C.C 魔精典卖行！
> 电话：847-6861XXX
>
> 又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。

孩子的创造
Children's Creation 小径

Circle Dance
圆圈舞

> 英文 / ENGLISH
> Snowmen of various sizes were arranged in a circle on the playground, and the children lovingly linked their twig arms together so that the snow friends were holding hands. Each child focused on decorating their little creation, staying close together, and when one arm brushed another's shoulder, there was a cheerful laugh.
>
> The little girl on the far left lowered her head, her braids curled up like haystacks in the sun. She carefully placed sunflower petals on her snowman's head. Nearby, two boys were trying to make their snowman's chubby body wider and sturdier so it would last longer and Ms. Vila could greet them more often.

The little boy's snowman was a bear. It was only through his explanation that the head and paws of the arctic fox could be seen on its back. Foxes don't usually have long ears like rabbits, but he gave it those in order to hear his mother's footsteps, Vila's footsteps, and his friends' footsteps. Finally, he carefully placed the mined ore on the fox's chest, just as he wore the beautiful stone his father had left him.

"Okay, my frosty comrades! You can all stay here and do the circle dance with Ms. Vila. Remember, no running around or making a ruckus; just listen to her instructions ..."

中文 / CHINESE

大小不一的雪人在操场上围成了圈，孩子们贴心地将它们的树枝手臂两两绑在一起，让这群雪朋友可以手拉着手。他们各自专注地装饰自己的小小造物，同样贴得离彼此很近，每当谁的胳膊撞上谁的肩膀，就会响起快活的笑声。

最左边的小姑娘低下头，辫子像太阳下的草垛儿一样翘起，闪闪发亮。她把向日葵花瓣仔细地贴在雪人头顶。旁边，两个男孩子试图把雪人胖胖的身躯变得再宽些，再结实些，好挨过更长时间，使它不太快融化——这样维拉老师能多跟它们打几次招呼。

属于小个子男孩儿的雪人是一只小熊，尽管需要依靠他的介绍，才能区分出脑袋、爪子、熊背上趴着的北极狐。狐狸通常可没有兔子的长耳朵，但他会让它拥有这个，好听清妈妈的脚步、维拉的脚步、好朋友们的脚步。现在是最后的工序了，他把找到的矿石仔细地安放在狐狸胸口，就像他把爸爸留下的漂亮石头挂在胸前。

“好啦，雪人同志们！你们要好好留在这里，和维拉老师一块儿跳圆圈舞，别乱跑，别吵闹，听她的话……”

工人们

The Workers 小径

Caring Crowd

温暖的人群

英文 / ENGLISH

Among the long tables sits a group of people.

The one in the middle maintains her usual politeness and friendly smile. If you weren't looking at how her hands are resting uncertainly on the table, you'd miss the emotion beyond the politeness. Yes, this young scholar is stunned that the theory she has been focusing on is back in the spotlight. After being relegated to the pile of old papers in most places outside, it has found a place in Rayashki.

As for the people around her, most are still wearing their work clothes, with coal dust clinging to their collars and pant legs. They are aware of this and keep their distance from the scholar until she reaches out to them. This group of makeshift teachers and students shake hands, determined to spend time understanding a fading discipline. Those most dedicated to the work are also the most serious pragmatists. The study of ley lines has played such an important role in the rebuilding of the town! When the scholar first entered the research institute, this is what she had hoped for. Is the study of ley lines omnipotent? No. But it may eventually bring about change.

Perhaps it will be the moment the coal mine was discovered, or perhaps it is this moment.

中文 / CHINESE

在长桌与长桌之间有这样一群人。

被围在中间的那个，维持着她惯常的礼貌、友善的笑容，如果不将目光挪向桌面那只不知如何安放的手，就会错过这层礼貌外的情绪——不可置信——是的，这位年轻的学者震惊于她所专注的理论如今再次备受瞩目，在外面多数地方把理线学扫进旧纸堆之后，它在来亚什基却有了容身之所。

至于她周围的人，多数还身着工作服，煤灰爬上了他们的领口和裤腿。他们自己也清楚这点，因此和学者保持着距离，直到她伸出手。这群临时凑成的老师和学生彼此握手，决心花时间了解一门没落的学科。最热衷于劳动的人们也是最认真的实用主义者，理线学在小镇的重建工作里起了怎样重要的作用啊！最初，在走进研究所的时候，学者正怀抱着类似的期望。理线学是万能的吗？不。但它或许能在某个时间带来改变。

也许是发现煤矿的那一刻，也许就是这一刻。

意外情况
Unexpected Scenario 小径

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又被那些滑头滑脑，无处不在的小家伙们绕晕了头？别把它们往坏处想！事实上，当您拥有了一只魔精，就等于掌握了财富，足以应付接下来的房租。我们有全美最准确的价格分区，童叟无欺。从最便宜的卡邦克鲁，到昂贵且美味得使食用者弹跳不停的拉伯雷多，都能在本行换得相应的报酬。C.C 行长向您保证，所售魔精会得到符合国际人道主义标准的家庭关怀。

抵达地平线
To the Horizon Line 小径

Wow. I'm getting a little nervous.
北方哨歌： 咳咳，这还真有点叫人紧张。

There are a lot of new faces here, quite unexpected. Well, hopefully a midday vodka will calm my nerves.
北方哨歌： 生面孔还挺多的……简直出乎意料。行，希望中午那杯伏特加能起作用。

May I have your attention, please? Comrades and visitors, welcome to today's lecture on the study of ley lines.
北方哨歌： 不好意思，请看这儿——各位同志，以及各位造访此地的陌生人，欢迎你们来参加这场理线学讲座。

I am Windsong, your speaker for today.
北方哨歌： 我是北方哨歌，今天的主讲人。

Now, I will present some practical examples on how the Study of Ley Lines can be applied to the mineral development in Rayashki ...
北方哨歌： 接下来，我将结合来亚什基矿产开发的具体情况，介绍一些理线学的实际应用事例……

...
……

This is undoubtedly beneficial to our research. Who cares about other people's opinions? Personally, I find Ley Lines very useful and relevant.
拉普拉斯研究员： 嗯，的确。这对我们的研究也有一定好处……谁管其他人怎么说？我看理线学挺有实用性。

We definitely need to try this out and tell Ms. Lucy about it. I have no doubt she would be intrigued by this type of presentation ...
拉普拉斯研究员： 当然得试试，这事儿也得让露西女士知道。她肯定会有兴趣亲自听听这样的讲座……

I'll take thorough notes. I'll be prepared in case there's a Q&A session later.
拉普拉斯研究员： 笔记……我先写详细些，如果稍后有提问环节……

Hello, there!
维拉： 抱歉，您好?

Uh? Oh. Hello, ma'am.
拉普拉斯研究员： 呃？噢……！您好，女士。

If you need a seat closer to the front, I can take you to the visitor's seats over there.
维拉： 如果您需要更近些的位置，我可以带您过去，那边有访客席位。

No thank you, I'm not a typical guest like them. I'm here as a researcher.
拉普拉斯研究员： 不用，反正我不像他们，我只是个搞研究的。

Is there somewhere I can hear more clearly? Does Ms. Windsong have any other business to attend to? I have a list of questions written down, such as methods for identifying lines ...
拉普拉斯研究员： 有没有能听得更清楚的地方？北方哨歌女士是否有其他事务要处理？我记录了几处疑问，比如辨认线条的技巧之类……

There will be a Q&A session after the presentation. Follow me and we'll see if there's a better location for you that's closer and more spacious.
维拉： 讲座结束后的确有答疑环节。您和我一块儿过来吧，我瞧瞧有没有更近的、空旷些的地方好落脚。

...
……

Phew, I really need a drink. This is as tiring as any physical labor.
北方哨歌： 呼，我该找点儿什么喝两口，这真是件体力活。

I hope the Q&A session won't be met with dead silence. Just in case, I have prepared a couple of basic talking points ...
北方哨歌： 希望待会儿的答疑环节不会一片沉默。最差的情况……我也准备了两三个简单的问题……

Comrade Windsong, here.
维拉： 北方哨歌同志，请你拿稳了，给。

Perfect. This glass of water couldn't have come at a better time.
北方哨歌： 你的这杯水真及时！我正需要这个。

The lecture went smoothly, and I still have time to make it to today's performance. As I promised to Avgust and the others, I have a little trick with ley lines that will surely amaze them.
北方哨歌：讲座还算顺利，我能赶上今天的演出——我答应了阿夫西维他们来点“翻花绳”的小把戏呢。

The Study of Ley Lines is much more than just a little trick, Comrade Windsong. We all know this to be true.
维拉：哈哈，理线学可不是什么小把戏，北方哨歌同志，我知道。

The woman from Laplace has technical inquiries for you. You might want to finish your drink, I have a feeling she has quite a few questions lined up.
维拉：那位拉普拉斯的女士想和你交流一些技术问题，你多喝几口水吧。我相信她肯定攒了一大堆话，就等着待会好提问。

She can ask all she wants about the subject. The truth is, I'll be researching Ley Lines for a long time to come.
北方哨歌：那就让她尽管问吧！不怕你笑话，我跟理线学相依为命的日子久得很呢。

What are your thoughts on this lecture? I welcome constructive criticism, so feel free to share your honest opinions, Comrade Vila.
北方哨歌：说来，你对这次讲座感想如何？我相当擅长听取意见，维拉同志，你不必安慰我。

It brought back memories of a "line" I had seen before, although it's not exactly the same as your ley lines.
维拉：我想起了曾见过的一线光景，虽然不是你所说的万物的线条。

One morning I was floating on the surface of the water, admiring the distant shore. The horizon line seemed impossibly far away, with a soft glow radiating from it.
维拉：在某个清晨，我随着海浪漂浮，凝望着远处的土地，地平线离我十分遥远，也十分柔和、明亮。

At that moment, I decided to go and see for myself. And so I arrived at Rayashki, my footprints leaving marks in the snow as I watched it transform into what it is today.
维拉：我决心要去看看。然后，我踏上了来亚什基，在雪地上留下足迹，眼见它变成如今的样子。

... It's remarkable how our dreams are gradually becoming a reality.
维拉：……多好啊，我们的理想都在逐渐实现。

To the Horizon Line
抵达地平线